IM345AT ▪ IV SEMESTER B.E.

MARKETING MANAGEMENT

Unit-wise Question Bank

with Model Answers to the Marking Scheme

Consolidated from the Semester End Examinations

September/October 2024 ▪ June/July 2025

Department of Industrial Engineering and Management
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How This Book Is Arranged

Every previous-year question recorded for this course is reproduced here — **165 questions** in total, **65 from Part A** and **100 from Part B**, drawn from thirteen papers:

- **Semester End Examinations** — October/November 2023, September/October 2024, and June/July 2025.
- **Continuous Internal Evaluation** — CIE-I of 1 July 2024, 3 April 2025 and 16 April 2026; CIE-II of 24 July 2024 (including the quiz), 7 May 2025 and 26 May 2026; and CIE-III of June 2026.
- **Improvement CIE** — 28 August 2024 and 4 June 2025.

Nothing has been abridged or silently dropped, and no question appears twice. Where a question has been set in more than one paper — and several have been set three or four times — it is answered once, with every occurrence recorded in its source tag. Those repeats are worth noticing: a question that has appeared in three papers is the single best use of revision time.

The questions are not printed paper by paper. They are re-arranged **unit-wise**, against the five units of the official IM345AT syllabus, so that everything examinable on one unit is read together. Two rules were used to place a question:

- **Part B** follows the official SEE blueprint, which is itself a unit map: Q2 is set from Unit I, Q3 and Q4 from Unit II, Q5 and Q6 from Unit III, Q7 and Q8 from Unit IV, Q9 and Q10 from Unit V.
- **Part A** draws from the whole syllabus and carries no blueprint, so each two-mark question has been placed against the unit whose descriptor actually contains its topic.

Every question carries a source tag beside its own text — [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q3b — 8 M] — naming the paper, the original question number where one was printed, and the marks. Appendix A at the back inverts the arrangement: it lists each paper in its original order and gives the page on which each answer is found, so a whole past paper can be worked through end to end and then marked.

Note the difference in format between the two kinds of paper. The SEE sets ten two-mark questions in Part A and eight-mark sub-divisions in Part B; the CIE sets two-mark questions and **ten-mark** descriptive questions. A ten-mark CIE answer therefore needs ten scoring points where the same topic in the SEE needs eight — which is why several questions in this book appear in both an eight-mark and a ten-mark form, answered at the length each paper's scheme expects.

Answers are written to the length the marks buy. A two-mark answer is two to four sentences. An eight-mark answer carries eight scoring points, a ten-mark answer ten, a six-mark answer six — because the valuation scheme for this course awards roughly one mark per distinct, correctly explained point. Where the official scheme of valuation prescribes a split, it is stated in the **Marking scheme** line that closes the answer; where no scheme was released, that line records the split the question's own wording implies.

> **How to use the marking-scheme line.** In the examination you are not rewarded for volume. You are rewarded for hitting the number of distinct points the scheme expects, each named and then explained in a line or two. Where an answer below runs longer than you could write in the time available, treat the numbered points as the skeleton to reproduce and the prose as the explanation to compress.

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UNIT 1

Introduction to Digital Marketing and Content Marketing

Syllabus: Principles of Digital Marketing; Digital Marketing Channels; Tools to Create Buyer Persona; Competitor Research Tools; Website Analysis Tools. Content Marketing Concepts and Strategies; Planning, Creating, Distributing and Promoting Content; Optimising Website UX and Landing Pages; Measuring Impact; Metrics and Performance; Using Content Research for Opportunities.

In the examination: Part B Question 2 is compulsory and is always set from this unit, so Unit I cannot be skipped by internal choice. It also supplies the largest share of Part A, because the marketing fundamentals — the mix, segmentation and research vocabulary — sit here.

Part A — Two-Mark Questions

1. **Differentiate between push and pull marketing.** [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.1 — 2 M]

   Push marketing takes the product to the customer: the seller creates demand and pushes the offering through the channel — trade promotions, distributor incentives, cold e-mails, SMS blasts, display and interruptive ads. The buyer has not asked for it. It suits new or unknown products that nobody is searching for yet. **Pull marketing** draws the customer to the brand: demand is created so that the buyer initiates the search — SEO, content marketing, organic social, referrals, word of mouth. In one line: push interrupts, pull attracts.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for push with an example, 1 M for pull with an example.

2. **Mention any four characteristics of a good content.** [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.2 — 2 M]

   (1) **Relevant and useful** — solves a real problem of the defined target audience.
   (2) **Original and accurate** — researched, credible, correctly sourced, not duplicated.
   (3) **Clear and well-structured** — readable, scannable headings, short paragraphs, plain language.
   (4) **Engaging and actionable** — holds attention and closes with a clear call to action.

   Also acceptable: SEO-optimised, shareable, visually supported, consistent with brand voice, current and up to date.

   Marking scheme: Any four characteristics, half a mark each. Naming alone is enough at two marks.

3. **Comment on the importance of demographic segmentation.** [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.1 — 2 M]

   Demographic segmentation divides a market by measurable population variables — age, gender, income, education, occupation, family size, religion. It is important because the data is easy and cheap to obtain, is objective and verifiable, correlates strongly with both needs and purchasing power, and is directly usable as targeting criteria on every digital advertising platform. It therefore allows precise message personalisation and cost-efficient media selection, and it is the base layer on which psychographic and behavioural segmentation are built.

Marking scheme: 1 M for what it is, 1 M for two or more reasons why it matters.

4. Identify the 4 P's of marketing. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.2 — 2 M]

(1) **Product** — the goods or service offered, its features, quality, branding and after-sales support.
(2) **Price** — the amount charged and the pricing strategy, discounts and payment terms.
(3) **Place** — the distribution channels and locations through which the customer obtains it.
(4) **Promotion** — the communication mix used to inform and persuade: advertising, sales promotion, personal selling, publicity, digital.

Marking scheme: Half a mark each. Naming the four is sufficient; a phrase of explanation each earns full marks safely.

5. Assume you are sitting in the dining area in casual attire during your vacation. Your uncle, a marketing manager, gives you a pen and asks you to sell it right at that moment. How would you respond? [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.3 — 2 M]

I would not begin by describing the pen. I would first ask questions to uncover a need — "When did you last have to sign something important, and what did you sign it with?" — and then position the pen against the need that answer reveals, whether that is reliability at a client meeting, the impression a good instrument makes, or simply having one to hand when it matters. I would close by asking for the sale directly. The point being demonstrated is **need-based selling**: establish the need first, present the product as the solution second.

Marking scheme: 1 M for asking questions/establishing the need before pitching, 1 M for linking the product's benefit to that need and closing.

6. Identify two types of research data. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.4 — 2 M]

Primary data — collected first-hand by the researcher for the problem currently in hand, through surveys, interviews, focus groups, observation or experiments. It is specific and current but costly and slow. **Secondary data** — already collected by someone else for another purpose, such as census reports, industry and trade publications, company records or existing Google Analytics data. It is fast and cheap but may be dated or not exactly fit the problem.

Marking scheme: 1 M each, with one line of description.

7. Provide your own psychographic and demographic profile as a marketing person would assess you. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.5 — 2 M]

Demographic: 20 years old, unmarried, undergraduate engineering student, resident of Bengaluru, urban middle-income household, no independent income beyond a monthly allowance of roughly Rs. 5,000. **Psychographic:** technology-forward and an early adopter of apps; value-conscious and strongly discount-driven; achievement-oriented with placement and higher studies as goals; interests in gaming, fitness and coding; heavy smartphone and social media user who reads reviews before every purchase; brand-aware but price-sensitive; prefers online purchase with cash-on-delivery or UPI.

Marking scheme: 1 M for a demographic profile using at least three standard variables, 1 M for a psychographic profile covering lifestyle, interests, values or attitudes.

8. Highlight one advantage and one limitation of psychographic segmentation. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.6 — 2 M]

Advantage: it explains *why* people buy. By segmenting on values, lifestyle, personality, interests and attitudes it enables emotionally resonant messaging and genuine brand differentiation, and so builds stronger loyalty than demographics alone can. **Limitation:** the data is subjective and difficult to obtain. It cannot be observed directly, must be inferred from surveys or behavioural proxies, is expensive to collect and hard to validate, and the resulting segments are hard to size and reach precisely — which makes media buying against them less reliable than against demographics.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

9. You want to test an app you have developed which addresses some needs of engineering college students. How can you use digital marketing to get initial quantitative feedback? [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.7 — 2 M]

Run narrowly targeted paid campaigns on Instagram, Facebook and LinkedIn filtered to the 18–24 age band and to specific engineering colleges, driving traffic to a landing page carrying an embedded Google Form. Quantitative feedback then comes from the numbers the campaign itself produces — click-through rate, cost per install, sign-up conversion rate, form response distributions, in-app event completion and Day-7 retention from Firebase or GA4 — supplemented by A/B tests of two value propositions and an in-app rating prompt. Every one of these is a countable metric, which is what distinguishes quantitative from qualitative feedback.

Marking scheme: 1 M for naming a targeted digital channel and mechanism, 1 M for naming the numeric metrics that constitute the quantitative feedback.

10. List any four online marketing tools that can be useful for beginners in the field of marketing. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.8 — 2 M]

(1) **Google Analytics** — website traffic, behaviour and conversion measurement.
(2) **Google Keyword Planner** or **Google Trends** — keyword demand and topic research.
(3) **Canva** — creative and social media design without a designer.
(4) **Mailchimp** — e-mail list management, campaigns and automation.

Also acceptable: Hootsuite or Buffer for scheduling, SEMrush or Ubersuggest for SEO, Google Search Console, Meta Business Suite, Hotjar.

Marking scheme: Any four, half a mark each.

11. Differentiate between marketplace and market space. [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M]

Marketplace is a physical or definite location at which buyers and sellers meet to exchange goods and services — a shop, a mall, a showroom, a mandi. **Market space** is the virtual or conceptual environment in which commercial value is created and exchanged through digital networks — Amazon, an app, an online store — with no physical location, no fixed hours and no geographic limit. In short: marketplace is physical, market space is digital.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

12. What is the mantra of marketing? [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 2 M]

Create, Communicate and Deliver Value to a Target market at a Profit. It compresses the whole discipline into one line: value must first be created in the offering, then communicated so the market knows of it, then delivered so the promise is kept — all aimed at a chosen target market and all done profitably, since value delivered at a loss is not marketing but charity.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the mantra itself, 1 M for a brief expansion of what it means.

13. Define affiliate marketing and give an example. [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 2 M]

Affiliate marketing is a performance-based model in which a business rewards external partners — affiliates — with a commission for each visitor, lead or sale their own promotional efforts deliver through a tracked link. The advertiser pays only for results, which makes the risk almost entirely the affiliate's. **Example:** Amazon Associates, where a blogger or YouTuber earns a percentage of every purchase made through their referral link.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for a correct named example.

14. What is the first step of content marketing? [CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M]

Defining the goals and identifying the target audience. Everything downstream — topic selection, format, tone, channel and the metric used to judge success — depends on knowing what the content is meant to achieve and who it is meant to reach, so content created before this step is decided is content produced without a standard to be judged against.

Marking scheme: 1 M for goal setting and audience identification, 1 M for why it comes first.

15. Mention any two core concepts of marketing. [CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 2 M]

Needs, wants and demands — a need is a basic requirement, a want is the culturally shaped form that need takes, and a demand is a want backed by the ability to pay. **Value and satisfaction** — the customer's judgement of the benefits received against the total cost paid, which determines whether they buy again. Also acceptable: exchange and transactions; markets; segmentation and targeting; the offering and the brand.

Marking scheme: 1 M each, with a phrase of explanation.

16. List any two principles of digital marketing. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

Know your customers — build the strategy around a researched buyer persona rather than around the product. **Know how you are doing** — measure continuously, because the defining property of digital marketing is that almost everything is trackable and therefore improvable. Also acceptable from the five pillars: know your business; know the competition; know what you want to achieve. Or, from the principle set: measurability, interactivity, personalisation, permission-based targeting.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

17. Differentiate between market segmentation and marketing mix. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

Market segmentation is the process of dividing a large heterogeneous market into smaller homogeneous groups of buyers with similar needs, using geographic, demographic, psychographic and behavioural bases, so that each group can be served distinctly. **Marketing mix** is the set of controllable tactical tools — Product, Price, Place and Promotion — blended to produce the desired response from a chosen segment. In one line: segmentation decides *whom* to serve; the marketing mix decides *how* to serve them.

Marking scheme: 1 M each. The "whom against how" contrast secures the second mark.

Part B — Eight, Six and Ten-Mark Questions

1. Explain any four key principles of digital marketing. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q2a — 8 M]

(1) **Customer-centricity.** Digital marketing is built outward from a documented buyer persona — the customer's needs, context, objections and journey — rather than inward from product features. Every channel, message and offer is chosen because it fits where that person already is.

(2) **Measurability and data-driven decisions.** Almost every interaction is trackable, so decisions are made on analytics and KPIs rather than opinion. Budget follows evidence: a channel that does not show a return in the data is cut.

(3) **Segmentation and personalisation.** The right message reaches the right person at the right moment, using demographic, behavioural and lifecycle data. Relevance, not volume, is what earns response.

(4) **Value-first content.** Attention is earned by being useful — solving a problem, answering a question, entertaining — rather than bought by interruption. Content built this way keeps working long after the campaign ends.

(5) **Integration and consistency across channels.** Search, social, e-mail, mobile and the website carry one brand voice and one promise, so the customer experiences a single journey rather than disconnected campaigns.

(6) **Continuous testing and optimisation.** A/B testing, iteration and rapid feedback loops mean nothing is final; the campaign that runs in week eight is measurably better than the one launched in week one.

(7) **Two-way engagement.** Digital media is a conversation — comments, reviews, DMs and communities — so listening and responding are part of the marketing, not an afterthought handled by support.

(8) **Cost-efficiency and scalability.** Precise targeting removes wasted impressions, and a campaign that works can be scaled up or geographically extended in hours rather than quarters.

Marking scheme: Any four principles, 2 M each: 1 M for correctly naming the principle, 1 M for explaining it. Do not write eight thin points — the question asks for four, explained.

2. Explain any four digital marketing channels to spread awareness about a new product. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q2b — 8 M]

(1) **Search engine marketing.** Paid search captures demand immediately — bidding on category and competitor keywords puts the new product in front of people already looking for that solution — while SEO builds the durable organic visibility that carries awareness after the launch budget stops.

(2) **Social media marketing.** Organic posts, Reels and Stories on Instagram, Facebook, YouTube and LinkedIn, amplified by paid reach and video-view campaigns, deliver mass awareness cheaply and allow precise interest and lookalike targeting for a product with no existing customer base.

(3) **Content marketing.** Blog articles, explainer and demonstration videos, infographics, webinars and buying guides teach the market what the product is for. For a genuinely new category this is essential — people cannot search for something they have no name for.

(4) **E-mail marketing.** An announcement sequence to the existing opt-in list is the cheapest awareness channel available and reaches the warmest audience: existing customers who already trust the brand and are most likely to try and to refer.

(5) **Influencer marketing.** Creators with an established, trusting niche audience lend

credibility a new brand has not yet earned, and produce demonstration content at a fraction of studio cost.

(6) **Display, video and programmatic advertising.** Banner, YouTube pre-roll and OTT placements build broad reach and visual recall, and support retargeting of everyone who visited the launch page.

(7) **Affiliate and marketplace marketing.** Partners and marketplace listings promote on a pay-per-result basis, giving reach with almost no upfront risk.

(8) **Mobile marketing.** App push notifications, SMS and WhatsApp broadcasts, in-app advertising and QR codes on packaging reach the customer on the device they actually use.

Marking scheme: Any four channels, 2 M each: 1 M for naming and describing the channel, 1 M for showing specifically how it creates awareness for a *new* product.

3. Discuss how website analysis contributes to enhanced customer experience and conversion optimization. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2a — 8 M]

Website analysis is the systematic evaluation of a site's traffic, technical health, content performance, usability and conversion paths, using tools such as GA4, Google Search Console, PageSpeed Insights, Hotjar or Microsoft Clarity, and SEMrush Site Audit.

Contribution to customer experience

(1) **It locates friction.** Exit-rate and funnel reports name the exact pages where visitors give up, turning a vague complaint that "the site is confusing" into a specific page to fix.

(2) **It shows behaviour, not just numbers.** Heatmaps and session recordings expose dead clicks, rage clicks, ignored navigation and abandoned form fields — the causes behind the exit statistics.

(3) **It fixes performance.** Page-speed and Core Web Vitals analysis identifies slow-loading pages, the single most common destroyer of experience on mobile data connections.

(4) **It enforces device reality.** Device, browser and screen-size reports reveal that most traffic is mobile and force responsive, mobile-first correction rather than desktop-led design.

(5) **It surfaces unmet needs.** On-site search term reports say, in the customer's own words, what they came for and could not find — a direct content and navigation backlog.

Contribution to conversion optimisation

(1) **It quantifies leakage.** Funnel visualisation gives the drop-off percentage at each step — product view, add to cart, checkout, payment — so effort goes where the loss is largest, not where opinion says.

(2) **It segments quality of traffic.** Conversion rate by source, campaign, device and geography shows which channels bring buyers rather than visitors, redirecting budget to what converts.

(3) **It enables controlled testing.** Analysis produces hypotheses that A/B and multivariate tests then prove or disprove — headline, CTA wording and placement, form length, layout, imagery, pricing display.

(4) **It closes the loop.** Conversion rate, average order value, cost per acquisition and revenue per visitor are re-measured after each change, so improvement is demonstrated rather than assumed.

Conclusion. Website analysis replaces opinion-driven design with evidence-driven design. The same body of data serves both goals at once: removing friction raises satisfaction, and satisfaction is what a conversion actually is — so lower bounce, higher engagement, higher conversion rate and higher lifetime value are outcomes of one activity, not two.

Marking scheme: 2 M for defining website analysis and naming the tools, 3 M for the customer-experience contributions, 3 M for the conversion contributions. A concluding line linking the two earns the benefit of the doubt on the last mark.

6. Explain how content research tools help marketers discover new opportunities and gain a competitive edge. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q2b — 8 M]

Content research tools are the software used to find out what an audience is searching for, what competitors already rank for, and what is gaining traction — BuzzSumo, SEMrush and Ahrefs content-gap reports, Google Trends, Google Keyword Planner, AnswerThePublic, Google Search Console, and social listening platforms such as Brandwatch or Sprout Social.

(1) **Topic and demand discovery.** Trend and volume data show which subjects are rising, which are seasonal and which are already saturated, so the brand publishes on an emerging topic *before* the market crowds into it. Being early is itself the advantage.
(2) **Keyword and intent research.** The tools reveal long-tail, low-difficulty keywords that carry real search volume and clear buying intent — the queries a smaller brand can realistically win — and allow each keyword to be mapped to a funnel stage.
(3) **Content-gap analysis.** Comparing the brand's ranking keywords against three or four competitors produces an explicit list of topics the competitors earn traffic from and the brand does not. That list is a prioritised editorial backlog, generated from data rather than brainstorming.
(4) **Competitor benchmarking.** The tools show which of a competitor's pages attract the most traffic, shares and backlinks, at what publishing cadence and in which formats — so their proven winners inform strategy instead of guesswork.
(5) **Audience question mining.** AnswerThePublic, Search Console query reports, on-site search logs, Reddit and Quora give the exact phrasing customers use for their problems, which makes copy resonate and captures voice and conversational search.
(6) **Format and channel insight.** Engagement data shows whether a topic performs as short video, long-form guide, listicle or infographic, and on which platform — preventing effort spent producing the right subject in the wrong form.
(7) **Distribution and influencer discovery.** The tools identify who amplifies content in the niche and which publications link to it, so promotion is planned alongside creation rather than after it.
(8) **Performance measurement and refresh.** Declining pages are flagged for updating, keyword cannibalisation between two of the brand's own pages is detected, and the next cycle's plan is corrected by the last cycle's results.

Competitive edge. Taken together these give faster time-to-market on emerging topics, better return on every keyword targeted, far less wasted production effort, an editorial calendar that can be defended with evidence, and an organic visibility position that competitors cannot buy their way past quickly.

Marking scheme: 1 M for naming the tools, 6 M for six distinct ways they create opportunity (1 M each), 1 M for an explicit statement of the resulting competitive edge.

7. What is digital marketing? Explain the differences between traditional marketing and digital marketing. Highlight any five key differences. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q2a — 8 M]

Digital marketing is the promotion of products, services and brands through digital channels and electronic devices — search engines, websites, social media, e-mail, mobile applications and display networks — using data to target, personalise and measure every interaction.

(1) **Direction of communication.** Traditional marketing is one-way broadcast: the brand speaks and the audience listens. Digital marketing is two-way: comments, reviews, DMs

and shares make the audience a participant. *Example:* a newspaper advertisement cannot be replied to; an Instagram post is answered within minutes.

(2) **Targeting precision.** Traditional targets a broad demographic inferred from the medium — everyone who reads that paper. Digital targets by age, location, interest, behaviour, past purchase and lookalike modelling. *Example:* a hoarding is seen by every passer-by; a Meta campaign reaches only women aged 25–34 in three postcodes.

(3) **Measurability.** Traditional results are estimated through surveys and circulation figures, usually after the campaign. Digital results — impressions, clicks, conversions, revenue, ROAS — are visible in real time and attributable to the individual advertisement.

(4) **Cost and accessibility.** Traditional demands large fixed expenditure that excludes small firms. Digital can start at a few hundred rupees a day and scale with results, which puts a startup and a multinational in the same auction.

(5) **Speed and flexibility of change.** A printed or televised campaign is fixed once released; a digital campaign's budget, creative, audience and landing page can be changed mid-flight in response to the data.

(6) **Reach.** Traditional reach is geographically bounded by the medium; digital reach is global and continuous, available at any hour.

(7) **Personalisation.** Traditional delivers one identical message to everyone. Digital delivers dynamically different content, offers and recommendations to each segment or individual.

Marking scheme: 2 M for defining digital marketing, 5 M for five clear differences at 1 M each with an example, 1 M for presentation — a comparison table earns this easily. The question says "any five", so five differences properly explained beat seven listed thinly.

8. Describe the key principles of digital marketing and explain how they differ from traditional marketing approaches. Provide examples to illustrate your points. [CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

The principles — the five pillars first, then the operating principles.

(1) **Know your business.** Be clear about the offering, the value proposition and the commercial objective before choosing a channel. Where traditional marketing began with a media plan, digital begins with a measurement plan.

(2) **Know the competition.** Competitive research is continuous and largely public — their keywords, ads, content and backlinks are all observable through SEMrush or the Meta Ad Library, which had no traditional equivalent.

(3) **Know your customers.** Strategy is built on a researched buyer persona drawn from analytics and social insight, not on the broad demographic that a newspaper's readership implied.

(4) **Know what you want to achieve.** Objectives are set as SMART, channel-level KPIs — cost per lead, ROAS — rather than as an aspiration such as "increase brand awareness".

(5) **Know how you are doing.** Continuous measurement and correction replace the post-campaign review. *Example:* a Google Ads campaign whose budget shifts daily towards the better-converting keyword.

(6) **Measurability.** Every impression, click and conversion is countable and attributable, so spend is defended with evidence. *Traditional contrast:* a television spot's effect is inferred from a brand-lift survey weeks later.

(7) **Interactivity and two-way engagement.** The audience replies, reviews and creates content. *Example:* a brand answering complaints on X within the hour — impossible in print.

(8) **Personalisation.** Content adapts to the individual. *Example:* Netflix's per-user home screen and Amazon's "customers also bought", against one identical billboard for all.

(9) **Permission-based targeting.** Digital largely operates on consent — opt-in lists, notifi-

cation permissions, cookie consent — where traditional simply interrupted.

(10) **Iteration and agility.** Continuous A/B testing means the campaign improves while it runs; a printed campaign cannot be edited after it ships.

(11) **Cost-efficiency and scalability.** Low entry cost, precise targeting and instant scaling replace large fixed media buys.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 5 M for the principles named and explained and 5 M for the contrast with traditional marketing plus examples. The question has three demands — describe, differentiate, exemplify — and marks are distributed across all three, so an answer with no examples caps at about two-thirds.

9. Identify and explain the various entities that can be marketed, providing relevant examples for each category. [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M]

Marketing applies to ten classes of entity, not merely to physical products.

(1) **Goods** — tangible physical products, the largest share of most economies' production and marketing effort. *Example:* cars, mobile phones, packaged food.

(2) **Services** — intangible, perishable, inseparable offerings produced and consumed simultaneously. *Example:* airlines, banking, hotels, salons, software as a service.

(3) **Experiences** — staged and orchestrated combinations of goods and services sold for the experience itself. *Example:* Disneyland, an adventure trek, a music festival.

(4) **Events** — time-bound occasions marketed to attendees, sponsors and broadcasters. *Example:* the Olympics, the IPL, a trade fair.

(5) **Persons** — celebrity, professional and personal branding. *Example:* sportspersons, actors, musicians and consultants building a marketable public identity.

(6) **Places** — cities, states and countries marketed for tourism, residence and investment. *Example:* "Incredible India", Dubai's tourism campaigns, state investor summits.

(7) **Properties** — intangible rights of ownership in real estate or financial assets. *Example:* apartments, land, shares, mutual funds.

(8) **Organizations** — institutions marketing their own image and reputation to build preference and attract talent. *Example:* a university, a hospital, a corporate employer brand.

(9) **Information** — knowledge produced, packaged and sold. *Example:* textbooks, market research reports, online courses, newspapers.

(10) **Ideas** — causes, behaviours and social propositions promoted for adoption, which is the domain of social marketing. *Example:* "Swachh Bharat", anti-smoking and road-safety campaigns, organ donation.

Marking scheme: 10 M — ten entities at 1 M each, every one requiring both the explanation and a relevant example. Naming the ten without examples earns about half, since the question explicitly asks for examples for each category.

10. How have the 4Ps of marketing evolved in the digital era? Provide examples of companies effectively leveraging digital strategies for each element. [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M]

(1) **Product — from standardised to digital, personalised and continuously updated.** Products are now often intangible, delivered as software and improved after purchase; mass customisation replaces mass production, and user data feeds the next version. *Example:* Spotify, whose Discover Weekly playlist is a product generated individually for each listener from their own listening data; Tesla, which improves a car already sold through over-the-air updates.

(2) **Price — from fixed printed price lists to dynamic, transparent and personalised pricing.** Prices adjust algorithmically to demand, competitor movement, inventory and user behaviour, while comparison sites make the whole market's pricing visible to the buyer, compressing margins and forcing value-based rather than cost-plus pricing. Subscription

and freemium models replace one-time purchase. *Example:* Amazon, which reprices millions of items many times a day; Uber's surge pricing; Netflix's tiered subscription.

(3) **Place — from physical distribution to omnichannel and direct digital delivery.** The shelf is replaced by the search result, the app and the marketplace listing; intermediaries are disintermediated as brands sell direct; and the customer expects to move between channels without losing continuity. *Example:* Nike's direct-to-consumer app and website with click-and-collect linking online and store; Zara's integrated inventory allowing online return in a physical shop.

(4) **Promotion — from interruptive broadcast to targeted, interactive and measurable engagement.** Promotion becomes content, community and conversation — SEO, social, influencer, e-mail and personalised advertising — all of it measurable and adjustable in flight. *Example:* Coca-Cola's "Share a Coke", which converted packaging into user-generated social content; Zomato's social media voice, which functions as continuous low-cost promotion.

The extended mix. Digital conditions have also promoted three further Ps to first-class status — **People** (community managers, reviewers and influencers who now speak for the brand), **Process** (frictionless checkout, one-click ordering, returns) and **Physical evidence** (website design, reviews, ratings and trust signals, which are the only "premises" an online buyer ever sees).

Marking scheme: 10 M. 2 M for each of the four Ps — 1 M for the nature of the evolution and 1 M for a named company example — and 2 M for a broader observation such as the extended 7 Ps or a concluding synthesis. Examples are explicitly demanded and carry half the marks.

11. A retail company using newspaper ads, billboards and TV commercials is considering a shift to digital marketing. Compare the benefits and limitations of both approaches and suggest a strategy for transitioning. [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M]

Traditional marketing — benefits: very wide mass reach through television and press; high perceived credibility and trust, particularly among older audiences; strong local impact from hoardings and regional press; excellent for broad brand building; and no dependence on the audience owning a device or a connection.

Traditional marketing — limitations: expensive, with a high fixed entry cost; results are difficult to measure and attribute; targeting is coarse; communication is one-way; production and booking lead times are long, so nothing can be corrected once released.

Digital marketing — benefits: far lower entry cost and spend that scales with results; precise targeting by demography, interest, behaviour and location; complete measurability and attribution; two-way interaction and community; global and round-the-clock reach; rapid A/B testing and mid-flight correction; and rich remarketing to people who have already shown interest.

Digital marketing — limitations: requires technical skill and tooling; intense competition and rising auction costs; privacy regulation and consent constraints; dependence on internet access, which limits rural and older segments; platform dependence and algorithm volatility; and exposure to public negative feedback and ad fraud.

Transition strategy

(1) **Audit and set objectives.** Establish the current cost per customer from traditional spend as the baseline, and set SMART digital objectives against it.

(2) **Build the digital foundation first.** A responsive website with analytics, a Google Business Profile, and social profiles — there is no point advertising to a destination that does not exist.

(3) **Instrument measurement before spending.** GA4, conversion tracking and a CRM, so the first rupee spent is already measurable.

(4) **Research the audience and build personas** from existing customer data and analytics rather than assumption.
(5) **Run a small pilot in parallel, not a switch.** Keep traditional running and divert 10–20% of budget into two digital channels for a quarter, so the comparison is evidence rather than faith.
(6) **Start with high-intent channels.** Search advertising and local SEO capture demand the existing brand already generates, which produces the quickest demonstrable return and secures internal support.
(7) **Add content and social** to build the owned audience that lowers paid dependence over time.
(8) **Train or hire, and choose tooling.** The commonest cause of failed transition is capability, not budget.
(9) **Integrate the two rather than opposing them.** Put QR codes and short URLs on print and hoardings, run television and search together around the same campaign, and measure the offline-to-online lift.
(10) **Review, reallocate and scale.** Compare cost per acquisition channel by channel each quarter and move budget progressively towards what pays, retaining traditional media only where it still outperforms.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 4 M for the comparison — benefits and limitations of both, best set out as a table — and 6 M for a phased, sensible transition strategy. An abrupt "stop traditional and go digital" recommendation loses marks; the graded, measured, parallel-run approach is what the scheme rewards.

12. Your company has a limited marketing budget and must choose between SEO, Pay Per Click and Social Media Marketing to promote a new high-tech gadget aimed at young professionals. Which channel(s) would you prioritise and why? Justify with specific examples. [CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

Compare the three against the situation.

(1) **SEO.** Free per click and compounding, with high buyer intent, but slow — three to six months to rank — and dependent on existing search demand.
(2) **PPC.** Instant visibility, precise control, and captures intent at the moment of search, but costs money per click continuously and stops dead when the budget stops.
(3) **SMM.** Strong for visual demonstration, discovery and virality among a young audience, with precise interest targeting and a low cost per thousand impressions, but low immediate intent — nobody opened Instagram to buy a gadget.

The decisive argument. A brand-new gadget has a demand problem before it has a conversion problem: nobody is searching for a product category they do not yet know exists. SEO harvests existing demand and PPC harvests existing search intent — so neither can carry a launch on its own. Demand must first be *created*, and that is what social does.

Recommendation — a weighted split, not a single channel.

(1) **Social media marketing — about 50% of budget.** Instagram and YouTube short-form demonstration video, precisely targeted at young professionals by interest and job title, plus micro-influencer unboxings, which supply the credibility a new brand lacks. *Example:* boAt built an entire audio brand in India primarily through social and influencer marketing rather than search.
(2) **PPC — about 35%.** Bid on category and competitor keywords to capture the buyer who is comparison-shopping — "best noise cancelling earbuds under 5000" — and, critically, run retargeting against everyone the social campaign reached, which is where most of the conversion will actually occur. *Example:* bidding on a competitor's brand name to appear beside it.

(3) **SEO — about 15% now, rising later.** Begin immediately because it is slow: publish comparison and buying-guide content, optimise the product pages, and build the organic asset that will reduce paid dependence in months six to twelve. *Example:* a "best earbuds for commuting" guide that keeps earning traffic long after the launch campaign ends.
(4) **The sequencing logic.** Social creates awareness → PPC and retargeting convert the aware → SEO progressively harvests the demand the first two created, lowering cost per acquisition over time.
(5) **Measurement and reallocation.** Judge each channel on cost per acquisition and ROAS rather than on clicks, review fortnightly, and shift budget as the launch matures — the correct split at month one is not the correct split at month nine.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 3 M for comparing the three channels on the right criteria (speed, cost model, intent, longevity), 5 M for a justified recommendation with a clear reason tied to *this* product and audience, and 2 M for specific examples. The answer must commit to a priority — a balanced description of all three with no decision loses the justification marks.

4. A newly launched e-commerce company wants to build brand awareness through content marketing. Suggest a step-by-step strategy, including content types and distribution channels. [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025 — 10 M]

(1) **Goal setting.** Define what awareness means numerically — for example branded search volume, reach and new-visitor sessions — and set SMART targets against a baseline.
(2) **Audience mapping.** Build buyer personas from market research, competitor audiences and early analytics; map their questions to the awareness, consideration and decision stages.
(3) **Content ideation and planning.** Keyword and topic research, content-gap analysis against competitors, and an editorial calendar fixing topic, format, owner, channel and publication date.
(4) **Content creation.** Produce to a defined quality standard — original, useful, accurate, on-brand — with a house style guide so output is consistent across writers.
(5) **Content types.** Blog articles and buying guides for search; short-form video and Reels for discovery; infographics for shareability; podcasts and webinars for depth and authority; e-books and checklists as gated lead magnets; and user-generated content and reviews for social proof.
(6) **Distribution — owned media.** The website and blog, the e-mail list, the app and the brand's own social channels: no media cost, full control, and the audience that compounds.
(7) **Distribution — earned media.** SEO rankings, press coverage, guest posts, community and forum participation, shares and word of mouth: the most credible and the least controllable.
(8) **Distribution — paid media.** Promoted posts, search and display advertising, and influencer partnerships used to give the best-performing organic content additional reach rather than to prop up weak content.
(9) **Amplification and repurposing.** Turn one substantial asset into many — a webinar becomes a blog post, five Reels, an infographic and an e-mail — and re-promote proven performers instead of always creating new.
(10) **Evaluation and improvement.** Track reach and impressions, engagement rate, bounce rate, time on page, backlinks earned, branded search lift, leads and conversion; review monthly, cut formats that do not perform, refresh decaying content and feed the findings into the next quarter's calendar.

Marking scheme: 10 M — ten sequenced steps at 1 M each. The question names three things that must appear explicitly: the step-by-step structure, the content types, and the distribution channels grouped as owned, earned and paid. Missing any one of the three costs its marks however good the rest is.

5. **A newly launched health and wellness startup offering organic lifestyle products aims to build brand awareness through content marketing. Design a step-by-step content marketing strategy, outlining content formats, content themes, distribution platforms (owned, earned, paid) and metrics for performance evaluation.** [CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M]

This question asks the same method as the previous one but names the four deliverables that must appear. Answer under those four headings after a short goal-and-audience preamble.

Step 1 — Goals. Increase branded search volume by 200% and reach 100,000 relevant users in six months; build an e-mail list of 10,000 opted-in subscribers as the owned asset.

Step 2 — Audience. Health-conscious urban adults aged 25–45, early-stage wellness adopters and new parents, who distrust unsubstantiated health claims and respond to evidence, transparency and visible sourcing.

(1) **Content formats.** Long-form blog articles and buying guides for search visibility; short-form video and Reels showing routines, recipes and product use; infographics on nutrition and ingredient comparisons; podcasts and expert interviews with nutritionists and doctors for authority; downloadable e-books, meal plans and habit trackers as gated lead magnets; and customer transformation stories and user-generated content for social proof.

(2) **Content themes.** Education — what organic certification actually means, how to read an ingredient label; Lifestyle — routines, recipes, sleep, stress and fitness integration; Trust and transparency — farm and supply-chain stories, certifications, third-party test results; Problem-solving — content mapped to specific concerns such as gut health or immunity; Community — challenges, testimonials and expert Q&A.

(3) **Owned distribution.** Website and SEO-optimised blog; e-mail newsletter and nurture sequences; Instagram, YouTube and WhatsApp channels; packaging inserts carrying QR codes to recipe content.

(4) **Earned distribution.** Organic search rankings; wellness and parenting community participation; PR in health publications; expert and dietitian endorsements; customer reviews and organic shares.

(5) **Paid distribution.** Meta and YouTube promotion of the best-performing organic content; search advertising on high-intent commercial keywords; micro-influencer partnerships with genuine wellness practitioners rather than general lifestyle creators.

(6) **Metrics — reach and visibility.** Impressions, reach, new users, organic sessions, keyword rankings, branded search volume.

(7) **Metrics — engagement.** Engagement rate, average engagement time, scroll depth, video completion rate, shares and saves.

(8) **Metrics — conversion and value.** Lead-magnet downloads, e-mail sign-up rate, conversion rate, cost per lead, revenue attributed to content, and customer lifetime value by acquisition content.

(9) **Governance and compliance.** Health claims must be substantiated and legally compliant; every claim needs a source, and an expert review step belongs in the workflow. This is what distinguishes a wellness content strategy from a generic one.

(10) **Review cycle.** Monthly performance review against the metrics above, quarterly content-gap re-analysis and refresh of decaying pages, with budget shifted towards the formats and themes that convert.

Marking scheme: 10 M. The scheme follows the four named deliverables: roughly 2 M each for formats, themes, distribution across owned/earned/paid, and metrics, plus 2 M for the step structure and goal/audience framing. Answer under the four headings the question gives — examiners mark against the words in the question.

6. Imagine you are a digital marketing strategist at GreenTech Innovations, launching a line of eco-friendly kitchen appliances called "EcoChef". Design a comprehensive content marketing strategy, including specific goals, types of content, distribution channels and methods of engagement. [CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

(1) **Goals.** 50,000 website visits and 5,000 e-mail subscribers in the first six months; 1,000 pre-orders at launch; and top-three rankings for "energy efficient kitchen appliances" within a year — each SMART and each measurable in GA4.

(2) **Audience.** Environmentally conscious urban homeowners aged 28–45 with above-median income; secondary audiences are new homeowners furnishing a kitchen and interior designers who specify appliances. Their decisive question is whether "eco" costs more than it saves.

(3) **Positioning and content angle.** Lead with quantified savings — units of electricity and rupees saved per year — rather than with virtue. The strongest content asset is therefore a *savings calculator*, not a blog post.

(4) **Content types — educational.** Blog guides on cutting kitchen energy use, explainers on energy ratings, and comparison articles against conventional appliances.

(5) **Content types — demonstrative.** Product demonstration and installation videos, a YouTube series on sustainable cooking, and before-and-after electricity-bill case studies from real customers.

(6) **Content types — interactive and gated.** The energy-savings calculator, a downloadable "sustainable kitchen" e-book, and a kitchen carbon-footprint quiz — all capturing e-mail addresses.

(7) **Distribution — owned.** Website and SEO blog, e-mail nurture sequences, YouTube channel, Instagram and Pinterest (both strongly visual and strongly kitchen-relevant).

(8) **Distribution — earned and paid.** Earned: organic search, sustainability and home-improvement press, green certifications, customer reviews. Paid: search advertising on high-intent appliance keywords, YouTube pre-roll on cooking content, and partnerships with sustainability and home-design creators.

(9) **Methods of engagement.** An "EcoChef Challenge" inviting users to post their reduced bills with a branded hashtag; live cooking sessions with chefs; a referral programme; responsive community management; a loyalty scheme rewarding reviews and repeat purchase; and user-generated kitchen photographs featured on the brand's channels.

(10) **Measurement and iteration.** Track traffic, keyword rankings, engagement rate, calculator completions, e-mail sign-ups, pre-orders, cost per acquisition and content-attributed revenue; review monthly; double down on the formats that convert and retire those that do not.

Marking scheme: 10 M. The question names four deliverables — goals, content types, distribution channels, engagement methods — so roughly 2–3 M each with the remainder for measurement. The answer must be specific to EcoChef; a generic content strategy with the brand name inserted twice will not earn the application marks.

7. Identify and explain at least five key metrics used to measure the impact and performance of content marketing. How can these metrics influence future content strategies? [CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

Reach and visibility metrics

(1) **Traffic — users, sessions and pageviews by piece.** Measures how many people the content reached and through which channel. *Influence on strategy:* the topics and formats that consistently draw traffic define the next quarter's calendar; those that draw none are retired rather than repeated.

(2) **Organic search performance — impressions, rankings, click-through rate from the SERP.** Measures durable discoverability. *Influence:* pages with high impressions but

low CTR need better titles and meta descriptions, not more content — a cheap, high-return correction that only this metric reveals.

Resonance metrics

(1) **Engagement rate — shares, saves, comments, likes, average engagement time.** Measures whether the content mattered to those it reached. *Influence:* high shares and saves identify the formats worth repurposing and worth promoting with paid budget.
(2) **Scroll depth and video completion rate.** Measures whether the content held attention to the end. *Influence:* consistent drop-off at 30% indicates the piece is too long or front-loaded with preamble, which changes how the next piece is structured.

Friction metrics

(1) **Bounce rate and exit rate by page.** Measures mismatch between the expectation that brought the visitor and what the page delivered. *Influence:* a high bounce rate on pages arriving from one particular channel means the content and the channel are mismatched, so either the targeting or the piece must change.

Business-outcome metrics

(1) **Lead generation — downloads, sign-ups, enquiries per piece.** Measures whether content produces a contactable prospect. *Influence:* it identifies which topics deserve a gated asset built around them.
(2) **Conversion rate and assisted conversions.** Measures content's contribution to revenue, including pieces that never get last-click credit. *Influence:* prevents the classic mistake of killing top-of-funnel content that assists many conversions but closes few.
(3) **Content ROI — revenue attributed against production and promotion cost.** Measures whether the programme pays. *Influence:* it settles budget arguments and sets the ceiling on what a piece of content is worth producing.
(4) **Backlinks and brand mentions earned.** Measures authority accumulated. *Influence:* identifies which content formats — usually original data and research — are worth the disproportionate effort they cost.

How metrics shape strategy overall. Together they convert content from a creative activity into a managed portfolio: double down on proven topics and formats, fix rather than replace underperforming pages, refresh decaying content, reallocate promotion budget to what earns it, and stop producing what the data shows nobody reads — so each cycle is measurably better informed than the last.

Marking scheme: 10 M. "At least five" means five is the floor: roughly 5–6 M for the metrics named and explained and 4–5 M for the second half — how each reading changes the next content decision. The second half is the part candidates routinely omit, and it carries close to half the marks.

6. List and explain various pricing strategies used in marketing management with suitable examples. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q2b — 8 M]

(1) **Cost-plus pricing.** Add a fixed percentage margin to unit cost. Simple and safe, but ignores demand and competition. *Example:* most retail and contract manufacturing.
(2) **Value-based pricing.** Price on the customer's perceived value rather than on cost — the most profitable approach where value can be demonstrated. *Example:* Apple, whose prices reflect brand and ecosystem value, not the bill of materials.
(3) **Penetration pricing.** Launch low to capture share quickly, then raise. *Example:* Jio's free introductory offer, and most streaming services' launch pricing in India.
(4) **Price skimming.** Launch high to harvest early adopters, then lower progressively. *Example:* new smartphone and console launches.

(5) **Competitive or going-rate pricing.** Set price at, above or below the prevailing market rate. *Example:* fuel retailers and airline fares on competitive routes.
(6) **Psychological pricing.** Exploit perception — Rs. 999 rather than Rs. 1,000, or a high anchor price shown struck through. *Example:* almost all e-commerce listing prices.
(7) **Bundle pricing.** Sell several items together below the sum of their individual prices, raising average order value and clearing slower stock. *Example:* fast-food combo meals, software suites.
(8) **Freemium and subscription pricing.** Give a basic tier free and charge for the premium tier, or charge recurrently for access rather than once for ownership. *Example:* Spotify, Zoom, Netflix.
(9) **Dynamic pricing.** Adjust algorithmically to demand, time, inventory and user behaviour. *Example:* Uber surge pricing, airline seat pricing, Amazon's continuous repricing.
(10) **Promotional and loss-leader pricing.** Temporary discounts, or selling one item at or below cost to draw traffic that buys other items. *Example:* festival sales; supermarket staples priced at cost.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly eight strategies at 1 M each, every one requiring both an explanation and an example. Note that pricing sits slightly outside the literal Unit I descriptor wording but has been examined under it, so it is worth knowing rather than assuming it cannot be asked.

7. A travel agency specializing in adventure tourism wants to improve its targeted marketing. How should they create a buyer persona, and what factors — demographics, interests, online behaviour — should they consider? [CIE-I, 3 Apr 2025; CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M]

Steps to create the persona

(1) **Collect data from several sources** — customer surveys and interviews, booking records, website analytics, social media insights and conversations with the sales team, who know the objections that never reach a form.
(2) **Segment by shared traits** into a small number of distinct groups, then choose the two or three worth building personas for — a persona per customer is not a persona at all.
(3) **Identify goals and pain points** for each group: what they are trying to achieve by travelling, and what stops them booking.
(4) **Build the profile** with a name, photograph, background, quote, goals, objections, preferred channels and buying triggers, so the whole team can picture one person rather than a spreadsheet row.
(5) **Validate and update** against actual booking data and feedback, and revise as the market shifts — a persona written once and never revisited becomes fiction within two seasons.

Factors to consider

(1) **Demographics.** Age roughly 20–40, gender split, income band, occupation — typically salaried urban professionals and students — education, city and marital status, since family stage strongly determines the kind of trip that is even possible.
(2) **Psychographics and interests.** Trekking, scuba diving, skydiving, camping and cycling; fitness and outdoor lifestyle; attitude to risk; preference for authentic experience over luxury; environmental consciousness; and the values that make adventure travel attractive in the first place.
(3) **Online behaviour.** Active on Instagram, YouTube and travel blogs; searches such as "best trekking places in India" and "budget adventure trips"; consumes video and reviews before deciding; follows travel influencers; researches on mobile and often books on mobile too.
(4) **Travel behaviour.** Frequency of travel, budget against premium preference, solo against

group, domestic against international, planning lead time, and preferred season — all of which are already recorded in the agency's own booking data.

(5) **Pain points and objections.** Safety and equipment concerns, doubts about guide credentials and insurance, budget constraints, lack of reliable information, fitness anxiety, and distrust of agencies after hidden costs. These matter most, because the marketing that converts is the marketing that answers them.

Example persona. **"Adventure Arun"**, 28, IT professional in Bengaluru, unmarried, income Rs. 12 lakh a year. Interests: trekking, camping, photography. Follows travel creators on Instagram and YouTube; plans two long weekends and one major trek a year; books online, on his phone, usually four to six weeks ahead. Goal: unique, physically demanding experiences he can share. Pain points: safety and guide credibility, and uncertainty about what the quoted price actually includes.

How the persona is used. It sets ad targeting parameters, chooses Instagram and YouTube over print, dictates that safety credentials and all-inclusive pricing appear prominently on landing pages, and determines that content should be video-led rather than text-led.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 4 M for the steps to create a persona, 4–5 M for the factors grouped as demographics, psychographics, online behaviour, travel behaviour and pain points, and 1–2 M for a worked example persona. The example is what demonstrates the method has been understood rather than memorised.

UNIT 2

Social Media Marketing and Search Engine Optimization

Syllabus: Social Media Marketing — introduction; major platforms for marketing; developing data-driven audience and campaign insights; social media for business; creation and optimisation of social media campaigns. Search Engine Optimization — fundamentals; keywords and the SEO content plan; SEO and business objectives; writing SEO content; on-site and off-site SEO; optimising organic search ranking.

In the examination: Part B Questions 3 and 4 are set from this unit as an internal-choice pair; one of the two must be answered in full. Both papers paired one social media question with one SEO question in each of Q3 and Q4, so neither half of the unit can be left out.

Part A — Two-Mark Questions

1. What is the primary goal of social media marketing? [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.3 — 2 M]

The primary goal is to build brand awareness and engage a defined target audience on social platforms so as to build relationships that drive profitable customer action — website traffic, leads, sales and loyalty. Awareness and engagement are the immediate goal; the business outcome of conversion and customer retention is what they are pursued for. Supporting goals include community building, customer service, reputation management and advocacy.

Marking scheme: 1 M for awareness/engagement with the target audience, 1 M for linking it to a business outcome such as traffic, leads, sales or loyalty.

2. What is the primary objective of Search Engine Optimization (SEO)? [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.4 — 2 M]

The primary objective is to improve a website's visibility and ranking on the *organic*, unpaid results of a search engine for relevant queries. This is achieved by making the site more relevant, more authoritative and more technically accessible to both crawlers and users, and the purpose of doing so is to attract sustained, high-intent, cost-free traffic that converts.

Marking scheme: 1 M for higher ranking/visibility in organic search results, 1 M for the purpose — relevant, high-intent traffic and conversions.

3. What is meant by data-driven audience insight in social media marketing? [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

It is the practice of collecting and analysing user data from social platforms — demographics, interests, online behaviour, engagement patterns and content preferences — in order to understand the target audience as it actually is rather than as it is assumed to be. It matters because it lets marketers build personalised campaigns, choose formats and posting times from evidence, and raise engagement and conversion instead of guessing.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for its use or benefit.

4. List any four elements required for creating an effective social media campaign. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

(1) Clear, measurable campaign objectives.
(2) A well-defined target audience.
(3) Engaging, platform-native creative content.
(4) Performance measurement and analytics.

Also acceptable: the right platform choice; a content calendar and posting schedule; a budget; a call to action.

Marking scheme: Any four, half a mark each.

5. Define campaign optimization in social media marketing and mention its purpose. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

Campaign optimisation is the continuous process of improving a running social media campaign's performance by analysing its metrics and adjusting content, creative, targeting, placement, budget and bidding accordingly. Its purpose is to raise engagement and conversion rates while reducing cost per result, so that the campaign delivers the maximum return on the money spent.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for the purpose.

6. List any four benefits of using social media platforms for business marketing and customer engagement. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

(1) Increased brand awareness and reach at low cost.
(2) Direct two-way interaction with customers.
(3) Cost-effective, precisely targeted promotion.
(4) Immediate customer feedback and reputation insight.

Also acceptable: website traffic and lead generation; competitor intelligence; community building and advocacy.

Marking scheme: Any four, half a mark each.

7. Define hashtag. List the importance of hashtags in social media marketing. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

A hashtag is a word or unspaced phrase prefixed with the # symbol that becomes a clickable, searchable label grouping every post on that topic. Importance: it makes content discoverable beyond existing followers; groups a campaign under one trackable label; allows the brand to join trending conversations; collects user-generated content; and gives a measurable unit for campaign reporting.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for two or more points of importance.

8. Why is keyword research important in SEO? [CIE-II, 7 May 2025; SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

Keyword research identifies the actual phrases users type into search engines, together with their search volume, competition level and intent. It is important because it ensures content targets phrases people genuinely search for, that the site can realistically rank for, and that carry commercial intent — so effort produces revenue rather than vanity traffic, and the whole content plan is built on demand evidence instead of assumption.

Marking scheme: 1 M for what keyword research is, 1 M for why it matters.

9. Differentiate between on-site SEO and off-site SEO. [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M]

On-site SEO is work done within your own website — title tags, meta descriptions, heading structure, content quality, keyword placement, internal linking and page speed — and it signals *relevance*. **Off-site SEO** is work done outside the website — backlinks, digital PR, brand mentions, reviews and listings — and it signals *authority*. On-site is fully within your control; off-site can only be influenced.

Marking scheme: 1 M each. The two-mark version needs only the definitions and the relevance-against-authority contrast; the eight and ten-mark versions of this question are answered elsewhere in this unit.

10. What is the purpose of optimizing organic search rankings in SEO? [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M]

To appear higher in the unpaid results for commercially relevant queries, and so capture sustainable, high-intent traffic at near-zero marginal cost. Doing so reduces dependence on paid advertising, lowers the overall cost per acquisition, and carries the additional credibility that users attach to an organic listing over an advertisement.

Marking scheme: 1 M for higher organic position on relevant queries, 1 M for the commercial purpose.

11. Name two technical aspects of a website that can significantly impact its organic search ranking. [CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M]

Page loading speed and Core Web Vitals — slow pages are demoted and abandoned before they render. **Mobile responsiveness** — indexing is mobile-first, so a site that fails on a phone fails outright. Also acceptable: HTTPS security, crawlability and indexability, XML sitemap, clean URL structure, structured data.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

12. Define SEO and explain why it is important for online businesses. [CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M]

SEO is the set of techniques used to improve a website's visibility and ranking in the organic results of search engines. It is important to online businesses because organic search supplies roughly half of all website traffic, carries the highest buyer intent of any channel, costs nothing per click, compounds over time as an owned asset, and confers more credibility with users than a paid listing does.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for two or more reasons.

13. What are two key considerations when writing SEO-friendly content for web pages? [CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M]

Match the search intent — the format, depth and angle must answer what the searcher actually wants, since a page that ranks but does not satisfy intent will not hold the position. **Integrate keywords naturally** in the title, H1, opening paragraph and subheadings using semantic variants at a moderate density, never stuffed. Also acceptable: a unique title tag and meta description; a scannable heading structure; original, comprehensive content.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

Part B — Eight, Six and Ten-Mark Questions

1. **Analyse how businesses can utilize Facebook and Instagram for different stages of a marketing funnel.** [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q3a — 8 M]

   Both platforms run on the same Meta advertising infrastructure, so a single funnel can be built across them, with the objective, creative format, audience and metric changing at each stage.

   Top of funnel — Awareness.

   (1) **Objective and format:** Reach, Brand Awareness and Video Views campaigns; Reels, Stories and short vertical video, which the algorithm currently distributes most widely to non-followers.
   (2) **Audience:** broad interest, demographic and lookalike audiences built from existing customers; Explore page and hashtag discovery on Instagram; Facebook Groups and Pages for community reach.
   (3) **Metrics:** reach, impressions, CPM, video-view rate, follower growth, brand recall lift.

   Middle of funnel — Consideration.

   (1) **Objective and format:** Traffic, Engagement and Lead Generation campaigns; carousel ads showing a range, collection ads, demonstration and testimonial video, Instagram Guides, Stories polls and Q&A stickers.
   (2) **Audience:** retargeting — video viewers of 25% or more, profile and post engagers, website visitors captured by the Meta Pixel, and uploaded e-mail lists as Custom Audiences.
   (3) **Mechanism:** instant lead forms that pre-fill from the profile, and click-to-Messenger or click-to-WhatsApp ads that begin a conversation without asking the user to leave the app.
   (4) **Metrics:** CTR, cost per landing-page view, cost per lead, engagement rate, saves and shares.

   Bottom of funnel — Conversion.

   (1) **Objective and format:** Sales and Catalogue Sales campaigns; dynamic product ads served automatically to cart abandoners and product viewers; Instagram Shopping tags and in-app checkout; limited-period offers and countdown stickers.
   (2) **Audience:** narrow, high-intent Custom Audiences built from Pixel and Conversions API events — add-to-cart in the last 7 days, checkout initiated but not completed.
   (3) **Metrics:** conversion rate, cost per purchase, ROAS, average order value.

   Post-purchase — Retention and advocacy.

   (1) Facebook Groups and Instagram Broadcast Channels for community; reposting user-generated content and reviews as social proof; loyalty and cross-sell offers to an existing-customer Custom Audience; customer service handled in DMs and Messenger. Metrics: repeat purchase rate, customer lifetime value, UGC volume, response time.

   The enabling layer. None of this works without measurement infrastructure: the Meta Pixel and Conversions API for server-side event capture, Meta Business Suite and Ads Manager for campaign control, Advantage+ audiences and placements for automated optimisation, and systematic A/B testing of creative at every stage. The funnel is judged as a whole — CPM at the top, CTR in the middle, ROAS at the bottom — because cheap reach that never converts is not an achievement.

   Marking scheme: 2 M for each of the four funnel stages, each stage needing the campaign objective, the content format, the audience and the metric. Alternatively 1.5 M per stage plus 2 M for the pixel, tooling and measurement layer.

11. Develop an SEO content plan for an e-commerce startup targeting eco-friendly household products. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q3b — 8 M]

(1) **Objectives and KPIs.** Grow organic sessions from zero to 25,000 a month and organic revenue to 40% of total within twelve months; track ranked keywords, impressions, average position, organic conversion rate and revenue per organic session.

(2) **Audience and persona.** Eco-conscious urban households — young working professionals and new parents in metro cities, aged 25–40, who are willing to pay a modest premium for verified sustainability but need reassurance that the product actually works and the claim is genuine. Their two questions are "does it work as well as the plastic version" and "is this really biodegradable".

(3) **Keyword research and clustering.** Build four intent clusters: *transactional* — "buy bamboo toothbrush online", "biodegradable garbage bags", "organic dishwash liquid"; *commercial investigation* — "best eco friendly kitchen products India", "bamboo vs plastic toothbrush"; *informational* — "how to reduce plastic in the kitchen", "are compostable bags really compostable"; *brand and local* — "zero waste store Bengaluru". Prioritise by volume against keyword difficulty, taking long-tail informational terms first because a new domain cannot rank for head terms.

(4) **Site architecture and content mapping.** Home → category (kitchen, cleaning, personal care, home decor) → sub-category → product page, with a parallel blog hub and buying-guide section. Assign exactly one primary keyword to one URL to prevent cannibalisation, and internally link every guide to the category page it supports.

(5) **Content calendar and formats.** Two blog articles a week, one long-form buying guide a month, a batch of ten product-page rewrites a month, plus seasonal pegs — Earth Day in April, Plastic-Free July, eco-gifting before Diwali. Formats: comparison tables, how-to guides with original photography, short demonstration video embedded for dwell time, and an FAQ block on every product page.

(6) **On-page SEO.** Title tags carrying the keyword and a benefit; unique meta descriptions written to earn the click; a single H1 with logical H2/H3 structure; original product descriptions rather than manufacturer copy, which is the commonest duplicate-content failure in e-commerce; descriptive alt text; clean keyword-bearing URLs; and structured data — Product, Offer, AggregateRating, FAQ and BreadcrumbList schema — to win rich results.

(7) **Technical SEO.** Mobile-first responsive build; Core Web Vitals within threshold, with compressed next-generation image formats since a product catalogue is image-heavy; HTTPS; XML sitemap and robots.txt; canonical tags on colour and size variants; controlled crawling of faceted navigation so filter combinations do not generate thousands of thin URLs; and clean handling of out-of-stock pages.

(8) **Off-page SEO and E-E-A-T.** Guest articles on sustainability blogs; digital PR built on an original data study, for example household plastic consumption in Indian cities, which earns links naturally; partnerships with eco-influencers; display of genuine certifications such as FSC or compostability standards; and systematic collection of customer reviews and user photographs, which supply both trust signals and fresh unique content.

(9) **Measurement and iteration.** Monthly review of Search Console queries, impressions and CTR; GA4 organic landing-page revenue; rank tracking on the priority clusters; quarterly content refresh of decaying pages and a repeat gap analysis against the three closest competitors.

Marking scheme: 8 M for a plan showing distinct stages — objective, audience, keyword research, architecture, calendar, on-page, technical, off-page, measurement — at roughly 1 M each. Marks are lost for a generic SEO essay that never mentions eco-friendly household products; the examples must be specific to the category.

12. Illustrate how social media analytics contribute to creating audience profiles. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q4a — 8 M]

Social media analytics is the collection and interpretation of data from social platforms — native tools such as Meta Business Suite, Instagram Insights, YouTube Studio and LinkedIn Analytics, and third-party tools such as Sprout Social, Hootsuite and Brandwatch. An **audience profile**, or persona, is the documented description of a target segment that marketing decisions are then made against.

(1) **Demographic layer.** Platform insights give age bands, gender split, city and country distribution, and language — the skeleton of the profile, and the only part most brands guess correctly.
(2) **Psychographic and interest layer.** Interest categories, pages followed, hashtags used and topics engaged with reveal values, aspirations and lifestyle, which is the part brands usually get wrong when they assume rather than measure.
(3) **Behavioural layer.** Active hours and days, device type, preferred content format, average watch time, and the ratio of saves and shares to likes show *how* the audience consumes, which directly sets the posting schedule and format mix.
(4) **Engagement segmentation.** The audience is not one group. Analytics separates advocates who share, engagers who comment, passive consumers who only watch, and detractors — each of which needs different content and different handling.
(5) **Social listening and sentiment.** Monitoring mentions of the brand, competitors and the category captures the audience's own vocabulary, its unmet needs and its objections, which becomes the raw material for messaging that sounds native rather than corporate.
(6) **Competitor audience analysis.** Examining who follows and engages with competitors exposes segments the brand has not yet addressed and validates whether its assumed persona is the one actually buying in the category.
(7) **Conversion-linked profiling.** Joining platform data to Pixel and CRM data identifies which social profile characteristics correlate with purchase and lifetime value, and turns the highest-value cluster into Custom and Lookalike Audiences — a profile that is directly actionable as a targeting instruction.
(8) **Output and maintenance.** The layers are consolidated into a persona card — demographics, goals, pain points, preferred channels and formats, objections, buying triggers, active hours — every field of which is backed by a data source, and the card is refreshed quarterly because audiences drift.

Illustration. A home-fitness brand assumed its buyer was a 30-year-old gym-goer. Analytics showed 62% of its engaged audience was female, aged 18–24, concentrated in Tier-1 cities, most active between 8 and 10 pm, overwhelmingly consuming Reels rather than static posts, and engaging with "small space home workout" hashtags. The resulting persona — a hostel or shared-flat resident with fifteen minutes and no equipment — changed the product photography, the content calendar and the ad copy, and the campaign built on it outperformed the previous one on cost per acquisition.

Marking scheme: 1 M for defining social media analytics, 6 M for six distinct contributions at 1 M each, 1 M for a worked illustration. The word "illustrate" in the question makes the worked example compulsory, not optional.

13. Construct a targeted marketing plan using SEO tools like Google Analytics and SEMrush for a B2B company. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q4b — 8 M]

Context: take a B2B industrial-automation software company. The buying cycle is long, the addressable market is small, the deal value is high, and the purchase is made by a committee — an engineer who evaluates, a finance head who approves, and a procurement officer who contracts. The plan must therefore optimise for lead *quality*, not traffic volume.

(1) **Objective.** Generate 40 marketing-qualified leads a month at a cost per lead 25% below the current figure within two quarters, with at least 30% of MQLs accepted by sales.
(2) **Baseline audit.** In **Google Analytics 4**, establish current organic, paid, referral and direct sessions; landing-page engagement rate; conversion paths and assisted conversions, which matter disproportionately in long B2B cycles where the last click is never the whole story. In **SEMrush**, run Site Audit for technical errors and Domain Overview for authority score and current ranking distribution.
(3) **Ideal customer profile.** Combine GA4 demographic, geographic and technology reports with LinkedIn firmographics to define industry, company size and role, and use SEMrush Traffic Analytics to see which publications and portals send traffic to competitors — those are the places the ICP already reads.
(4) **Keyword strategy.** Use SEMrush Keyword Magic Tool to build bottom-funnel commercial clusters — "PLC integration service provider", "SCADA software for pharma manufacturing" — and Keyword Gap against three named competitors to find terms they rank for and the company does not. Prioritise by intent first and volume second: in B2B a keyword with 90 searches a month can be worth more than one with 9,000.
(5) **Content mapped to the buying committee.** Technical whitepapers, integration documentation and comparison pages for the engineer; ROI calculators, TCO breakdowns and customer case studies with quantified results for the finance head; compliance, security and SLA documentation for procurement. Gate the high-value assets behind a short form to capture the lead; leave the top-of-funnel content ungated to earn rankings and links.
(6) **On-page and technical execution.** Optimise service and solution pages against the priority clusters; fix the crawl, speed and Core Web Vitals errors listed by the SEMrush audit; add Organisation, Product and FAQ schema; and build an internal linking structure that funnels authority from blog articles to the money pages.
(7) **Off-page and authority building.** Close the backlink gap identified by SEMrush Backlink Gap through trade-publication contributions, industry association listings, conference and webinar pages, and digital PR around original industry benchmark data.
(8) **Measurement, attribution and iteration.** Define GA4 key events for demo requests, whitepaper downloads and pricing-page views; enforce UTM conventions on every campaign; track rankings in SEMrush Position Tracking; and — the step that distinguishes a B2B plan — push GA4 client IDs into the CRM so that MQL, SQL and closed-won revenue can be attributed back to the keyword and content that started the journey. Review monthly and reallocate effort to the clusters producing accepted leads.

Marking scheme: 8 M for eight plan stages at 1 M each. Both named tools must be used explicitly and for the right job — GA4 for on-site behaviour, conversion and attribution; SEMrush for keyword, competitor, audit and backlink work. An answer that names the tools once in the introduction and then writes a generic plan will not earn the tool marks.

14. Develop a social media marketing campaign strategy for a local bakery looking to increase online sales. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q3a — 8 M]

(1) **Objective.** A SMART goal: increase online orders by 30% and raise the share of revenue coming from digital channels from 10% to 25% within three months.
(2) **Audience.** Residents aged 18–40 within a five-kilometre radius, split into three usable segments — students and young professionals buying single items and snacks, families buying for weekends, and occasion buyers ordering celebration cakes, who are the highest-value segment and plan several days ahead.
(3) **Platform selection.** Instagram as the primary channel because baked goods are inherently visual and Reels reach non-followers locally; Facebook for the older family segment and local community groups; WhatsApp Business for ordering, catalogue and broadcast; and a

properly completed Google Business Profile, since "bakery near me" is where local intent actually lands.

(4) **Content pillars and calendar.** Four pillars — product beauty shots and fresh-out-of-the-oven Reels; behind-the-scenes baking and the people who bake; customer testimonials and reposted user photographs; and offers, new launches and festive specials. Four to five feed posts a week plus daily Stories, with a fixed weekly rhythm so the audience learns when to look.

(5) **Paid promotion.** A modest Rs. 400–500 a day on geo-fenced Instagram and Facebook ads set to a five-kilometre radius; carousel ads of bestsellers for cold audiences; retargeting of profile visitors, video viewers and website visitors with a first-order discount; and click-to-WhatsApp ads that let a customer order without a website at all.

(6) **Conversion mechanics.** A first-order code such as FRESH15; combo bundles that raise average order value; free delivery above a threshold; Instagram Shopping tags on product posts; a single link-in-bio ordering page; and pre-order forms for celebration cakes so the high-value segment can be captured days in advance.

(7) **Community and influencer activity.** Barter collaborations with five to ten micro food bloggers in the city, who cost a box of pastries rather than a fee; a branded local hashtag; reposting every customer photograph; running a "you choose next week's flavour" poll; and replying to every comment and DM within an hour, which on a local account is itself a competitive advantage.

(8) **Measurement and optimisation.** Track reach and engagement rate, profile-to-link click-through, orders attributed by promo code and UTM, cost per order, ROAS and repeat-order rate. A/B test creatives weekly, review spend allocation fortnightly, and hold a monthly review against the 30% target.

Marking scheme: 8 M for eight strategy components at 1 M each. The answer must be recognisably about a *local* bakery — geo-targeting, WhatsApp ordering, Google Business Profile, micro-influencers — since a generic social media essay forfeits the application marks.

15. Explain the difference between on-site and off-site SEO. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q3b — 8 M]

On-site SEO (on-page SEO) is everything done *within* the website to make it relevant, crawlable and useful. **Off-site SEO** is everything done *outside* the website to build its authority and reputation.

(1) **Location of activity.** On-site work happens on pages the owner controls; off-site work happens on third-party websites, platforms and publications.

(2) **Degree of control.** On-site is fully within the owner's control and can be changed the same day; off-site can only be influenced — another site decides whether to link, and a bad link cannot simply be deleted.

(3) **Signal produced.** On-site signals *relevance* — this page is about this topic. Off-site signals *authority and trust* — other credible sites vouch for this one.

(4) **Principal elements.** On-site: keyword research and placement, title tags and meta descriptions, heading hierarchy, content quality and depth, URL structure, internal linking, image alt text, structured data, page speed and Core Web Vitals, mobile responsiveness, HTTPS, crawlability and sitemaps. Off-site: backlink acquisition and quality, anchor-text profile, guest posting, digital PR and brand mentions, social sharing and signals, influencer outreach, forum and community participation, local citations and NAP consistency, Google Business Profile and customer reviews.

(5) **Time to effect.** On-site changes can move rankings within days to weeks; off-site authority accumulates over months and years.

(6) **Cost profile and risk.** On-site cost is mostly internal effort and carries little penalty

risk if done honestly. Off-site often involves outreach cost or agency spend and carries real penalty risk — bought links, link farms and manipulated anchor text are what search engines penalise.

(7) **Tools used.** On-site: Google Search Console, Screaming Frog, PageSpeed Insights, SEMrush Site Audit, Yoast or RankMath. Off-site: Ahrefs and SEMrush backlink analytics, Majestic, HARO, BuzzStream.

(8) **Dependence.** They are complements, not alternatives. On-site SEO makes a page *eligible* to rank; off-site SEO is what lets it *win* a competitive query. A technically perfect page with no authority stalls on page three; a well-linked page with poor on-page relevance never surfaces for the right query at all.

Marking scheme: 2 M for the two definitions, 4 M for four or more clear points of difference — control, signal, elements, timeframe, risk — and 2 M for naming concrete elements or tools on each side and stating that both are required.

16. Discuss the importance of SEO in digital marketing strategies. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q4a — 8 M]

(1) **It occupies where journeys begin.** The large majority of online purchase and research journeys start at a search engine, and the first few organic results take most of the clicks. A brand absent from that position is absent from the start of its own market's decision process.

(2) **It delivers high-intent, qualified traffic.** A visitor arriving from a search has actively described their need. Conversion rates on organic search traffic are therefore typically higher than on interruptive display or social traffic, which reaches people who were not looking for anything.

(3) **It is cost-effective and compounds.** There is no cost per click. A page that ranks continues to deliver traffic for years, so SEO behaves like a capital asset, whereas paid advertising stops delivering the moment the budget stops — the difference between owning and renting.

(4) **It confers credibility and trust.** Users read a high organic ranking as an implicit endorsement in a way they do not read a sponsored label, and consistent visibility supports the experience, expertise, authoritativeness and trust that search engines and customers both reward.

(5) **It improves the user experience as a by-product.** The work SEO demands — fast loading, mobile responsiveness, logical structure, accessible markup, useful content — is the same work good UX demands, so the site improves for humans while it improves for crawlers.

(6) **It builds a defensible position.** Rankings backed by content depth and an earned backlink profile cannot be bought overnight by a competitor with a larger budget, which makes organic visibility one of the few durable advantages in digital marketing.

(7) **It strengthens every other channel.** Keyword research informs paid search bidding and ad copy; SEO content feeds social and e-mail programmes; landing-page quality raises Google Ads Quality Score and lowers CPC; and digital PR serves both link building and brand.

(8) **It is measurable, local and mobile-ready.** Search Console and GA4 quantify impressions, clicks, position and revenue precisely; local SEO and Google Business Profile capture "near me" intent and drive physical footfall; and optimisation for mobile and voice queries positions the brand for how search is actually conducted now.

Marking scheme: 8 M for eight distinct reasons at 1 M each, or six substantial points explained at greater length. Naming without explanation earns half marks.

17. Discuss the benefits and challenges of using social media for business marketing. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q4b — 8 M]

Benefits

(1) **Reach at low cost.** Billions of active users are accessible without the media budget traditional advertising demands, which puts a small business on the same shelf as a large one.
(2) **Precise targeting.** Demographic, interest, behavioural, custom and lookalike targeting reduces wasted impressions far below what print or television can achieve.
(3) **Two-way engagement and relationships.** Comments, DMs, polls and communities turn broadcast into conversation, which builds loyalty and generates continuous unsolicited feedback.
(4) **Measurability and speed.** Reach, engagement, clicks, conversions and ROAS are visible in near real time, so a campaign can be corrected within hours rather than after the quarter.
(5) **Traffic, leads and social commerce.** Shoppable posts, lead forms and click-to-chat convert attention directly, without requiring the user to leave the platform.
(6) **Brand humanisation and advocacy.** Behind-the-scenes content, founder presence and user-generated content build the personality and social proof that advertising alone cannot manufacture.

Challenges

(1) **Resource intensity.** Consistent quality content across several platforms demands time, skill and money on a permanent basis, not as a campaign.
(2) **Declining organic reach and algorithm dependence.** Platforms progressively throttle unpaid reach and change ranking rules without notice, so an audience built on rented land can be devalued overnight.
(3) **Negative publicity and speed of escalation.** A complaint, a review or a badly judged post can go viral within hours, and a slow or defensive response compounds it.
(4) **Attribution and ROI difficulty.** Engagement is easy to count and hard to value; connecting a like to revenue requires pixel, CRM and attribution work that many businesses never do.
(5) **Privacy regulation and tracking loss.** GDPR, CCPA and India's DPDP Act, together with app tracking restrictions, have reduced targeting precision and made consent management a compliance obligation.
(6) **Rising cost, ad fatigue and clutter.** Auction prices climb, users tune out repetition, and standing out requires ever more creative production — while bots and fake engagement distort the numbers used to judge it.

Marking scheme: 4 M for benefits and 4 M for challenges, roughly four substantive points on each side at 1 M each. An answer weighted heavily to one side loses the marks allotted to the other.

7. Explain the concept of Search Engine Optimization and its significance in digital marketing. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q4a — 8 M]

Concept. SEO is the practice of improving a website's visibility in the organic — unpaid — results of search engines for queries relevant to the business, by making the site technically accessible, topically relevant and externally authoritative. It is distinct from PPC, which buys placement; both together form SEM.

The three pillars

(1) **Technical SEO** — crawlability, indexability, site speed, mobile responsiveness, HTTPS,

sitemaps and structured data. Makes the site *discoverable*.

(2) **On-page SEO** — keyword research and placement, title tags and meta descriptions, heading hierarchy, content quality and depth, internal linking, image optimisation. Makes the site *relevant*.

(3) **Off-page SEO** — backlinks, digital PR, brand mentions, reviews, local citations. Makes the site *authoritative*.

Significance in digital marketing

(1) **It is where journeys start.** Organic search delivers roughly half of all website traffic — more than any other single channel.

(2) **Highest buyer intent.** The visitor has typed their need in their own words, so conversion rates exceed those of interruptive channels.

(3) **Compounding return at near-zero marginal cost.** There is no cost per click, and a ranking page keeps earning long after the work is done, unlike advertising that stops when the budget stops.

(4) **Credibility.** Users trust organic listings more than sponsored ones, so ranking confers authority that cannot be bought.

(5) **Competitive defence and measurability.** A ranking backed by content and links is hard for a competitor to displace quickly, and Search Console and GA4 make every element of performance measurable.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 3 M for the concept including the three pillars and the SEO/PPC/SEM distinction, and 5 M for the significance at 1 M per reason.

4. **Explain the key components of Search Engine Optimization — on-page, off-page and technical SEO. How do these elements contribute to improving website ranking?** [CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M]

On-page SEO — content optimisation

(1) **Keyword optimisation** — researched primary and semantic keywords placed in the title, H1, opening paragraph, subheadings and body without stuffing.

(2) **Meta tags** — a unique title tag written to earn the click and a meta description that summarises the page persuasively.

(3) **URL structure and heading hierarchy** — short, readable, keyword-bearing URLs and one H1 with a logical H2/H3 structure.

(4) **Content quality and internal linking** — original, comprehensive, intent-matching content, linked internally with descriptive anchor text so authority flows to the pages that matter.

Off-page SEO — external signals

(1) **Backlinks** — editorial links from relevant, authoritative domains, judged far more on quality than on count.

(2) **Digital PR, guest posting and influencer collaboration** — the legitimate means of earning those links.

(3) **Social sharing, brand mentions and online reviews** — reputation and demand signals, plus local citations and a complete Google Business Profile for local ranking.

Technical SEO — backend optimisation

(1) **Speed and Core Web Vitals, and mobile friendliness** — indexing is mobile-first and speed is a ranking factor in its own right.

(2) **HTTPS, XML sitemap, robots.txt, canonical tags and structured data** — security, crawl guidance, duplicate control and rich-result eligibility.

How they combine to improve ranking

(1) Technical SEO makes the site **discoverable** — a page that cannot be crawled, rendered or loaded cannot rank at any level of quality. On-page SEO makes it **relevant** — it tells the engine and the user what the page answers and satisfies the intent behind the query. Off-page SEO makes it **authoritative** — it supplies the third-party evidence that this page deserves to outrank equally relevant competitors. Ranking is a function of all three: strength in one cannot compensate for absence of another, which is why an excellent article on a slow, unlinked site stays invisible.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 3 M for each of the three components with their elements, and 1–2 M for the synthesis explaining how they interact. The second half of the question — "how do these contribute" — is a separate demand and must be answered explicitly, not left implied.

10. Analyse the differences between on-site and off-site SEO techniques. Provide examples for each. [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M]

This is the ten-mark form of the eight-mark question answered earlier in this unit. Give the same points of difference — location, control, signal, elements, timeframe, cost and risk, tools, and interdependence — but at ten marks add a worked example against each technique rather than only naming them.

(1) **Location and control.** On-site: changes made on your own pages, deployable today. *Example:* rewriting a product page's title tag from "Products" to "Bamboo Toothbrush — Plastic-Free, 4-Pack". Off-site: activity on third-party properties, which you can influence but never command. *Example:* a sustainability blog choosing to cite your research.

(2) **Signal produced.** On-site signals relevance — what this page is about. Off-site signals authority — whether anyone credible vouches for it.

(3) **Content and keywords.** On-site: intent-matched content with keywords in the title, H1 and body. *Example:* publishing a 1,800-word buying guide targeting "best air purifier for allergies". Off-site has no content of its own; it borrows other sites' content as a carrier for links.

(4) **Technical elements.** On-site only: site speed, mobile responsiveness, HTTPS, sitemaps, canonicals, schema. *Example:* compressing images to bring LCP under 2.5 seconds.

(5) **Link work.** On-site: internal linking to distribute authority. *Example:* linking ten blog posts to the main category page. Off-site: earning external backlinks. *Example:* a guest article on an industry publication linking back with a descriptive anchor.

(6) **Reputation and social.** Off-site only: reviews, brand mentions, social sharing, local citations. *Example:* 200 Google reviews averaging 4.6 stars, and consistent name, address and phone details across directories.

(7) **Timeframe.** On-site changes can move rankings in days or weeks; off-site authority accrues over months and years.

(8) **Cost and risk.** On-site is mostly internal effort with little penalty risk when done honestly. Off-site often carries outreach or agency cost and real penalty risk — purchased links, link farms and over-optimised anchor text are precisely what search engines penalise.

(9) **Measurement.** On-site is audited with Search Console, Screaming Frog, PageSpeed Insights and SEMrush Site Audit; off-site with Ahrefs or SEMrush backlink analytics and Majestic.

(10) **Interdependence — the analytical conclusion.** On-site SEO makes a page *eligible* to rank; off-site SEO is what lets it *win* a competitive query. A technically perfect page with

no authority stalls on page three; a heavily linked page with poor on-page relevance never surfaces for the right query at all. Neither substitutes for the other.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6–7 M for the points of difference and 3–4 M for examples, which the question demands explicitly for each side. A comparison table with an example column is the most efficient way to present this.

11. Describe the role of content in SEO. How can a business create high-quality, SEO-friendly content? [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q4b — 8 M]

The role of content

(1) **It is the material rankings are computed from.** Search engines index and rank text; without substantial relevant content there is nothing for a query to match against.
(2) **It satisfies intent and so holds the ranking.** Dwell time, return visits and low pogo-sticking are behavioural evidence that the page answered the question, and they sustain the position content won.
(3) **It is the asset that earns backlinks.** Nobody links to a product page; they link to a guide, a study or a tool — so content is the mechanism by which off-page authority is acquired.
(4) **It carries E-E-A-T.** Demonstrated experience, expertise, authoritativeness and trust are expressed through content — author credentials, citations, depth and accuracy — and matter most in health, finance and safety topics.

How to create it

(1) **Research keywords and intent first,** and decide the format the intent demands — comparison, how-to, list, definition — before writing.
(2) **Write for the reader, optimise afterwards.** Content written for the algorithm reads badly and converts worse; the sequence matters.
(3) **Beat what currently ranks.** Study the top results and produce something more comprehensive, more current, better structured or better evidenced — parity is not a ranking argument.
(4) **Structure for scanning.** One H1, logical H2 and H3 headings, short paragraphs, lists and tables, with the direct answer near the top.
(5) **Optimise the on-page elements.** Unique title tag and meta description, keyword and semantic variants placed naturally, descriptive image alt text, clean URL, and FAQ or How-To schema where it applies.
(6) **Add rich media and internal links,** which raise engagement time and route authority to the pages that need it.
(7) **Keep it fresh.** Audit historically, update decaying pages, merge cannibalising pages, and re-date only when the content genuinely changed.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 3 M for the role of content and 5 M for the method. The question has two halves and both must be answered; a pure "content is king" essay with no practical method loses the larger half.

5. You are writing a blog post about a complex technical topic. Describe how you would integrate relevant keywords naturally while keeping it engaging and informative for readers. [CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

The governing principle is *write for the reader first, optimise second.* Keywords inserted into a draft read as noise; keywords planned into a structure read as headings.

(1) **Research before writing.** Identify one primary keyword, three to five secondary keywords and the semantic field around them, and check what the top-ranking pages actually cover.

(2) **Let intent set the structure.** If the query is a how-to, the article is steps; if it is a comparison, it is a table. Structure chosen from intent places keywords naturally, because headings become the queries.
(3) **Place keywords in the high-value positions.** The title tag, the H1, the first hundred words, at least one H2, the URL, the meta description and one image alt attribute — these carry most of the weight, and hitting them removes any need to force keywords elsewhere.
(4) **Use semantic variants and natural language rather than repetition.** Search engines match meaning, not exact strings, so synonyms, related entities and question phrasings serve better than the same phrase eleven times.
(5) **Keep density moderate.** Roughly three to five per cent including variants; beyond that the text degrades and stuffing risks a penalty.
(6) **Explain jargon on first use.** A complex technical topic loses readers at the first undefined term. Define it in one plain sentence, then use it — which also captures the definitional long-tail queries.
(7) **Cover the People Also Ask questions** as H2 or H3 subheadings. This makes the article genuinely more complete and simultaneously targets additional queries without any artificial insertion.
(8) **Break the density of the text.** Diagrams, code blocks, tables, short paragraphs and pull-out summaries carry a technical argument better than prose and raise engagement time, which is itself a signal.
(9) **Link internally with descriptive anchors,** for example to a prerequisite explainer, so the reader can go deeper and authority flows through the site.
(10) **Read it aloud before publishing.** If any sentence sounds like it was written to contain a phrase rather than to say something, rewrite it. That single test catches almost all unnatural optimisation.

Marking scheme: 10 M for ten points at 1 M each. The question sets two constraints — natural keyword integration *and* readability for a technical audience — and marks are lost by answering only the SEO half.

6. What are the key metrics used to measure organic search ranking? How can businesses monitor and improve these metrics over time? Describe the process of conducting an SEO audit and implementing changes. [CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

Key metrics

(1) **Average position and keyword rankings** by tracked term, and the count of keywords in the top three and top ten.
(2) **Organic impressions, clicks and click-through rate** from Search Console — CTR isolates a title-and-description problem from a ranking problem.
(3) **Organic sessions, engagement rate and organic conversions or revenue** — the business outcome, without which rankings are vanity.
(4) **Indexed pages, crawl errors and Core Web Vitals** — technical health, and **backlinks, referring domains and domain authority** — off-page strength.

Monitoring and improving. Set a baseline; track weekly in Search Console and a rank tracker; review monthly against competitors; and treat each metric as a diagnostic — high impressions with low CTR means rewrite titles and descriptions, good rankings with low conversion means the landing page fails intent, falling rankings means content decay or a competitor's move.

The SEO audit process

(1) **Crawl the site** with Screaming Frog or SEMrush Site Audit to enumerate every URL and its status.

(2) **Technical check** — indexation against sitemap, robots.txt, canonical errors, redirect chains, broken links, HTTPS, mobile usability, Core Web Vitals.
(3) **On-page check** — missing, duplicate or truncated title tags and meta descriptions, heading structure, thin or duplicated content, image alt text, schema coverage.
(4) **Content and keyword check** — keyword cannibalisation, content gaps against competitors, decaying pages, intent mismatch on key landing pages.
(5) **Off-page check** — backlink quality and growth, toxic links, anchor-text distribution, competitor backlink gap.
(6) **Prioritise, implement, verify.** Rank every finding by impact against effort, fix the highest-impact technical blockers first, then on-page, then content, then links; re-crawl to confirm, request re-indexing, and re-measure after four to eight weeks — then repeat the cycle quarterly, because SEO is maintenance, not a project.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 3 M for the metrics, 2 M for monitoring and improvement, and 5 M for the audit process. The question has three distinct demands; answers that cover only the audit lose half the marks.

5. An educational institution is struggling to rank for competitive keywords related to online courses. Conduct an SEO audit of their website, identify key issues affecting organic search ranking, and recommend actionable solutions. [CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

Answer as a diagnosis, pairing each finding with its remedy — that pairing is what the question rewards.

(1) **Finding — targeting head terms only.** The site chases "online courses" and "best online education", which are dominated by national aggregators. *Solution:* move to long-tail, intent-rich and local terms — "online data science course with placement in Bengaluru" — where the institution can realistically win, and build up.
(2) **Finding — thin course pages.** Each course page carries a paragraph and a fee table. *Solution:* expand into full pages — syllabus, outcomes, faculty credentials, duration, fees, placement data, alumni testimonials, FAQ — which serves both intent and E-E-A-T.
(3) **Finding — keyword cannibalisation.** Four near-identical pages target the same course term. *Solution:* consolidate into one canonical page and 301-redirect the rest.
(4) **Finding — weak E-E-A-T on an education topic.** No named authors, no faculty credentials, no accreditation displayed. *Solution:* author bios with qualifications, visible accreditation and affiliation, verifiable placement statistics.
(5) **Finding — technical issues.** Slow LCP from uncompressed hero images, poor mobile usability on the application form, and an outdated sitemap. *Solution:* compress and lazy-load images, fix the mobile form, regenerate and resubmit the sitemap, resolve crawl errors.
(6) **Finding — no structured data.** *Solution:* add Course, Organization, FAQ and BreadcrumbList schema so listings become eligible for rich results, which lifts CTR even without a ranking change.
(7) **Finding — missing or duplicated metadata.** *Solution:* unique benefit-led title tags and meta descriptions for every course page.
(8) **Finding — almost no authoritative backlinks.** *Solution:* earn links through original research on employment outcomes, faculty contributions to education publications, listings in genuine education directories, and partnerships with schools and employers.
(9) **Finding — no content for the research stage.** Prospective students search "is a data science certificate worth it" months before they search for a course. *Solution:* build a guide and comparison content hub feeding internal links to the course pages.
(10) **Finding — no local or reputational signals.** *Solution:* complete the Google Business Profile, secure consistent citations, and systematically collect student reviews. *Then:*

prioritise by impact against effort, implement in that order, and re-measure rankings, impressions and enquiry conversions after six to eight weeks.

Marking scheme: 10 M for ten findings each paired with an actionable solution. Marks are awarded for the pairing — a list of generic SEO advice with no diagnosis, or a diagnosis with no remedy, earns roughly half. The scenario is an educational institution, so E-E-A-T, course schema and student reviews are the context-specific points examiners look for.

6. Discuss the key metrics used to measure the success of a social media marketing campaign, and explain their importance for evaluating performance. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q3a — 8 M]

(1) **Reach and impressions.** How many distinct people saw the content and how many times it was displayed — the denominator for everything else, and the measure of awareness.
(2) **Engagement and engagement rate.** Likes, comments, shares and saves as a proportion of reach. Rate matters more than count, because a large account with poor engagement is a worse asset than a small one with high engagement.
(3) **Follower growth and audience quality.** Net growth over time and whether the new followers match the target profile.
(4) **Click-through rate and traffic to the site.** Whether attention converted into intent, measured through UTM-tagged links in GA4.
(5) **Conversion rate and leads or sales.** The business outcome — sign-ups, enquiries, purchases attributed to the campaign.
(6) **Cost metrics — CPM, CPC, cost per lead and ROAS.** Whether the outcome was worth what it cost, which is the only test that ultimately matters.
(7) **Share of voice and sentiment.** How much of the category conversation the brand holds and whether the tone of it is favourable.
(8) **Video and content-specific metrics.** View-through rate, completion rate, saves and shares, which identify the creative worth repeating and worth promoting with paid budget.

Why measurement matters. It proves or disproves ROI and so justifies budget; it identifies the best-performing content, audience and posting time so resources move to what works; it exposes underperformance early enough to correct mid-campaign; it enables A/B testing and therefore continuous improvement; it supports benchmarking against competitors and against the brand's own history; and it converts social media from an activity that is merely believed to work into one that can be shown to.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 5 M for the metrics — named, defined and grouped — and 3 M for the importance of measuring them. Both halves are examined; the second is the one usually skipped.

7. Explain the importance of social media marketing for businesses today. How can businesses integrate social media platforms into their overall marketing strategy? [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M]

Importance

(1) **The trust asymmetry.** People overwhelmingly believe peers and other customers over brand advertising, and social media is where peer opinion lives — so it reaches buyers through the channel they actually trust.
(2) **Reach and time spent.** Billions of active users spending hours a day makes it the single largest attention pool available.
(3) **Cost-effectiveness.** Organic presence is free and paid reach is cheap relative to traditional media, with far better targeting.
(4) **Two-way engagement and service.** Comments and DMs turn marketing into conversation and double as a support channel.

(5) **Continuous customer feedback and market research** at no research cost — what customers praise, complain about and ask for.
(6) **Social selling and commerce.** Shoppable posts, catalogues and click-to-chat shorten the path from discovery to purchase.
(7) **It fuels the other channels.** Social content supplies material for e-mail and the website, generates brand search, and earns the mentions and links that support SEO.

Integration into the overall strategy

(1) **Start from shared business objectives.** Social goals must be derived from the marketing plan's goals, not set separately, so that social KPIs ladder up to revenue.
(2) **Map content to the customer lifecycle,** so that social serves awareness, consideration, conversion, retention and advocacy rather than awareness alone.
(3) **Synchronise campaigns across channels.** One message, one calendar and one creative system across social, e-mail, search, website and offline, so a customer meets a continuous conversation rather than five disconnected ones.
(4) **Connect the data.** Pixels, UTM discipline and CRM integration let social audiences be retargeted through search and e-mail, and let social's assisted contribution be measured instead of dismissed.
(5) **Assign ownership, tooling and governance** — calendar, approval workflow, response-time standards and a crisis playbook — then review performance monthly against the shared objectives and reallocate.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 5 M for importance and 5 M for integration. The integration half is the harder and less frequently prepared one; an answer that lists benefits of social media and then stops has answered half the question.

8. **Compare the roles of Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn and Twitter (X) in social media marketing. How should a business choose the right platform?** [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M]

(1) **Facebook.** The broadest demographic reach, skewing older, with the strongest local-business and community tooling — Pages, Groups, Marketplace, events. Core mechanic: community and targeted advertising through the most mature ad platform available. Best for local businesses, B2C at scale, and any campaign needing precise paid targeting.
(2) **Instagram.** Visual-first and younger, driven by Reels and Stories with strong discovery through Explore. Core mechanic: aspiration and aesthetics. Best for lifestyle, fashion, food, travel, fitness and beauty, for influencer collaboration and for social commerce through shoppable posts.
(3) **LinkedIn.** Professional and firmographic, with targeting by job title, industry, seniority and company size available nowhere else. Core mechanic: credibility and professional identity. Best for B2B lead generation, thought leadership, recruitment and high-value considered purchases.
(4) **Twitter/X.** Real-time, text-first and conversational, oriented to news, trends and public discourse. Core mechanic: immediacy. Best for customer service, live-event marketing, public relations, and technology or media brands.

How to choose

(1) **Where the target audience actually is.** Verified from analytics and platform audience data, not from assumption — this criterion outweighs all others.
(2) **The objective.** Awareness and discovery favour Instagram and YouTube; B2B lead generation favours LinkedIn; community and local reach favour Facebook; service and real-time response favour X.

(3) **The product and its content form.** A visually demonstrable product suits Instagram; a complex, high-consideration service suits LinkedIn long-form; a fast-moving consumer topic suits short video.
(4) **Resources and sustainable cadence.** Two platforms served consistently outperform five served sporadically, so capacity is a selection criterion, not an afterthought.
(5) **Competitor presence and gaps.** Where competitors are strong the cost of attention is higher; a channel they neglect may be cheaper to win.
(6) **Cost, measurability and test evidence.** Compare CPM, CPC and cost per result; then pilot on two platforms for a quarter and let the measured cost per outcome make the final decision rather than intuition.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6 M for the four platform comparisons — 1.5 M each, each needing audience, core mechanic and best use — and 4 M for the selection criteria. A comparison table plus a short criteria list is the strongest format.

5. Explain the importance of data-driven insights in social media marketing. Describe the process of developing audience insights using analytics tools, and how these insights inform the development and optimization of campaigns. [CIE-I, 1 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

Importance. Data-driven insight replaces assumption about who the audience is, when they are reachable and what they respond to. It reduces wasted spend, raises relevance and engagement, allows precise targeting and lookalike expansion, makes performance predictable enough to forecast, and turns social media from an unaccountable activity into a measurable investment.

The process

(1) **Define the question.** Decide what decision the insight must serve — which segment to target, which format to fund, when to post — because data gathered without a question produces reports, not insight.
(2) **Collect from native analytics.** Meta Business Suite, Instagram Insights, YouTube Studio, LinkedIn and X analytics for demographics, reach, engagement and timing.
(3) **Add third-party and listening tools.** Sprout Social, Hootsuite or Brandwatch for cross-platform comparison, sentiment and competitor benchmarking.
(4) **Join to site and CRM data.** Pixel, GA4 and CRM records connect social behaviour to actual purchase and lifetime value — the step that distinguishes insight from engagement trivia.
(5) **Clean and segment.** Remove bot and internal traffic, then segment by demography, interest, behaviour, engagement level and value.
(6) **Analyse for patterns.** Which segments engage, at what hours, with which formats and messages; which content correlates with conversion rather than merely with likes.
(7) **Build and document personas** with every attribute traced to a data source, and validate them against actual purchase data.
(8) **Distribute the insight** in a form the creative and media teams can act on — a one-page persona card and a posting matrix, not a raw dashboard.

How the insight informs development and optimisation

(1) **Campaign development.** It sets targeting and lookalike seeds, selects platforms, fixes the content mix and tone, determines the posting schedule, and allocates budget between segments before a rupee is spent.
(2) **In-flight optimisation.** It drives the levers that are adjusted while the campaign runs — pausing underperforming creative, reallocating budget between ad sets, narrowing or broadening audiences, shifting dayparting, changing placements and testing new hooks — with each change justified by a measured difference rather than by opinion.

Marking scheme: 10 M. The question has three parts — importance, process, application — so roughly 3 M, 4 M and 3 M. Answering only the process, which is the commonest response, forfeits the other two.

9. Analyse how the Facebook algorithm filter evaluates content distribution. Which practices are penalised and which are rewarded? [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

What it is. The algorithm is the ranking system that decides which posts appear in each user's feed and in what order, out of the thousands eligible. It exists because supply vastly exceeds attention, and its objective is to maximise meaningful time spent — so it predicts, for each user and each post, how likely that user is to find it valuable.

How it evaluates

(1) **Relationship and engagement history** — how often this user has previously interacted with this page or person. Past interaction is the strongest single predictor.
(2) **Relevance and predicted interest** — topical match between the post and the user's demonstrated interests.
(3) **Content-type preference** — whether this user habitually watches video, reads links or views photos, and whether the post matches.
(4) **Recency and timeliness** — newer posts are favoured, and posting when the audience is active compounds the advantage.
(5) **Quality, originality and predicted response** — signals of genuine value, weighted by how likely the user is to comment, share or dwell rather than merely scroll past.

Penalised — filtered out

(1) Clickbait headlines that withhold or exaggerate.
(2) Engagement bait — "like if you agree", "tag five friends", "comment YES".
(3) Repeatedly posting the same source or link back to back.
(4) Misinformation and content flagged by fact-checkers.
(5) Spam, scraped and copied low-quality content.
(6) Excessively promotional posts with no value to the reader.

Rewarded — propelled through

(1) Time genuinely spent on the post after it has fully loaded, which is harder to fake than a like.
(2) Active video signals — unmuting, going full-screen, choosing HD, and completion.
(3) Live video, which earns substantially more watch time and interaction than recorded video.
(4) Original content rather than reshared or aggregated material.
(5) Meaningful interactions — comments, replies to comments and shares that generate conversation — weighted above passive likes.
(6) Informative and locally relevant posts, and consistent posting that sustains the relationship signal.

The analytical conclusion. Every penalised practice manufactures a signal; every rewarded practice earns one. The algorithm is therefore best understood not as an obstacle to be gamed but as a proxy for genuine audience value — which is why the durable strategy is to produce content people actually want, posted consistently, in the format that audience prefers.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 2 M for what the algorithm is and why, 3 M for the evaluation criteria, 2–3 M for penalised practices, 2–3 M for rewarded ones, and credit for a concluding synthesis. Lists alone earn the middle band; the analysis of *why* the two lists differ is what lifts the answer.

12. Explain the stages of the customer lifecycle orbit, and discuss the difference between selling to new prospects and to existing customers. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

The stages

(1) **Awareness.** The prospect first learns the brand exists, typically through social discovery, search or word of mouth. Content job: reach and recall.
(2) **Engagement.** They interact — follow, watch, read, comment. Content job: earn attention repeatedly and establish relevance.
(3) **Evaluation or consideration.** They compare against alternatives. Content job: proof — reviews, comparisons, demonstrations, guarantees.
(4) **Purchase or conversion.** They buy. Content job: remove friction and reassure at the point of decision.
(5) **Retention or post-purchase support.** They use the product and decide whether it met expectations. Content job: onboarding, support, useful follow-up — the stage most brands neglect.
(6) **Advocacy.** They recommend, review and refer, feeding new prospects back into awareness — which is why it is an orbit rather than a funnel.

New prospects against existing customers

(1) **Probability of sale.** Selling to an existing customer succeeds roughly 60–70% of the time; to a new prospect, roughly 5–20%. The gap is the single most important number in the comparison.
(2) **Cost.** Acquiring a new customer costs several times more than retaining an existing one, because trust must be built from zero and paid media must do the introducing.
(3) **Order value and behaviour.** Repeat customers spend materially more per order, try new categories more readily, are less price-sensitive and cost less to serve.
(4) **Strategic implication.** Since retention is both cheaper and more likely to convert, social content must serve the whole orbit — retention and advocacy included — rather than pouring the entire budget into awareness. Advocacy in particular is the only stage that reduces future acquisition cost, because a referred customer arrives pre-trusted.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6 M for the six stages explained and 4 M for the comparison, which must include the quantified contrast — the 5–20% against 60–70% probability figures are what the scheme looks for — and the strategic conclusion drawn from it.

7. Based on the content lifecycle matrix, how should a marketer adjust the objective, tone and format of content as a prospect moves from the early stage to the late stage? [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

The matrix maps three variables against three stages. The trajectory is the answer: **objective** moves from attention to trust to action; **tone** moves from entertaining to educational to conversion-focused; **format** moves from light and shareable to substantive to transactional.

(1) **Early stage — objective: capture attention.** The prospect does not know the brand and owes it nothing, so the only achievable goal is to be noticed and remembered.
(2) **Early stage — tone: fun, entertaining, light.** Educational depth is wasted on someone who has not yet decided to listen.
(3) **Early stage — formats:** curated news, quick tips, memes, striking visual content, short-form video, trend participation.
(4) **Middle stage — objective: build trust and deepen the relationship.** The prospect is aware and now assessing whether the brand is credible.
(5) **Middle stage — tone: educational and helpful,** demonstrating expertise without demanding a purchase.

(6) **Middle stage — formats:** how-to guides, webinars, contests, newsletter subscription offers, event invitations, case studies, comparison content.
(7) **Late stage — objective: drive action.** The prospect trusts the brand and is deciding whether to buy; hesitation here is about risk, not information.
(8) **Late stage — tone: informative, specific and conversion-focused,** addressing objections directly.
(9) **Late stage — formats:** product demonstrations, free trials, click-to-purchase posts, testimonials, limited-period offers, pricing and FAQ content.
(10) **The governing principle.** Mismatching stage and content is the commonest failure in content marketing — a purchase call to action shown to someone at the awareness stage reads as intrusive, while entertaining content shown to someone ready to buy wastes their intent. Content must therefore be planned as a sequence, with retargeting audiences used to ensure each stage's content reaches the people actually at that stage.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Three stages against three variables gives nine cells, roughly 1 M each, plus 1 M for the concluding principle. Presenting it as a three-by-three matrix and then explaining the trajectory is the most efficient and best-rewarded structure.

8. **Detail the four Rs of content scaling. How does this framework help marketers maximise the use of their content assets?** [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

The four Rs address a structural problem: most content is published once, performs for a few weeks and is then abandoned, even though producing it was the expensive part.

(1) **Reorganize.** Restructure an existing asset into a different form for a different channel and audience, without rewriting the substance. *Example:* a 2,000-word guide becomes an infographic, a ten-slide carousel, a five-part e-mail sequence and three short videos.
(2) **Rewrite.** Update an ageing but still valuable asset — refresh statistics, add developments, improve structure and re-optimise for current keywords — then republish. *Example:* a 2023 SEO guide updated for AI search behaviour, which typically recovers rankings faster than a new article would earn them.
(3) **Retire.** Remove or consolidate content that no longer performs, is obsolete, or competes with a stronger page. *Example:* merging four thin articles on the same keyword into one authoritative page and redirecting the rest — which raises the site's overall quality signal.
(4) **Redesign.** Improve the presentation of content whose substance is sound — better visuals, clearer layout, updated branding, improved mobile rendering, added media. *Example:* converting a wall of text into a scannable page with tables and diagrams, raising engagement time without changing a single argument.

An alternative formulation taught in some sources is **Repurpose, Refresh, Repost and Recombine**. Either is acceptable provided it is labelled; the underlying logic is identical.

How the framework maximises content assets

(1) **It saves time and cost** — reworking an asset is far cheaper than originating one, so output rises without proportional spend.
(2) **It increases reach** — the same idea meets audiences on channels and in formats they would never have encountered it in originally.
(3) **It improves SEO** — refreshed and consolidated content recovers and holds rankings, and cannibalisation is eliminated.
(4) **It raises engagement** — format matched to platform performs better than one asset cross-posted everywhere.
(5) **It maximises ROI and enforces portfolio discipline** — content is managed as a set of assets with a lifecycle, each periodically reviewed and either reorganised, rewritten,

retired or redesigned, rather than published and forgotten.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 5–6 M for the four Rs, each named, explained and exemplified, and 4–5 M for the benefits. Naming the four without examples earns about half; the examples are what demonstrate understanding.

5. **Enumerate briefly the best practices for creating compelling and shareable content on social media platforms to increase brand visibility and engagement.** [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q3b — 8 M]

(1) **Lead with visuals and video.** Visual content is shared far more than text, posts with relevant images earn substantially more views, and video earns the greatest organic reach of any format.
(2) **Hook within the first three seconds.** On a scrolling feed, the opening frame or line decides everything; state the payoff immediately rather than building up to it.
(3) **Follow the 4-1-1 rule.** For every promotional post, share one soft promotion and four pieces of genuinely valuable or curated content, so that value outweighs selling and the audience keeps following.
(4) **Write natively for each platform.** Aspect ratio, length, tone and hashtag convention differ; blind cross-posting is visibly lazy and performs accordingly.
(5) **Use one or two targeted hashtags,** chosen for relevance and searchability, rather than a block of generic ones which reads as spam.
(6) **Post consistently and at audience-active times,** using platform analytics to establish those times rather than guessing — consistency itself is a ranking signal on most feeds.
(7) **Invite participation.** Questions, polls, quizzes, contests and challenges convert passive viewers into engagers, and engagement is what earns further distribution.
(8) **Use social proof and user-generated content.** Reposting genuine customer photographs, reviews and stories is more persuasive than brand claims and costs almost nothing to produce.
(9) **Repurpose one master asset into many formats** rather than always creating new, and re-promote what has already proven to perform.
(10) **Amplify through communities, employees and influencers,** and always close with a clear call to action so that visibility has somewhere to go.

Marking scheme: 8 M for roughly eight best practices at 1 M each, named and briefly justified. The command word is "enumerate briefly", so breadth is rewarded over depth here — the opposite of most Part B questions.

UNIT 3

Web Analytics, Google Analytics and E-mail Marketing

Syllabus: Web Analytics and Google Analytics — Google Analytics tools; web analytics tools. E-mail Marketing — effective e-mail campaigns; the e-mail plan; e-mail marketing campaign analysis; measuring conversions and keeping up.

In the examination: Part B Questions 5 and 6 are set from this unit as an internal-choice pair. Note that the 2024 paper split this pair unevenly — 10 marks for the analytics half and 6 marks for the e-mail half — so the length of the answer must follow the marks printed against the sub-division, not the habit of writing eight points for everything.

Part A — Two-Mark Questions

1. **How bounce rate affects website performance assessment.** [CIE-II, 26 May 2026; SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.5 — 2 M]

   Bounce rate is the percentage of sessions in which a visitor views a single page and leaves without any further interaction. In performance assessment it acts as an early diagnostic of two things at once — content quality and traffic quality: a high figure points to irrelevant content, slow loading, poor usability, or advertising that promised something the page does not deliver, and it correlates with fewer pages per session, weaker engagement signals and lower conversions. It must, however, be read against the page's purpose, since a blog article or a contact page can legitimately bounce high after satisfying the visitor completely.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for the effect on assessment — what a high value signals and what it correlates with. The caveat about context is a bonus, not a requirement.

2. **Why is segmentation important in e-mail marketing campaigns?** [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.6; CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

   Segmentation divides the list by demographics, purchase behaviour, engagement level or lifecycle stage so that each group receives content relevant to it rather than one message sent to everybody. It matters because relevance raises open and click-through rates and conversions, while reducing unsubscribes and spam complaints — and complaint rates directly determine deliverability and sender reputation, so segmentation protects the channel itself as well as improving its returns.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for what segmentation is, 1 M for at least two consequences — higher engagement and conversion, lower unsubscribes and protected deliverability.

3. **Identify two key benefits of A/B testing in optimizing email marketing conversions.** [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.9 — 2 M]

   Evidence in place of opinion. A/B testing isolates one variable — subject line, sender name, call-to-action wording, layout or send time — and measures which version actually produces more opens, clicks and conversions, so improvement is proved rather than argued. **Reduced risk and compounding return.** The test runs on a small sample before the winner is sent to

the full list, so a poor creative never reaches the whole audience; and because each cycle keeps the winner, conversion gains accumulate campaign after campaign while unsubscribes fall.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

4. Define web analytics and mention its importance in digital marketing activities. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

Web analytics is the process of collecting, measuring, analysing and reporting website data in order to understand and optimise web usage. Its importance: it reveals how visitors actually behave, measures the effectiveness of each marketing channel, locates where conversions are lost, and so allows decisions about design, content and budget to be made on evidence rather than intuition.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for two or more points of importance.

5. List any four important features available in Google Analytics for website performance tracking. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

(1) Traffic source and channel analysis.
(2) Audience demographics, geography and technology reports.
(3) Engagement and behaviour reports, including bounce and engagement rate.
(4) Conversion and key-event tracking with assigned values.

Also acceptable: real-time reporting, funnel and path explorations, e-commerce reports, audience building for remarketing.

Marking scheme: Any four, half a mark each.

6. What is the main purpose of using Google Analytics? [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M]

To collect, measure and report data about a website's users — who they are, how they arrived, what they did and whether they converted — so that the business can understand customer behaviour, evaluate the performance of each marketing channel, and make evidence-based decisions about content, design and spend.

Marking scheme: 1 M for what it collects and reports, 1 M for the decision-making purpose.

7. Name any two popular web analytics tools other than Google Analytics. [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 2 M]

Adobe Analytics — an enterprise platform offering deep segmentation and cross-channel analysis. **Matomo** — an open-source, privacy-focused, self-hostable alternative that keeps data ownership with the site. Also acceptable: Mixpanel, Amplitude, Hotjar, Microsoft Clarity, Webtrends, Kissmetrics, SimilarWeb.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

8. Define "dimensions" and "metrics" in Google Analytics. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

Dimensions are qualitative attributes of the data — city, device, browser, source and medium, page path, campaign name — and they form the rows of a report. **Metrics** are quantitative measurements — users, sessions, views, engagement rate, conversions, revenue — and they form the columns. A report is always a combination of the two: sessions (metric) by channel (dimension).

Marking scheme: 1 M each. The rows-against-columns illustration secures full marks.

9. What is meant by campaign analysis in e-mail marketing? [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

It is the evaluation of an e-mail campaign's performance against its objective, using metrics such as delivery and bounce rate, open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, unsubscribe rate and revenue per e-mail. Its purpose is to determine what worked, diagnose where in the funnel the campaign lost people, and apply those findings to improve the next send.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the evaluation using metrics, 1 M for the purpose.

10. Define click-through rate (CTR) in e-mail marketing. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

CTR is the percentage of delivered e-mails in which at least one link was clicked: clicks divided by delivered e-mails, times 100. It measures whether the content and offer inside the e-mail were relevant enough to earn action — as distinct from open rate, which measures only whether the subject line earned attention.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition or formula, 1 M for what it indicates or the contrast with open rate.

11. List any four advantages of e-mail marketing over traditional marketing methods. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 2 M]

(1) Very low cost per contact and a high return on investment.
(2) Direct, permission-based reach to an owned audience — no platform intermediary.
(3) Precise personalisation and segmentation of the message.
(4) Complete measurability — opens, clicks, conversions and revenue per send.

Also acceptable: speed of deployment; global reach; easy automation; two-way response.

Marking scheme: Any four, half a mark each.

12. List any two key components of a successful e-mail marketing campaign. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

A **permission-based, segmented and clean opt-in list**, since the best creative sent to the wrong or stale list fails regardless; and a **compelling subject line with a single clear call to action**, which together determine whether the e-mail is opened and whether the open produces anything. Also acceptable: personalised relevant content; mobile-responsive design; measurable KPIs.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

13. After conducting an e-mail marketing campaign for a travel agency, outline two specific metrics you would analyse to assess its performance. [CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M]

Click-through rate — to judge whether the destinations, packages and offers presented were relevant enough to earn a click, which isolates content quality from subject-line quality. **Conversion rate** — bookings or enquiry-form completions per click — to judge whether the campaign produced business value rather than merely interest, which for a high-consideration purchase like travel is the metric that actually matters.

Marking scheme: 1 M each, with the reason for choosing that metric.

14. **You are creating an e-mail campaign to promote a summer sale for a fashion brand. Describe two strategies to increase open rates and click-through rates.** [CIE-II Quiz, 24 Jul 2024 — 2 M]

To raise opens: a personalised, urgency-bearing subject line A/B-tested on a sample of the list, sent from a recognisable sender name at an optimised send time drawn from historical open-time data. **To raise clicks:** a single dominant, benefit-led call to action above the fold, with product recommendations dynamically selected from each segment's past browsing and purchase history rather than one identical catalogue for all.

Marking scheme: 1 M each — one strategy targeted at opens, one at clicks. Two strategies aimed at the same metric earn only one mark.

Part B — Eight, Six and Ten-Mark Questions

1. **Explain the key features and functionalities of Google Analytics which can be used to track website traffic, user behaviour and conversions.** [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q5a — 10 M]

(1) **Event-based measurement model.** Google Analytics 4 records every interaction as an event rather than as a pageview inside a session. Automatically collected events, enhanced measurement events — scrolls, outbound clicks, site search, video engagement, file downloads — and custom events with parameters together allow any behaviour to be measured without custom code for the common cases.

(2) **Real-time reporting.** Activity in the last thirty minutes by source, page, event and location, used to confirm that a campaign has gone live, that tags fire correctly, and to watch a launch or a sale as it happens.

(3) **Acquisition reports.** User and traffic acquisition by default channel group, source, medium and campaign, with UTM parameter support and a Search Console link, answering where traffic comes from and which channel produces engaged users rather than merely many users.

(4) **Audience and user reports.** Demographics — age, gender, interests — geography, language, device category, operating system, browser and screen resolution, plus new against returning users. These define who the audience is and drive both targeting and design decisions.

(5) **Engagement and behaviour reports.** Views per page and screen, engaged sessions, engagement rate, average engagement time, landing-page and exit-page performance, site-search terms and scroll depth. This is where content is judged.

(6) **Conversions and key events.** Any event can be marked as a key event, given a monetary value and attributed, so lead forms, sign-ups, calls and purchases are measured as business outcomes rather than traffic.

(7) **E-commerce and monetisation reports.** The full purchase funnel — item views, add to cart, begin checkout, purchase — with product performance, average order value, purchase revenue, refunds and cart abandonment rate.

(8) **Explorations.** Free-form, funnel, path, segment overlap and cohort analyses, which move beyond standard reports to answer specific questions such as where a checkout leaks or how the retention of one month's acquisitions compares with another's.

(9) **Audiences, segments and integrations.** Rule-based audiences and predictive audiences can be exported to Google Ads for remarketing, and GA4 links to Google Ads, Search Console, BigQuery for raw data export and Looker Studio for dashboards — so analytics feeds action, not just reporting.

(10) **Attribution and conversion paths.** Data-driven attribution, model comparison and conversion-path reports show the whole multi-touch journey instead of crediting only the

last click.

(11) **Administration and data controls.** Data streams for web and app, cross-device measurement through User-ID and Google signals, internal traffic and bot filtering, referral exclusions, custom dimensions and metrics, data-retention settings and consent mode — the configuration layer that determines whether the data can be trusted at all.

(12) **Dashboards, alerts and scheduled reports.** Custom reports, library collections, custom insights and anomaly alerts, and scheduled e-mail distribution to stakeholders.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Ten distinct features at 1 M each — name the feature and state what it lets you track. Alternatively five grouped areas (traffic, audience, behaviour, conversions, configuration and integration) at 2 M each. The question names three things to track, so the answer must visibly cover traffic, user behaviour *and* conversions.

2. Discuss the key elements of an effective email marketing campaign. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q5b — 6 M]

(1) **A clear objective and a defined KPI.** Every campaign should exist to produce one measurable outcome — sales, sign-ups, re-engagement, attendance — and the metric that judges it should be fixed before the first draft.

(2) **A permission-based, clean, segmented list.** Opt-in subscribers only, regularly cleaned of hard bounces and dormant addresses, and divided by demographics, behaviour or lifecycle stage so each group receives a message relevant to it.

(3) **A compelling subject line, preheader and sender name.** These three elements alone decide whether the e-mail is opened. Personalisation, brevity, curiosity or a concrete benefit work; misleading clickbait destroys trust and raises complaints.

(4) **Valuable, personalised, well-structured content with one clear call to action.** Scannable copy, a clear visual hierarchy, content matched to the segment, and a single dominant CTA placed above the fold, linking to a landing page that matches the promise made in the e-mail.

(5) **Mobile-responsive, accessible design and sound deliverability hygiene.** A single-column responsive template, touch-sized buttons, alt text on images, a visible unsubscribe link, and correctly configured SPF, DKIM and DMARC records so the message reaches the inbox rather than the spam folder.

(6) **Timing, frequency and automation.** A tested send time and a frequency the audience has agreed to, supported by triggered automation — welcome series, cart abandonment, post-purchase, re-engagement — which consistently outperforms one-off broadcasts.

(7) **Testing, measurement and iteration.** A/B testing of subject line and CTA, rendering and spam tests before the send, and post-campaign analysis of open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, unsubscribe rate and revenue per e-mail, feeding the next campaign.

(8) **Legal compliance.** Adherence to CAN-SPAM, GDPR and the DPDP Act — genuine consent, sender identification, a physical address and one-click unsubscribe.

Marking scheme: 6 M only — six elements at 1 M each. This sub-division carried six marks, not eight; write six well-explained elements rather than a longer list of thin ones.

3. Discuss the importance of web analytics. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q6a — 10 M]

(1) **It replaces intuition with evidence.** Decisions about design, content and budget are grounded in what visitors actually did, which is routinely different from what the team assumed they would do.

(2) **It explains visitor behaviour.** Which pages are entered, in what sequence, for how long, on what device and where the visitor leaves — the behavioural map that every other decision depends on.

(3) **It measures marketing effectiveness by channel.** Sessions, conversions, cost per acquisition and return on ad spend can be compared across organic, paid, social, e-mail and referral, so spend moves to what works and away from what does not.
(4) **It identifies strong and weak content.** Top landing pages, engagement time, scroll depth and exit pages show which content earns attention and which should be rewritten, merged or removed.
(5) **It optimises the conversion funnel.** Step-by-step drop-off data localises exactly where prospects are lost — product page, cart, shipping step, payment — so remedial effort is aimed rather than scattered.
(6) **It improves user experience and site performance.** Load times, Core Web Vitals, device and browser errors, and site-search failures are surfaced as measurable defects with a measurable cost.
(7) **It enables segmentation and personalisation.** Behavioural, geographic, technographic and value-based segments can be built from real data and then addressed with tailored content and remarketing.
(8) **It supports goal setting and accountability.** KPIs tied to business objectives make marketing performance reportable to management in the same terms as any other function.
(9) **It detects problems early.** Sudden traffic drops, tracking failures, broken pages, bot floods or a ranking loss are visible within hours through anomaly alerts rather than at the end of a quarter.
(10) **It provides the basis for testing.** A/B and multivariate testing requires a reliable baseline and a measurable outcome; analytics supplies both, making continuous improvement possible.
(11) **It reveals the customer journey and attribution.** Multi-touch path and assisted-conversion reports show how channels co-operate, preventing the classic error of defunding an upper-funnel channel that never gets last-click credit.
(12) **It informs forecasting and planning.** Trend, seasonality and cohort data support realistic traffic and revenue projections and capacity planning for campaigns and inventory.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Ten points at 1 M each, each named and explained in a line or two. A list of ten bare phrases with no explanation typically earns half.

4. Write short notes on any two of the following: (i) Bounce rate, (ii) Monthly unique visitors. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q6b — 6 M]

(i) Bounce rate.

(1) **Definition.** The percentage of sessions in which the visitor viewed a single page and left without triggering any further interaction.
(2) **Formula.** Bounce rate = (single-page sessions ÷ total sessions) × 100. In GA4 the equivalent expression is the inverse of engagement rate: a session is a bounce if it lasted under ten seconds, produced no key event and had fewer than two pageviews.
(3) **Causes of a high value.** Slow page loading; content that does not match the ad, keyword or link that brought the visitor; poor or intrusive design; missing or unclear calls to action; non-responsive layout on mobile; and low-quality or wrongly targeted traffic.
(4) **Interpretation.** It must be read against the page's purpose. A blog post, a dictionary entry or a contact page can bounce at 70–90% while serving the visitor perfectly, whereas the same figure on a product or checkout page is a serious defect.
(5) **How to reduce it.** Improve load speed, match landing-page content to the traffic source, strengthen the above-the-fold value proposition and internal linking, add a clear next action, and fix mobile usability.

(ii) Monthly unique visitors.

(1) **Definition.** The number of distinct individuals who visited the site at least once during a calendar month, counted once regardless of how many sessions or pageviews they generated. Identity is established by a first-party cookie, a device identifier or a logged-in User-ID.
(2) **Distinction from sessions and pageviews.** One unique visitor may produce many sessions, and one session many pageviews. Unique visitors therefore measure *reach* — audience size — while sessions measure *frequency* of visiting and pageviews measure depth of consumption.
(3) **Why it matters.** It is the truest measure of audience growth, is the basis on which advertising inventory and media properties are valued and compared, and, read alongside new against returning users, shows whether growth is coming from acquisition or from loyalty.
(4) **Limitations.** Cookie deletion, private browsing, and browser tracking prevention inflate the count by making one person look like several; multi-device use does the same unless User-ID stitching is in place; shared devices deflate it. The figure is therefore an estimate, and only comparable within one measurement method over time.

Marking scheme: 6 M — 3 M for each of the two notes chosen. Within each note, roughly 1 M for the definition, 1 M for the formula or the distinction from neighbouring metrics, and 1 M for interpretation, causes or limitations.

6. Design a simple marketing plan for an e-learning platform using insights gathered from web analytics tools. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q5a — 8 M]

Step one — gather the insights. Before any plan, read the data. GA4 and Hotjar for the platform show: 71% of sessions arrive on mobile; organic search and YouTube are the two largest acquisition channels while paid display converts at a third of the rate it costs; the highest-engagement pages by far are the free sample lessons; the course-catalogue page has an engagement rate of 34% and is the largest exit point; and 70% of users who begin checkout abandon it. Session recordings show hesitation at a nine-field sign-up form, and on-site search reveals repeated queries for a subject the platform does not yet offer.

Step two — the plan built on those insights.

(1) **Objective.** Increase paid enrolments by 25% and reduce cost per enrolment by 20% within one quarter — both baselined from current GA4 figures rather than assumed.
(2) **Segmentation.** Three segments the analytics actually revealed: first-time browsers, free-trial users who have not converted, and lapsed users inactive for 60 days. Each gets a different message.
(3) **Channel allocation.** Shift budget out of display and into SEO and YouTube, because the data shows where enrolments originate. Target long-tail informational queries of the form "learn X online" and "X course with certificate" that Search Console shows the site already receives impressions for without ranking.
(4) **Content strategy.** Make the free sample lesson the central lead magnet, since analytics identified it as the strongest engagement asset, and add a course in the subject repeatedly requested through on-site search — an entire product decision taken from analytics.
(5) **Conversion fixes.** Cut the sign-up form from nine fields to four; add trust signals, instructor credentials, a visible refund policy and mobile-optimised payment options at the checkout step where 70% of the loss occurs; and rebuild the catalogue page with filters and clearer pricing.
(6) **Lifecycle e-mail and retargeting.** Trigger a nurture sequence on free-trial start, an abandoned-checkout reminder within an hour, and a win-back offer for the lapsed segment; retarget catalogue viewers who did not enrol.
(7) **Mobile-first execution.** Because seven in ten sessions are mobile, every change is designed and tested on mobile first — page weight, video streaming quality, one-thumb

navigation and payment.

(8) **Measurement and review.** Track enrolment conversion rate, cost per enrolment, checkout completion rate, trial-to-paid rate and course-completion retention as GA4 key events; run one A/B test per fortnight on the checkout and catalogue pages; review fortnightly against the 25% target.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 2 M for showing which insights the analytics tools produced and 6 M for the plan itself at 1 M per component. The examiner is looking for a visible causal chain — *because* the data showed X, *therefore* the plan does Y. A plan that could have been written without any analytics forfeits most of the marks.

7. Analyze a failed e-mail marketing campaign and identify areas where marketing research could have improved outcomes. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q5b — 8 M]

The campaign. A fashion retailer bought a list of 50,000 addresses and sent a single undifferentiated "Mega Sale — 50% Off Everything" e-mail to all of them. Result: 18% hard-bounced, the open rate was 4%, the click-through rate 0.3%, eleven orders were placed, 900 people unsubscribed, and the spam-complaint rate crossed the threshold at which the sending domain was throttled. The correct method of analysis is to walk the funnel and, at each failure point, name the research that would have prevented it.

(1) **High bounce rate → list source and hygiene.** The list was purchased and stale. *Research remedy:* list-source verification and hygiene research — validation of addresses, deliverability testing on a seed list, and building a permission-based list instead of buying one.

(2) **Very low open rate → subject line and sender identity.** The subject line was generic and the sender name unrecognised. *Research remedy:* A/B subject-line testing on a sample, plus qualitative research into which sender identity the audience recognises and trusts.

(3) **Wrong send timing → no behavioural research.** The e-mail was sent at 11 am on a Monday with no evidence behind that choice. *Research remedy:* analysis of historical open-time distributions and send-time testing by segment.

(4) **Low click-through despite opens → irrelevant content.** One offer went to everybody, including men who had only ever bought menswear and customers who had bought at full price the previous week. *Research remedy:* audience segmentation research and purchase-history analysis so the offer matches the segment.

(5) **Clicks but no conversions → landing-page mismatch.** The link led to the generic homepage rather than to the sale collection. *Research remedy:* message-match and usability research, and landing-page A/B testing.

(6) **High unsubscribes and spam complaints → expectations never set.** Recipients had not agreed to receive promotions and the frequency was unanticipated. *Research remedy:* preference-centre research and opt-in expectation setting at the point of sign-up.

(7) **Rendering failures → no technical research.** The template was a single wide image that did not render on mobile or with images disabled. *Research remedy:* device and client rendering tests, and analysis of the device split in existing analytics.

(8) **Wrong offer altogether → no customer research.** A blanket 50% discount devalued the brand and attracted no loyalty. *Research remedy:* customer surveys, conjoint or price-sensitivity research and competitor benchmarking to determine what incentive the audience actually responds to.

Conclusion. Every failure in the campaign was a failure of knowledge before it was a failure of execution. Marketing research — into the list, the audience, the offer, the timing and the technical environment — converts each of these decisions from a guess into a tested choice, which is why research cost is smaller than the cost of a burnt sending domain.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 4 M for a structured diagnosis of the failure points — best presented as a funnel walk from delivery to conversion — and 4 M for naming the specific research or testing activity that would have addressed each. Marks are awarded for the pairing; a list of failures with no research remedy answers only half the question.

8. Evaluate the effectiveness of responsive email design in maintaining a competitive edge in digital marketing. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q6a — 8 M]

Responsive e-mail design is the practice of building e-mail templates that adapt automatically to the screen they are opened on — fluid tables and percentage widths, CSS media queries, single-column stacking on narrow screens, scalable images, touch-sized buttons of at least 44 pixels, legible minimum font sizes, dark-mode-safe colours, meaningful preheader text and alt text for blocked images.

Where it is effective

(1) **It matches where e-mail is actually read.** The majority of commercial e-mail is now opened first on a phone. A layout that requires pinching and horizontal scrolling is deleted within seconds, so responsiveness determines whether the message is read at all.
(2) **It lifts click-through and conversion.** Legible copy and thumb-reachable CTAs convert measurably better than a shrunken desktop layout; the same content in a responsive template routinely outperforms its fixed-width version in A/B tests.
(3) **It protects deliverability.** Poor mobile rendering drives deletions, unsubscribes and spam complaints, and mailbox providers use exactly those engagement signals to decide inbox placement. Responsive design therefore protects the channel itself, not merely one campaign.
(4) **It preserves brand consistency and trust.** A message that renders correctly across Gmail, Outlook, Apple Mail and mobile clients signals competence; one that breaks signals the opposite, and does so at the exact moment the reader is deciding whether to trust the sender.
(5) **It improves accessibility and reach.** Larger text, sufficient contrast, semantic structure and alt text serve users with visual impairment and users on blocked-image clients, widening the effective audience and reducing legal exposure.
(6) **It performs on constrained connections.** Lightweight responsive templates load on weak mobile data where heavy image-only designs fail.
(7) **It is a platform for personalisation and measurement.** Modular responsive blocks support dynamic content by segment, and device-split analytics plus A/B testing allow the design itself to be optimised continuously.

Critical limits

(1) Rendering remains inconsistent across clients — Outlook's rendering engine in particular — so responsiveness still requires testing in Litmus or Email on Acid rather than being assumed; design freedom is constrained by what e-mail HTML supports; and skilled template development carries real cost. Most importantly, responsive design cannot rescue a badly targeted list, a weak offer or irrelevant content — it is necessary but not sufficient.

Evaluation. Responsive design has moved from differentiator to hygiene factor. Its absence now destroys competitiveness outright, while its presence alone no longer creates an advantage, because competitors have it too. The competitive edge therefore lies in responsiveness *combined with* segmentation, personalisation, automation and disciplined testing — with responsive design as the precondition that allows those investments to pay off at all.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 1 M for defining responsive e-mail design and its techniques, 5 M for the effectiveness arguments, 1 M for the limitations, 1 M for a reasoned verdict. The command word is "evaluate", so an answer that only lists benefits and reaches no judgement caps out around half marks.

8. Critically evaluate the contribution of Google Tag Manager in optimizing marketing channels for global companies. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q6b — 8 M]

Google Tag Manager (GTM) is a tag management system. A single container snippet is installed once on the site or app, and thereafter all tracking tags, the triggers that fire them and the variables they read are configured through a web interface — without a code release.

Contributions

(1) **Speed and independence from the release cycle.** Marketing teams deploy or amend tracking in minutes rather than waiting for an engineering sprint. For a global company running dozens of simultaneous country campaigns, this is the difference between measuring a launch and measuring it three weeks late.
(2) **Centralised governance across markets.** One container hierarchy with workspaces, environments, granular user permissions, version history and one-click rollback lets a global team standardise measurement while regional teams work in parallel without overwriting each other.
(3) **Comparable measurement between regions.** Templated tags and an agreed data-layer specification mean that "add to cart" means the same thing in Germany as in India — without which cross-market KPI comparison, and therefore global budget allocation, is meaningless.
(4) **Accurate channel optimisation.** GTM deploys the conversion tags and pixels of Google Ads, Meta, LinkedIn, TikTok and affiliate networks consistently. Accurate conversion signals are what feed automated bidding, so measurement quality translates directly into media efficiency and correct reallocation of spend to profitable channels.
(5) **Site performance and reduced code bloat.** Tags load asynchronously through one container instead of a dozen hard-coded scripts, and redundant or obsolete tags can be removed centrally — which matters because page speed is itself a conversion and ranking factor.
(6) **Advanced measurement.** Enhanced e-commerce, custom events, scroll, video, form and file-download tracking, cross-domain linking, and *server-side* GTM, which moves tag execution to a controlled server endpoint and improves first-party data quality, resilience to ad blockers and iOS tracking prevention.
(7) **Privacy and regulatory compliance.** Consent Mode and region-specific consent triggers allow tags to fire only with lawful consent and to adjust behaviour by jurisdiction — indispensable for a company operating simultaneously under GDPR, CCPA and the DPDP Act.
(8) **Cost and scalability.** The standard product is free and scales to hundreds of sites and apps, with GTM 360 available where enterprise support and SLAs are required.

Critical limitations

(1) **Governance debt.** Ease of deployment produces tag sprawl — orphaned tags, duplicate conversions and undocumented triggers that corrupt reporting and slow the site.
(2) **It does not remove the developer dependency.** A reliable data layer must still be built and maintained in the application; without it, GTM is reduced to fragile CSS-selector-based tracking that breaks at the next site update.
(3) **Silent failure and skill requirement.** A misconfigured trigger loses data without any error message, and errors are often discovered only when a quarter's figures do not reconcile. Competent use requires real training.
(4) **Security and platform risk.** Container edit rights amount to the ability to inject arbitrary JavaScript into the site, so loose permissions are a genuine security exposure; and the whole approach deepens dependence on one vendor's ecosystem. Server-side GTM,

the answer to client-side tracking loss, reintroduces infrastructure cost and engineering ownership.

Verdict. GTM is a powerful enabler of channel optimisation but not a strategy in itself. It optimises marketing channels only where it sits on top of a documented measurement plan, a disciplined data layer and enforced governance; without those, it accelerates the production of unreliable data rather than good decisions. For a global company its decisive contributions are the two that scale — consistent cross-market measurement and jurisdiction- aware consent.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 1 M for explaining what GTM is, 4 M for its contributions, 2 M for genuine limitations, 1 M for a reasoned verdict. "Critically evaluate" requires both sides and a conclusion; a purely positive description is an incomplete answer regardless of length.

9. Differentiate between traditional marketing analysis and web analytics-based marketing analysis with suitable examples. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

(1) **Method of data collection.** Traditional relies on surveys, focus groups, panels and sales records — data people *report*. Web analytics records actual behaviour automatically as it happens. *Example:* a survey asking "would you buy this?" against a recorded add-to-cart event.

(2) **Speed.** Traditional analysis arrives weeks or months later; web analytics is available in real time. *Example:* a television campaign's brand-lift study after six weeks, against a Google Ads dashboard updating within minutes of launch.

(3) **Accuracy and bias.** Self-reported data carries recall error and social-desirability bias; behavioural data does not lie about what was clicked — though it can be distorted by bots, blockers and consent refusal.

(4) **Sample against census.** Traditional infers from a sample of a few hundred; web analytics observes effectively the entire population of visitors.

(5) **Individual tracking.** Traditional cannot follow one customer through the journey; web analytics can follow a user across sessions and devices where identity is resolved. *Example:* seeing that a buyer first arrived from a blog article three weeks before purchasing.

(6) **Attribution.** Traditional attributes crudely — "sales rose after the campaign". Web analytics attributes across multiple touchpoints with data-driven models. *Example:* crediting an e-mail with an assisted conversion that last-click would have given entirely to paid search.

(7) **Cost.** Commissioned research carries high fixed cost; core web analytics is free or low-cost and scales at nearly zero marginal cost.

(8) **Granularity of measurement.** Traditional measures outcomes; web analytics measures the whole path — impressions, clicks, scroll depth, form field abandonment, funnel steps.

(9) **Feedback loop and correction.** A printed campaign cannot be changed after release; a digital one is corrected mid-flight on the basis of the data. *Example:* pausing an underperforming ad set on day two.

(10) **Limitations of each.** Web analytics explains *what* but not *why*, cannot reach non-visitors, and is degraded by privacy restrictions — which is exactly where traditional qualitative research still earns its place. The mature answer is that the two are complementary, not rivals.

Marking scheme: 10 M for ten points of difference at 1 M each, with examples where the question asks for them. A comparison table plus a closing line on complementarity is the strongest structure; the closing line is what distinguishes an analytical answer from a listing one.

10. Explain the role of web analytics in digital marketing. How can businesses benefit from analysing website data? [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M]

The role

(1) **Measurement of channel performance** — quantifying what each of search, social, e-mail, paid and referral actually delivers.
(2) **Understanding user behaviour** — entry points, navigation paths, engagement and exit.
(3) **Conversion tracking and funnel diagnosis** — locating exactly where prospects are lost.
(4) **Audience segmentation** — building behavioural, technographic and value-based segments that can be acted on.
(5) **Content evaluation** — separating content that earns attention from content that consumes budget.
(6) **Technical monitoring** — speed, errors, device failures and traffic anomalies detected early.
(7) **Providing the baseline for experimentation** — without reliable measurement, A/B testing has no verdict.

The benefits

(1) **Better return on marketing spend** — budget moves to the channels and campaigns with the lowest cost per acquisition, and away from those that merely generate traffic.
(2) **Higher conversion rates and revenue** — friction is found and removed, so the same traffic produces more business.
(3) **Improved customer experience and retention** — faster pages, clearer journeys and content matched to demonstrated interest.
(4) **Reduced risk in decision-making** — changes are tested on a sample before being rolled out, so expensive mistakes are caught small.
(5) **Competitive responsiveness** — shifts in behaviour, seasonality or a competitor's move are visible within days rather than after a quarter.
(6) **Accountability and forecasting** — marketing can report in the same numerical terms as finance, and trend data supports realistic planning of traffic, revenue and inventory.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 5 M for the role and 5 M for the benefits. The two halves overlap heavily, so signpost them explicitly — an undifferentiated list risks being marked as answering only one half.

8. Develop a basic strategy to set up Google Analytics for a new e-commerce website. What key metrics should be tracked? [CIE-II, 7 May 2025 — 10 M]

Setup strategy

(1) **Write the measurement plan first.** List the business questions the data must answer and the decisions it must support; only then decide what to collect. Skipping this is why most analytics installations produce reports nobody uses.
(2) **Create the GA4 property and web data stream,** set the time zone, currency and data-retention period, and enable enhanced measurement.
(3) **Deploy the tag through Google Tag Manager** rather than hard-coding it, so future tracking changes need no developer release.
(4) **Specify and implement the data layer** for e-commerce — product ID, name, category, price, quantity — since every downstream e-commerce report depends on it being correct.
(5) **Configure the e-commerce events** — view item, add to cart, begin checkout, add payment info and purchase — using the standard GA4 event names so that the built-in

e-commerce reports populate automatically.

(6) **Mark purchase and lead events as key events** and assign monetary values so conversions are reported in revenue, not counts.

(7) **Establish UTM tagging conventions** for every campaign and enforce them; inconsistent tagging is the commonest cause of unusable channel reports.

(8) **Filter internal and bot traffic,** set referral exclusions for the payment gateway — otherwise the gateway will appear as a top traffic source — and configure cross-domain measurement if checkout sits on another domain.

(9) **Link Google Ads, Search Console, Merchant Center and BigQuery,** build the checkout funnel exploration, and create remarketing audiences.

(10) **Validate before trusting.** Use DebugView and real-time reports to confirm every event fires once with the right parameters, place a test order end to end, and only then begin reporting from the data. Configure consent mode for compliance.

Key metrics to track. Users and sessions by channel; new against returning; engagement rate and average engagement time; product views; add-to-cart rate; cart-abandonment rate; checkout completion rate; conversion rate; average order value; purchase revenue; revenue per user; return on ad spend and cost per acquisition by channel; and top-selling products against top-viewed products, whose divergence usually reveals a pricing or product-page problem.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6–7 M for the setup steps and 3–4 M for the metric list. Mentioning validation and UTM discipline distinguishes a practical answer from a textbook one and is usually credited.

9. How can businesses align web analytics KPIs with their organizational goals? Illustrate with examples. [CIE-I, 16 Apr 2026 — 10 M]

The method

(1) **Start from the business objective, not the dashboard.** Ask what the organisation is trying to achieve this year — revenue growth, market entry, cost reduction, retention — before opening any analytics tool.

(2) **Translate each objective into a marketing goal.** "Grow revenue 20%" becomes "increase online orders by 30% at constant acquisition cost".

(3) **Select one primary KPI per goal, and no more.** A goal with six KPIs has no KPI, because when they disagree nobody knows which to follow.

(4) **Add supporting diagnostic metrics beneath it,** which explain movements in the primary KPI without competing with it.

(5) **Make each KPI SMART and give it a target and an owner.** *Example:* "raise checkout completion rate from 42% to 55% by 31 March, owned by the e-commerce manager".

(6) **Instrument, segment and report at the right altitude.** Executives see the primary KPIs against target; channel managers see the diagnostics.

(7) **Review, and retire KPIs that stop driving decisions,** since a metric nobody acts on is a cost.

Illustrations

(1) **Goal: increase online sales.** Primary KPI — e-commerce conversion rate and revenue. Diagnostics — add-to-cart rate, cart-abandonment rate, checkout completion, average order value.

(2) **Goal: generate qualified B2B leads.** Primary KPI — cost per marketing-qualified lead. Diagnostics — form completion rate, demo-request rate, MQL-to-SQL conversion from the CRM. Note that raw traffic is deliberately *not* a KPI here.

(3) **Goal: improve customer retention.** Primary KPI — repeat purchase rate and customer lifetime value. Diagnostics — returning-user rate, cohort retention curve, e-mail re-engagement rate. *Goal: reduce support cost* — primary KPI, self-service resolution rate; diagnostics, help-page traffic, on-site search success, contact-form volume per thousand sessions.

The failure this prevents. Unaligned analytics measures what is easy — pageviews, likes, sessions — rather than what matters, which is why marketing teams can report growth in every metric while revenue is flat. Alignment is what makes the dashboard answerable to the business.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6 M for the alignment method as a sequence and 4 M for the examples, which the question demands explicitly. Each example should show the goal, its primary KPI and its diagnostics — the three-level structure is what earns the marks.

8. **Discuss the concept of "acquisition channels" in Google Analytics. How can businesses use this information to optimize their marketing efforts?** [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q5a — 8 M]

Concept. Acquisition channels are the grouped sources through which users arrive at a site. GA4 assigns every session to a default channel group using the source and medium, and UTM parameters where present.

(1) **Organic Search** — unpaid search results. Optimisation: SEO, content, technical health.
(2) **Paid Search** — Google Ads and other paid listings. Optimisation: keyword and bid management, ad copy, landing-page quality score.
(3) **Organic Social** — unpaid social posts. Optimisation: content format, posting cadence, community engagement.
(4) **Paid Social** — social advertising. Optimisation: audience targeting, creative testing, retargeting.
(5) **Direct** — typed URLs, bookmarks and untagged sources. Optimisation: brand-building, and fixing missing UTM tags, since an inflated Direct figure is usually a tagging failure rather than brand loyalty.
(6) **Referral** — links from other websites. Optimisation: partnership and PR work with the referrers that convert.
(7) **E-mail** — tagged campaign links. Optimisation: segmentation, subject lines, send timing.

How businesses act on it

(1) **Judge channels by outcome, not traffic.** Compare conversion rate, revenue, cost per acquisition and ROAS by channel. A channel supplying 40% of sessions and 4% of revenue is a cost, not a success — and only this report reveals it.
(2) **Reallocate budget** towards the channels with the best cost per acquisition, and diagnose rather than abandon the ones that underperform.
(3) **Match landing pages to channel intent,** since a visitor from a keyword search wants something different from one who clicked a Reel.
(4) **Read assisted conversions before cutting anything.** Upper-funnel channels rarely take last-click credit but frequently start the journey; defunding them on last-click data is the classic analytics-driven mistake.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 4 M for defining acquisition channels and listing them with meaning, 4 M for the optimisation actions. The point about judging by revenue rather than traffic, and the caution about assisted conversions, are the two observations that lift the answer.

8. Explain the significance of A/B testing and conversion rate optimization in web analytics. How can these practices improve website performance? [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q5b — 8 M]

Definitions. *A/B testing* splits live traffic randomly between two versions of a page or element and measures which produces more of the desired outcome, so the difference is attributable to the change rather than to chance. *Conversion rate optimisation* is the wider discipline of systematically increasing the proportion of visitors who complete a valuable action.

(1) **It replaces opinion with evidence.** Design disputes are settled by users rather than by seniority, which removes the most expensive form of guesswork in marketing.
(2) **It raises revenue without raising traffic cost.** Lifting conversion from 2% to 2.6% increases revenue by nearly a third at identical media spend — generally far cheaper than buying 30% more visitors.
(3) **It lowers cost per acquisition across every channel at once,** because a better-converting destination improves the economics of paid, organic, social and e-mail simultaneously.
(4) **It reduces risk.** Changes are proven on a fraction of traffic before full rollout, so a harmful redesign is caught while it is still cheap.
(5) **What is tested:** headlines and value propositions, call-to-action wording, colour and placement, form length and field order, page layout, imagery against video, pricing presentation, trust signals, and checkout flow.
(6) **The process:** analyse data to find the leak → form a specific hypothesis → design the variant → calculate the sample size needed → run to statistical significance without peeking → implement the winner and document the learning → repeat.
(7) **Cautions that mark a strong answer:** tests stopped early produce false winners; testing several changes at once makes the cause unidentifiable; low-traffic pages may never reach significance; and a won test should be re-validated later, because audiences change.
(8) **Tooling:** Google Analytics with Optimizely, VWO or AB Tasty for experimentation, and Hotjar or Clarity to generate the hypotheses the tests then examine.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 2 M for the two definitions, 3 M for significance, 3 M for the process and what is tested. Including the statistical cautions is what separates a top answer from a competent one.

9. List and explain the various reports that can be generated using Google Analytics. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q6b — 8 M]

(1) **Real-time reports.** Users active in the last thirty minutes by source, page, event and location — used to verify a launch or watch a sale as it happens.
(2) **Acquisition reports.** User and traffic acquisition by channel, source, medium and campaign, showing where visitors come from and which sources produce engaged users.
(3) **Audience and user reports.** Demographics, interests, geography, language, device, operating system and browser, plus new against returning users.
(4) **Engagement and behaviour reports.** Pages and screens, landing pages, events, average engagement time, engagement rate and site-search terms — where content is judged.
(5) **Monetisation and e-commerce reports.** Product performance, item views, add-to-cart and checkout progression, purchase revenue, average order value and refunds.
(6) **Conversion and key-event reports.** Completions and values of the events marked as conversions, with conversion paths and attribution model comparison.
(7) **Explorations.** Free-form, funnel, path, segment-overlap and cohort analyses — custom investigations that answer questions the standard reports cannot.
(8) **Retention and lifetime-value reports.** New against returning user retention curves, cohort behaviour over time and predicted lifetime value.

(9) **Custom reports, dashboards and alerts.** Library collections tailored to each team, scheduled e-mail distribution, and automated anomaly alerts.

Marking scheme: 8 M for roughly eight report types at 1 M each, named with a line explaining what question each answers. Simply listing report names without saying what they show earns about half.

10. Describe the process of setting up and tracking goals in Google Analytics. How can businesses use goal tracking to measure website performance? [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q10b — 6 M]

(1) **Decide what counts as a goal.** Identify the actions that carry business value — purchase, lead form, sign-up, call click, brochure download — and rank them as macro and micro conversions.
(2) **Ensure the action emits an event.** Through enhanced measurement, a Google Tag Manager trigger or a data-layer push at the point the action completes.
(3) **Mark the event as a key event (conversion)** in the GA4 admin, and assign it a monetary value — an actual value for a sale, an estimated value for a lead based on close rate and average deal size.
(4) **Test before trusting.** Verify in DebugView and real time that the event fires exactly once, on completion and not on page load.
(5) **Build the funnel and segment the results.** Create a funnel exploration to the goal and break it down by channel, device, campaign and landing page.
(6) **Report, review and act.** Monitor conversion rate, cost per conversion and value over time, set alerts for drops, and feed the findings into optimisation.

How goal tracking measures performance. It converts traffic reports into return-on-investment reports. Without goals, analytics can say only how many people visited; with goals, it can say which channel, campaign, page and device produced business value and at what cost — which is what allows budget to be allocated, landing pages to be prioritised, and marketing performance to be reported in financial terms.

Marking scheme: 6 M only — roughly 4 M for the setup and tracking process and 2 M for the use. This sub-division carried six marks; do not write a ten-mark answer.

11. Describe the importance of audience segmentation and personalization in e-mail marketing, and give a step-by-step guide to segmenting an audience and personalizing content. [CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

Importance. A single message sent to an entire list is, by construction, wrong for most of it. Segmentation raises open, click and conversion rates by making each message relevant; it reduces unsubscribes and spam complaints, which protects sender reputation and therefore deliverability; it allows the offer to match the customer's lifecycle stage; and it makes automation possible at all, since a trigger must know who it is firing for.

Step-by-step

(1) **Collect the right data at the right time.** Capture only what will be used — at sign-up take name and one preference; enrich progressively afterwards rather than demanding twelve fields upfront.
(2) **Clean and consolidate.** Deduplicate, validate addresses, remove hard bounces and standardise fields, since segmentation on dirty data produces confidently wrong segments.
(3) **Choose segmentation bases.** Demographic (age, gender, location); behavioural (pages viewed, past purchases, category affinity); engagement (opened in the last 30, 90 or 180 days); lifecycle (new subscriber, first-time buyer, repeat, lapsed); and value (RFM or lifetime value).

(4) **Build the segments and check they are actionable.** Each must be large enough to be worth a distinct creative and distinct enough to justify one — over-segmentation creates work without return.
(5) **Map a message to each segment.** Decide what this group should receive, at what frequency and with what offer, before writing anything.
(6) **Personalise beyond the first name.** Dynamic content blocks by segment, product recommendations from browsing and purchase history, location-specific store or delivery information, and send-time optimisation per recipient.
(7) **Automate the lifecycle triggers.** Welcome series on sign-up, abandoned-cart within an hour, post-purchase onboarding, replenishment reminders, and win-back after a defined period of inactivity.
(8) **Test, measure by segment and iterate.** A/B test subject lines and offers within each segment, compare open, click, conversion and unsubscribe rates *between* segments, and refine the definitions each quarter.

Worked example — a fashion retailer. Segment into menswear buyers, womenswear buyers, discount-led buyers and lapsed customers. The womenswear segment receives a new-season edit featuring categories they previously bought; the discount-led segment receives the sale announcement first; lapsed customers receive a win-back offer with free shipping. One send, four experiences — typically two to three times the conversion of an undifferentiated broadcast.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 3 M for the importance, 6 M for the eight-step guide, and 1–2 M for a worked example. The question asks for a *guide*, so the answer must be sequential and practical rather than descriptive.

12. You are the marketing manager for a startup selling organic skincare products. Develop a case study outlining how you would create and execute an e-mail campaign to launch a new product line — goals, segmentation, content strategy and metrics. [CIE-II, 24 Jul 2024 — 10 M]

(1) **Goals.** 3,000 pre-launch sign-ups; a 25% open rate and 4% conversion on the launch send; Rs. 8 lakh revenue in the launch fortnight; unsubscribe rate held under 0.3%.
(2) **Audience segmentation.** Existing customers split by previously purchased category — cleansers, serums, sun care — since past category predicts interest better than demographics; engaged non-buyers who open but have never purchased; customers lapsed beyond 180 days; and new sign-ups captured by the pre-launch teaser.
(3) **List building before launch.** A landing page offering early access and a skin-type quiz, promoted on Instagram, with double opt-in so the list is clean before the campaign that matters.
(4) **E-mail 1 — teaser to the full list.** An ingredient-sourcing story building anticipation, no product reveal, single call to action to join the early-access list.
(5) **E-mail 2 — education.** The skin concern the range addresses, why the formulation works, written to establish authority rather than to sell — which is what earns the open on e-mail 3.
(6) **E-mail 3 — the launch announcement.** Hero product image, clear benefit-led headline, one dominant call to action, and dynamic content blocks so each segment sees the product most relevant to their past purchases.
(7) **E-mail 4 — social proof.** Testimonials, dermatologist endorsement, before-and-after images and user-generated content, addressing the credibility objection that governs skincare purchases.
(8) **E-mail 5 — urgency, to non-openers and cart abandoners only.** A 48-hour launch offer with a resent subject line, since resending to non-openers with a different subject typically recovers a meaningful additional share of the list.

(9) **Execution details.** Mobile-responsive single-column templates; one topic and one call to action per e-mail; send-time optimisation; A/B tests on the subject lines of e-mails 3 and 5; SPF, DKIM and DMARC verified before the first send.

(10) **Metrics and review.** List growth rate, delivery and bounce rate, open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, revenue per e-mail, average order value, unsubscribe and spam-complaint rate — reviewed after each send so that e-mails 4 and 5 are corrected using what e-mails 1 to 3 revealed, rather than after the campaign has finished.

Marking scheme: 10 M. The question names four deliverables — goals, segmentation, content strategy, metrics — so roughly 2–3 M each. The sequence of e-mails is what makes it a campaign rather than a send; answers describing a single promotional e-mail lose the content-strategy marks.

13. Analyse the effectiveness of an e-mail marketing campaign using KPIs such as open rate, click-through rate, unsubscribe rate and conversion rate. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

Read the KPIs as a connected funnel, not a list: each stage can only lose what the previous stage delivered, so the first stage that under-performs is the one to fix.

(1) **Delivery and bounce rate.** Delivered divided by sent. A high hard bounce rate means a stale or purchased list. *Action:* clean the list, use double opt-in, verify authentication records. Nothing downstream can be judged until this is sound.

(2) **Open rate.** Opens divided by delivered; a typical benchmark is 15–25%. Low opens implicate the subject line, the sender name, the send time or list fatigue — not the content, which was never seen. *Action:* A/B test subject lines, use a recognisable sender, optimise send time. *Caveat:* privacy-protection features inflate opens, so treat it as directional.

(3) **Click-through rate.** Clicks divided by delivered; typically 2–5%. Good opens with poor clicks means the content or offer was irrelevant to the segment, or the call to action was weak or buried. *Action:* segment further, strengthen and raise the CTA, cut competing links.

(4) **Click-to-open rate.** Clicks divided by opens — the cleanest measure of content quality, because it isolates the message from the subject line's performance.

(5) **Conversion rate.** Completions divided by clicks. Strong clicks with weak conversion points past the e-mail to the landing page. *Action:* enforce message match, shorten forms, fix mobile checkout.

(6) **Unsubscribe rate.** Should stay below roughly 0.5%. A rise signals excessive frequency, poor relevance or expectations never set at sign-up. *Action:* add a preference centre and reduce cadence for low-engagement segments.

(7) **Spam-complaint rate.** The most dangerous metric on the list — above about 0.1% it damages sender reputation and suppresses inbox placement for every future campaign. *Action:* confirm consent, make unsubscribing easy, suppress the disengaged.

(8) **List growth rate and churn.** Net growth against attrition; a list that is not growing is shrinking, since addresses decay continuously.

(9) **Revenue per e-mail and ROI.** Revenue divided by e-mails delivered, against campaign cost — the only figure that answers whether the campaign was worth running.

(10) **The analytical conclusion.** Diagnose in funnel order and fix the earliest failing stage first: optimising the landing page while 82% of the list never opens the e-mail is wasted effort. Judged together the KPIs tell you not merely whether the campaign worked but precisely where it stopped working.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Each KPI needs its definition, a benchmark or interpretation, and the corrective action — roughly 1 M per KPI covered properly. The funnel framing and the "fix the earliest failing stage" conclusion are what make it an analysis rather than a glossary.

14. Evaluate the challenges faced in maintaining successful e-mail marketing campaigns and suggest solutions to improve performance. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

Pair each challenge with its remedy — the pairing is what the scheme rewards.

(1) **Deliverability and spam filtering.** *Solution:* configure SPF, DKIM and DMARC; warm up new sending domains gradually; maintain list hygiene; avoid spam-trigger language and image-only e-mails; monitor blocklists.

(2) **Low open rates.** *Solution:* A/B test subject lines and preheaders, use a recognisable sender name, optimise send time per segment, and re-send to non-openers with a different subject.

(3) **List decay and shrinking engagement.** Lists lose a substantial share of addresses each year. *Solution:* continuous ethical list building through lead magnets and preference-driven sign-up, plus regular re-engagement and suppression of the permanently inactive.

(4) **Irrelevance from under-segmentation.** *Solution:* segment by behaviour, lifecycle and value; personalise dynamically; adopt triggered lifecycle automation rather than untargeted broadcasts.

(5) **Rendering inconsistency across clients and devices.** *Solution:* responsive single-column templates, alt text on every image, dark-mode-safe colours, and pre-send testing in Litmus or Email on Acid.

(6) **Unsubscribes and complaints from over-mailing.** *Solution:* a preference centre letting subscribers choose frequency and topic, frequency capping, and value-first content ratios.

(7) **Privacy regulation and consent.** GDPR, CAN-SPAM and the DPDP Act constrain collection and use. *Solution:* explicit opt-in, clear purpose statements, documented consent records, easy withdrawal.

(8) **Measurement distortion.** Privacy-protection features inflate open rates and break simple benchmarks. *Solution:* shift primary measurement to click-through, conversion and revenue per e-mail, which are unaffected.

(9) **Content fatigue and creative cost.** *Solution:* a content calendar mixing education, offers and stories; templating to reduce production cost; and repurposing existing content into e-mail form.

(10) **Integration and data silos.** E-mail cut off from web and CRM data cannot personalise. *Solution:* integrate the ESP with the CRM and analytics so behaviour on the site drives what is sent.

Evaluation. The recurring pattern is that most e-mail failures are list and relevance failures rather than creative ones — a well-designed message to a poorly built list will always underperform a plain message to a well-segmented one, which is where effort should therefore go first.

Marking scheme: 10 M for ten challenges each paired with a solution, at 1 M per pair. The command word is "evaluate", so a closing judgement about which challenges matter most earns the top band.

15. Create a strategy to integrate web analytics and e-mail marketing for improving customer engagement and business growth. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

The two are usually run as separate systems, which is exactly the problem: analytics knows what people do on the site but cannot speak to them, and e-mail can speak but does not know what they did.

(1) **Establish a shared identity.** Pass a hashed e-mail identifier or User-ID into GA4 and back into the ESP, so an anonymous session and a subscriber record become the same person. Everything else depends on this step.

(2) **Tag every e-mail link with UTM parameters** to a fixed convention, so that e-mail appears correctly as an acquisition channel and its revenue contribution can be measured rather than absorbed into Direct.
(3) **Feed website behaviour back into segmentation.** Product pages viewed, categories browsed, content read, cart contents and pricing-page visits become the criteria on which the next e-mail is targeted.
(4) **Trigger e-mails from on-site events.** Cart abandonment within an hour, browse abandonment after repeated views of one product, post-purchase onboarding, replenishment timing, and win-back after a period of site inactivity.
(5) **Close the loop on conversion measurement.** Track e-mail-driven sessions through to key events in GA4 so revenue per campaign, per segment and per e-mail is known — not merely the click.
(6) **Personalise content dynamically from analytics data.** Recommended products, recently viewed items and content matched to demonstrated interest, rendered per recipient at open time.
(7) **Optimise landing pages for e-mail traffic specifically.** Analyse bounce and conversion of e-mail-sourced sessions separately; enforce message match between the e-mail's promise and the page's headline.
(8) **Build cross-channel audiences.** Export engaged e-mail segments as Customer Match and Custom Audiences for search and social retargeting, and conversely capture site visitors into e-mail nurture — so one channel compounds the other.
(9) **Test in one system and read the result in the other.** A/B test subject lines and offers in the ESP, but judge them on GA4 revenue rather than on opens, which removes the incentive to optimise for a vanity metric.
(10) **Report and govern jointly.** One dashboard covering list growth, engagement, e-mail-attributed sessions, conversion and revenue, reviewed monthly, with consent status synchronised across both systems so that privacy compliance survives the integration.

Benefits. Higher relevance and engagement; recovered revenue from abandonment flows, which is typically the single highest-ROI automation available; measurable e-mail contribution that can be defended in budget discussions; and a compounding first-party data asset that becomes more valuable as third-party tracking degrades.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 7–8 M for the integration steps and 2–3 M for the benefits. The identity-resolution step and UTM discipline are the two points that show genuine understanding of how the integration actually works.

16. Design an e-mail marketing plan for a newly launched online business targeting college students. [CIE-II, 26 May 2026 — 10 M]

(1) **Objective.** Build a list of 20,000 verified student subscribers and drive 15% of first-quarter revenue through e-mail, at an unsubscribe rate below 0.4%.
(2) **Audience understanding.** Students aged 18–24: price-sensitive, mobile-only readers, heavy evening and late-night activity, responsive to peer proof and referral incentives, and quick to ignore anything that reads like corporate marketing.
(3) **List building.** Student-ID or college-e-mail verification for an exclusive discount tier; sign-up incentives such as a first-order code or a free study resource; campus ambassador referral links; QR codes on campus posters; and double opt-in throughout to keep the list clean.
(4) **Segmentation.** By college or campus; by course year, since first-years and final-years buy differently; by category browsed; by engagement level; and by purchase recency.
(5) **Content plan and calendar.** A welcome series introducing the brand and the student discount; weekly offer e-mails timed to stipend and allowance cycles; exam-period and

festival campaigns; useful non-selling content such as study or hostel-life guides to maintain permission; and new-arrival announcements. Roughly two e-mails a week, capped.

(6) **Automation flows.** Welcome, abandoned cart, browse abandonment, post-purchase review request, referral prompt after a positive review, and a win-back at 45 days of inactivity.

(7) **Design and copy.** Mobile-first single-column templates with large tap targets — almost all opens will be on a phone — short conversational copy, one dominant call to action, and clear price and delivery information, since ambiguity about cost loses this segment immediately.

(8) **Timing and frequency.** Send in the evening and late-evening windows the analytics identify, avoid examination weeks for promotional sends, and let subscribers set frequency through a preference centre.

(9) **Compliance and deliverability.** Explicit consent, SPF, DKIM and DMARC configured, a visible unsubscribe link, and suppression of non-openers after a defined window to protect sender reputation.

(10) **Measurement and iteration.** Track list growth, open, click-through and conversion rates, revenue per e-mail, referral sign-ups, unsubscribe and complaint rates; A/B test subject lines every campaign; review monthly and adjust cadence and offers by segment.

Marking scheme: 10 M for ten plan components at 1 M each. The plan must be visibly built for *students* — price sensitivity, mobile-only reading, campus referral, exam-period timing, ID verification. A generic e-mail plan with the word "students" inserted loses the application marks that this question is principally testing.

UNIT 4

Web Design and Mobile Marketing

Syllabus: Web Design — web design and optimisation of websites; publishing a basic website; user-centered design and website optimisation; design principles and website copy; website metrics and developing insight. Mobile Marketing — the difference between mobile advertising and mobile marketing; using mobile marketing for sales promotions; online applications.

In the examination: Part B Questions 7 and 8 are set from this unit. In both papers the pair mixed a web-design question with a mobile-marketing question, so the two halves must be prepared together. Note that the 2025 paper set Q7a on Google Analytics and Hotjar — placed here because the blueprint assigns Q7 to Unit IV, and because the question is about developing *website insight*, which is a Unit IV descriptor phrase.

Part A — Two-Mark Questions

1. Why is it important to integrate SEO in website development? [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.7 — 2 M]

Because the largest SEO factors are development decisions, not marketing decisions: site architecture, URL structure, crawlability, rendering method, page speed, mobile responsiveness, semantic markup and structured data are all fixed while the site is being built. Integrating SEO from the start means the site is indexable, fast and rank-ready on the day it launches, whereas retrofitting it later means expensive rebuilds, URL migrations and the traffic loss that accompanies them.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the point that SEO elements are structural/development decisions, 1 M for the consequence — ranking from launch, and avoidance of costly rework or traffic loss.

2. What is the role of geo-targeting in mobile marketing? [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.8 — 2 M]

Geo-targeting delivers advertisements, offers and content to users on the basis of their physical location, determined by GPS, IP address, geofences or in-store beacons. Its role is to make mobile messages contextually relevant — reaching a user when they are near a store, serving location-specific offers, languages, stock and store details, and triggering proximity notifications — which raises response rates, eliminates spend on users outside the service area, and produces measurable footfall.

Marking scheme: 1 M for what geo-targeting is, 1 M for its role — relevance, proximity offers, reduced wastage or measurable footfall.

3. What is the primary difference between mobile advertising and mobile marketing? [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q1.10; CIE-III, Jun 2026; Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025; Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 2 M]

Mobile advertising is a paid, largely one-way promotional activity — in-app and in-game banners, interstitials, native and video ads, paid SMS and paid search on mobile — aimed at immediate reach, clicks and installs. **Mobile marketing** is the whole strategy of reaching and serving customers on mobile devices: responsive websites and mobile SEO, apps and push notifications, SMS and WhatsApp, QR codes, location-based marketing, mobile payments and mobile advertising itself. The primary difference is one of scope — advertising is a paid tactic contained within mobile marketing, which is the broader relationship-building strategy.

Marking scheme: 1 M for each definition, with the scope relationship — advertising is a subset of marketing — carrying the distinction. A candidate who states only "one is paid" earns half.

4. **What is website optimization?** [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 2 M]

   Website optimisation is the continuous, data-driven process of improving a website's performance, speed, usability, content and search visibility so that more of its visitors complete the actions the business wants. It covers technical optimisation, content and copy, SEO and mobile experience, and it is judged by conversion rate rather than by appearance.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for the process of improving performance, usability and visibility, 1 M for the purpose — more traffic and higher conversions.

5. **Mention any two principles of website design.** [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 2 M]

   Simplicity — remove everything that does not help the visitor complete their task, since every additional element competes for the same attention. **Consistency** — the same layout, colours, typography, button styles and terminology on every page, so the user learns the interface once. Also acceptable: visual hierarchy, mobile responsiveness, accessibility, fast loading, clear navigation.

   Marking scheme: 1 M each, with a phrase of justification.

6. **Mention two key principles of user-centered design in website development.** [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 2 M]

   Design from an explicit understanding of users, their tasks and their environment — established through research rather than assumed. **Iterative design refined through user involvement and user-centred evaluation** — prototypes tested with real users and improved in cycles, rather than designed once and launched. Also acceptable: involving users throughout; addressing the whole user experience; multidisciplinary design teams.

   Marking scheme: 1 M each.

7. **How can website metrics help in optimizing a website for marketing effectiveness?** [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 2 M]

   Metrics locate problems precisely — naming the page, step or device where visitors are lost — and rank potential fixes by likely impact, so effort goes where the loss is largest. They also prove or disprove each change through before-and-after measurement and A/B testing, reallocate budget towards the channels that convert, and expose segment-specific failures that site-wide averages conceal.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for diagnosis and prioritisation, 1 M for validation of changes or budget reallocation.

8. **State two key elements that visitors commonly expect to see on a well-optimized landing page.** [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 2 M]

   A **clear benefit-led headline** that matches the advertisement or link which brought them there, so the visitor knows within seconds that they are in the right place; and a **single prominent call-to-action button**, visually dominant and above the fold. Also acceptable: trust signals such as ratings, testimonials or security badges; transparent pricing.

   Marking scheme: 1 M each.

9. How does image optimization contribute to overall website performance? [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 2 M]

Compressing images, serving modern formats and lazy-loading below-the-fold assets reduces page weight and load time, which improves Core Web Vitals and lowers bounce rate — images are usually the largest component of page weight, so this is the single highest-leverage speed fix. It also improves the mobile experience on slow connections, and descriptive file names and alt text improve both SEO and accessibility.

Marking scheme: 1 M for speed, page weight and bounce rate, 1 M for the SEO, accessibility or mobile benefit.

10. List any four key metrics used to measure the success of a website. [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 2 M]

(1) Traffic — users and sessions, split new against returning.
(2) Bounce rate or engagement rate.
(3) Average session duration or engagement time.
(4) Conversion rate.

Also acceptable: pages per session, page load time, traffic sources, exit rate, cost per acquisition.

Marking scheme: Any four, half a mark each.

11. How can push notifications be used in mobile marketing to enhance sales promotions? [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 2 M]

Push notifications deliver time-critical offers instantly to the installed base through an owned channel that no platform algorithm throttles. In sales promotion they announce flash sales and create urgency with countdowns, recover abandoned carts within minutes, trigger geo-fenced coupons when a user approaches a store, and re-engage lapsed users with personalised offers — each deep-linked so the tap lands on the product rather than the home screen.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the mechanism — instant, owned, direct-to-device delivery — and 1 M for two or more promotional uses.

12. How can user-friendly design impact the overall effectiveness of a website? [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 2 M]

It reduces the cognitive effort needed to complete a task, so more visitors finish what they came to do. The measurable effects are lower bounce rate, longer engagement time, more pages per session and a higher conversion rate; the indirect effects are greater trust in the brand, more return visits, and better organic ranking, because search engines now reward the same engagement behaviour that good usability produces.

Marking scheme: 1 M for reduced effort and task completion, 1 M for the measurable outcomes.

13. List any two aspects of branding and consistency in web design. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

Consistent visual identity — the same logo, colour palette, typography, imagery style, iconography and button design applied on every page. **Consistent tone of voice and terminology** — in all copy, including microcopy, error messages, form labels and CTA text, so the site reads as one coherent personality rather than as several. Also acceptable: consistent navigation and layout patterns across pages.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

14. **List any two differences between mobile web marketing and mobile app marketing.** [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

Access and reach: mobile web is reached through a browser with no installation, so it has far broader reach and is better for acquisition; an app requires download and installation, so it reaches a narrower but much more engaged and higher-value audience. **Capability:** apps have full push notification rights and device access — camera, GPS, biometrics, wallet — and can work offline; mobile web has limited push capability and restricted device access.

Marking scheme: 1 M each.

15. **What is the impact of user behavior analysis on website optimization?** [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

It replaces assumption with observation: heatmaps, scroll maps, click maps and session recordings show what users actually do — which elements they look at, which they ignore, where they hesitate, where they rage-click and how far down the page they really scroll. Its impact is to generate the specific hypotheses that A/B testing then validates, without which optimisation is guesswork dressed as design opinion.

Marking scheme: 1 M for what behaviour analysis reveals, 1 M for its role in generating and validating optimisation hypotheses.

Part B — Eight, Six and Ten-Mark Questions

1. **Outline the steps involved in publishing a basic website for a small business.** [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q7a — 8 M]

(1) **Define purpose, audience and required pages.** Decide what the site must achieve — enquiries, orders, credibility, directions — and list the pages that serve it: home, about, products or services, pricing, contact, and a blog if content is planned.

(2) **Register a domain name.** Choose a short, memorable, brand-relevant name, prefer a `.com` or `.in` extension, and register it through a registrar with privacy protection and auto-renewal enabled.

(3) **Choose hosting or a website builder.** Shared or cloud hosting with a CMS such as WordPress gives control and lower long-run cost; a hosted builder such as Wix, Squarespace or Shopify trades control for speed and simplicity. For a small business the decision turns on whether anyone will maintain it.

(4) **Plan the structure and wireframe the pages.** Draw the navigation hierarchy and a simple wireframe of each page showing where the value proposition, images, trust signals and calls to action sit, before any design work begins.

(5) **Select the platform, theme and design.** Choose a responsive, lightweight, mobile-first template; set brand colours, typography and logo; and keep the layout conventional — a small business gains nothing from an experimental navigation pattern.

(6) **Create the content.** Write clear customer-focused copy, take or source good photographs of the actual products or premises, and prepare product details, pricing, business hours, address, map and contact information.

(7) **Build the pages and the conversion paths.** Assemble navigation, pages, contact and enquiry forms, WhatsApp or chat buttons, and prominent calls to action; verify responsiveness at mobile, tablet and desktop widths and check basic accessibility — contrast, alt text, keyboard navigation.

(8) **Add the essential integrations.** A working contact form with e-mail delivery, a payment gateway if selling, Google Maps, social profile links, and a claimed and completed Google Business Profile, which for a local business often delivers more traffic than the site itself.

(9) **Apply on-page SEO basics.** Unique title tags and meta descriptions, one H1 per page, keyword-bearing readable URLs, image alt text, an XML sitemap and a robots.txt file.
(10) **Secure the site.** Install an SSL certificate so the site serves over HTTPS, set up automated backups, keep the CMS and plugins updated, and add basic spam and firewall protection.
(11) **Test before launch.** Check every page across browsers and devices, test all forms and payment flows end to end, run a page-speed test, and fix broken links and missing images.
(12) **Publish and register with search engines.** Point the domain to the host, take the site live, then submit the sitemap through Google Search Console and install Google Analytics so measurement begins on day one.
(13) **Maintain.** Monitor analytics and Search Console, refresh content, apply updates and backups on a schedule, and act on the enquiries the site produces — a site nobody monitors is a cost, not an asset.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly eight distinct steps at 1 M each, in a sensible order. Domain, hosting, structure, content, build, SEO and security basics, testing, go-live and measurement should all appear; sequence itself carries marks because the question says "outline the steps".

2. Discuss any four important website metrics. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q7b — 8 M]

(1) **Traffic — users and sessions, new against returning.** *What it is:* the number of distinct visitors and visits in a period. *What it reveals:* the size and growth of the audience, and whether growth comes from acquisition (new users) or from loyalty (returning users). *How to act on it:* a rising session count with a flat user count means the same people visiting more often — an engagement success, not an acquisition one, and the two require different responses.
(2) **Traffic sources and channels.** *What it is:* the breakdown of arrivals into organic search, paid search, social, e-mail, referral and direct. *What it reveals:* which investments actually produce visitors, and how dependent the business is on any single channel. *How to act on it:* compare conversion rate and cost per acquisition by channel, not volume, and move budget accordingly; a channel producing 40% of traffic and 5% of revenue is a problem, not an achievement.
(3) **Bounce rate and engagement rate.** *What it is:* the share of single-page, non-interacting sessions, and its inverse. *What it reveals:* whether the landing experience matches the expectation that brought the visitor. *How to act on it:* examine bounce rate by landing page and by source; a high figure on paid landing pages usually means the ad promised something the page does not deliver, and is fixed by message match, load speed and a clearer above-the-fold proposition.
(4) **Average engagement time and pages per session.** *What it is:* how long a visitor is actively engaged and how many pages they consume. *What it reveals:* the depth of interest and the quality of internal linking and navigation. *How to act on it:* low values on content pages point to weak or hard-to-read content; strengthening internal links and adding a clear next step raises both.
(5) **Conversion rate and goal completions.** *What it is:* the percentage of sessions that complete a defined valuable action. *What it reveals:* whether the site does its job, and it is the only metric here that is directly a business outcome. *How to act on it:* segment it by device, source and landing page to locate where conversion is lost, then A/B test the specific step.
(6) **Page load time and Core Web Vitals.** *What it is:* LCP, INP and CLS — loading, responsiveness and visual stability. *What it reveals:* technical experience quality, which affects both conversion and search ranking. *How to act on it:* compress images, defer non-critical scripts, use a CDN and remove unused tags.
(7) **Exit rate and top exit pages.** *What it is:* the share of sessions ending on a given page.

What it reveals: where the journey breaks; a high exit rate on a checkout or form page is a defect, on a thank-you page it is expected.

(8) **Cost per acquisition and return on ad spend.** *What it is:* the marketing cost of each conversion and the revenue produced per unit of spend. *What it reveals:* whether the whole operation is profitable, which no traffic metric can tell you.

Marking scheme: 8 M — *four* metrics at 2 M each, not eight at 1 M. Within each: 1 M for the definition and 1 M for its significance and how it is acted upon. Answering with eight briefly named metrics is the commonest way to lose marks on this question.

3. Discuss the challenges of using mobile marketing for sales and promotion. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q8a — 8 M]

(1) **Screen size and attention constraints.** A promotion must communicate in a few square centimetres to a user who is walking, commuting or multitasking. Copy, imagery and the call to action all have to work at a glance, which makes complex offers very hard to convey.

(2) **Device, operating-system and client fragmentation.** Thousands of device models, screen sizes, Android versions and e-mail or browser clients must all render the campaign correctly, multiplying design, development and testing cost.

(3) **Privacy regulation and the loss of tracking.** GDPR, CCPA and the DPDP Act require consent for collection and use of personal and location data, while Apple's App Tracking Transparency and the deprecation of third-party identifiers have materially reduced targeting precision and attribution accuracy.

(4) **Intrusiveness and permission fatigue.** The phone is a personal device, so poorly timed or excessive push notifications and SMS are experienced as an intrusion. The penalty is severe and immediate — notification permissions revoked, the app uninstalled, the number blocked.

(5) **Ad avoidance and quality problems.** Ad blockers, banner blindness, accidental "fat-finger" clicks that inflate reported performance, and mobile ad fraud through click farms and install fraud all degrade the value of the impressions bought.

(6) **High acquisition cost and poor app retention.** Cost per install continues to rise, while a large majority of installed apps are abandoned within the first week — so the promotion pays for an install that produces no second visit.

(7) **Network, data cost and device constraints.** Heavy creatives, video and large app updates fail on weak connections or are declined by users conscious of data cost and battery, particularly in price-sensitive markets.

(8) **Measurement and attribution complexity.** Journeys cross app, web and physical store on the same device and across devices; without deterministic identity resolution, credit for a sale cannot be assigned reliably, which makes budget defence difficult.

(9) **Security and trust.** SMS phishing, malicious apps and payment fraud have made users cautious about links and permissions, so legitimate promotional messages are treated with suspicion.

(10) **Platform dependence and rapid change.** App store policies, operating-system releases and platform algorithm changes can invalidate a working tactic without notice, forcing continuous re-investment.

(11) **Content, language and localisation demands.** Mobile audiences are linguistically diverse, and campaigns often require localisation into several languages and cultural contexts to work at all.

(12) **Clutter and competition.** Every brand is targeting the same screen, so the marginal value of one more notification falls while the cost of standing out rises.

Marking scheme: 8 M for eight challenges at 1 M each, named and explained. Marks are for distinct challenges — "small screen" and "limited attention" will be read as one point, not two.

4. Elucidate the importance of understanding user-centered design concepts while developing digital marketing strategies. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q8b — 8 M]

User-centered design (UCD) is an iterative design process in which the needs, goals, contexts and limitations of the actual user drive every decision at every stage. Its cycle is: research the users → specify the context and requirements → design a solution → evaluate it against real users → repeat. Its instruments are personas, journey maps, wireframes, prototypes, usability testing and accessibility standards.

(1) **It grounds strategy in evidence rather than assumption.** UCD research replaces what the marketing team believes customers want with what observed users actually do, which is the single most common source of wasted digital spend.

(2) **It removes friction and so raises conversion.** Marketing pays to bring a visitor to a destination; if that destination is confusing, slow or demands too much, the acquisition spend is lost at the last step. UCD is what makes the traffic convert.

(3) **It produces the personas and journey maps the strategy runs on.** The same research output — who the user is, what they are trying to do, where they struggle — drives targeting, channel selection, messaging and content sequencing, so UCD and marketing planning share a foundation.

(4) **It builds trust and credibility.** Clarity, honest labelling, predictable navigation, visible pricing and transparent policies are design decisions that determine whether a first-time visitor believes the brand — and trust is a precondition of conversion, not a consequence.

(5) **It makes the offering accessible and inclusive.** Designing to WCAG standards — contrast, text sizing, keyboard operability, screen-reader compatibility, captions — extends reach to users with disabilities and to everyone in poor conditions, and reduces legal risk.

(6) **It enforces context realism, especially mobile.** UCD asks where and how the product is actually used — one-handed, on mobile data, in sunlight, between meetings — and produces mobile-first, low-bandwidth, short-attention designs that match reality instead of the studio.

(7) **It reduces cost and rework.** A usability problem found in a paper prototype costs almost nothing; the same problem found after launch costs a redevelopment cycle and the revenue lost meanwhile. Iterative evaluation moves discovery earlier, where it is cheap.

(8) **It supports SEO and engagement indirectly.** Clear structure, fast loading, readable content and satisfied users produce the engagement signals and dwell times that search engines reward, so good UX and good organic visibility reinforce each other.

(9) **It creates loyalty and advocacy.** A pleasant, low-effort experience produces repeat visits, positive reviews and referrals, which lower acquisition cost and raise lifetime value — the compounding returns that campaign spending alone never generates.

(10) **It gives the strategy a testable, adaptive method.** Usability testing and A/B testing keep the strategy responsive to changing user behaviour, so decisions can be revisited on evidence rather than defended on authority.

Conclusion. Digital marketing controls the arrival; user-centered design controls what happens after it. Since the return on every rupee spent on acquisition is realised only at the destination, understanding UCD is not a design specialism adjacent to marketing strategy — it is the condition on which that strategy's numbers depend.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 2 M for defining UCD and its process, 5 M for five or six substantiated reasons at roughly 1 M each, 1 M for a conclusion connecting UCD to marketing outcomes.

5. Demonstrate how tools like Google Analytics and Hotjar can be used to develop insights into user behavior and improve marketing decisions. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q7a — 8 M]

The two tools answer different questions and are used together. **Google Analytics is quantitative** — it tells you *what* happened, to how many people, and how much it cost. **Hotjar is qualitative** — it shows *why* it happened.

Google Analytics — the what

(1) **Acquisition analysis.** Sessions, engaged sessions, conversions and revenue by channel, source and campaign, showing which marketing investments produce buyers rather than visitors.
(2) **Landing-page and content performance.** Entrances, engagement rate, average engagement time and exits per page, identifying which content earns attention and which loses it.
(3) **Funnel and path exploration.** Step-by-step drop-off through the conversion funnel, and the actual paths users take, which are frequently not the paths the site was designed around.
(4) **Segmentation.** The same funnel split by device, geography, new against returning and traffic source — which is usually where the real finding is, for example a mobile conversion rate one-third of desktop.
(5) **Key events and value.** Conversion tracking with assigned values, cost per acquisition and ROAS, so behaviour is translated into money.

Hotjar — the why

(1) **Heatmaps.** Click, move and scroll maps show what users actually look at and interact with — typically revealing that the key call to action sits below the point 60% of users ever scroll to, or that users repeatedly click a non-clickable image.
(2) **Session recordings.** Replays of individual sessions expose rage clicks, hesitation, repeated back-navigation and the exact field at which a form is abandoned.
(3) **Form and funnel analytics.** Field-level analysis naming the input that causes abandonment — typically a phone number, a mandatory GST or PAN field, or an unexplained password rule.
(4) **On-site polls, surveys and feedback widgets.** Voice-of-customer data captured in the moment — "what stopped you from completing your purchase today?" — which no behavioural dataset can supply.

The combined workflow, demonstrated

(1) GA4 reports that mobile checkout completion is 22% against 61% on desktop — a quantified problem, but no cause. Hotjar recordings of mobile checkout sessions show users reaching the coupon field, leaving to search for a code, and never returning; the heatmap confirms heavy tapping on that field. A hypothesis follows: the coupon field is causing abandonment. The remedy — collapse it behind a small "have a code?" link — is A/B tested, and GA4 measures the resulting lift. That loop, *quantify* → *explain* → *hypothesise* → *test* → *re-measure*, is the demonstration the question asks for.

Marketing decisions improved: reallocation of budget to the channels GA4 shows convert; redesign of the landing pages Hotjar shows confuse; shortening of forms; reordering of page content to match real scroll depth; mobile-first prioritisation; and content commissioned against the questions surveys and site-search reveal.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 3 M for Google Analytics capabilities, 3 M for Hotjar capabilities, 2 M for the combined workflow and the marketing decisions it changes. The command word is "demonstrate", so a worked example carries marks — listing features of both tools without showing them used together answers only part of the question.

10. Formulate a mobile-based marketing plan for a local food delivery startup to reach a targeted student segment. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q7b — 8 M]

(1) **Objective.** 5,000 app installs and 1,500 monthly orders from three named campuses within six months, at a customer acquisition cost below Rs. 120 and a repeat-order rate above 40%.

(2) **Segment insight.** Students aged 18–24 living in hostels and shared flats: highly price-sensitive, order late at night and during exam weeks, order in groups to split delivery fees, pay by UPI, discover through Instagram and WhatsApp rather than search, and are strongly influenced by peers and by referral credits.

(3) **Positioning and offer design.** Student-priced combos under Rs. 99; free delivery on verification of a college ID; a group-order feature that splits the bill; a midnight menu during examination periods; and a referral scheme giving credit to both parties, which is the cheapest acquisition channel in a dense campus network.

(4) **App and mobile experience.** A lightweight app that installs quickly on mid-range phones and poor connections; OTP sign-up in one step; saved hostel and block addresses; one-tap reorder; live tracking; UPI as the default payment; and a fast progressive web app for students unwilling to install anything. App-store optimisation on "student food delivery *city*" and hostel-related terms.

(5) **Channel mix.** Geofenced Instagram and Snapchat advertising drawn tightly around campus and hostel blocks; click-to-WhatsApp ads for ordering without an install; a campus ambassador programme paying commission per referred order; QR-code posters in canteens, hostel notice boards and library entrances; and opt-in WhatsApp broadcast lists per campus.

(6) **Location and timing tactics.** Geofencing and, where available, beacons to trigger proximity offers; dayparting concentrated on the lunch break, the 8–10 pm window and the midnight peak; weather-triggered promotions on rainy evenings; and calendar-triggered campaigns keyed to examination and fest schedules.

(7) **Retention programme.** Loyalty points and order streaks; personalised push notifications based on order history, capped in frequency to protect the notification permission; a subscription pass offering free delivery for a month; and win-back offers to users inactive for 21 days.

(8) **Measurement and optimisation.** Track installs, cost per install and CAC, notification opt-in and open rates, order conversion rate, average order value, repeat-order rate, Day-7 and Day-30 retention and ROAS in Firebase and GA4 with a mobile measurement partner for attribution; run weekly creative A/B tests; review campus-level unit economics monthly and stop what does not pay.

Marking scheme: 8 M for eight plan components at 1 M each. The plan must be visibly *mobile-based* — app, push, WhatsApp, geofencing, QR — and visibly aimed at *students*. A general digital marketing plan, however good, will lose the application marks that this question is mostly testing.

11. Evaluate the effectiveness of mobile marketing in facing market changes due to rapid technological advancements. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q8a — 8 M]

The case for effectiveness

(1) **Ubiquity and permanence of the channel.** The smartphone is now the primary internet device for most users and is carried at all times, so mobile marketing reaches the customer wherever the market moves — it does not depend on the customer coming to a desk, a shop or a television.

(2) **Speed of response.** Push notifications, in-app messages, SMS and WhatsApp campaigns can be conceived and delivered within hours, so a brand can react to a competitor's move,

a price change, a stock-out or a sudden demand shift almost immediately — something print, television and even e-mail cannot match.

(3) **Data richness and personalisation.** Device, location, app usage and purchase history support individually tailored offers and AI-driven recommendation, so the offering can be re-tuned continuously as preferences shift.

(4) **Context awareness.** Geofencing, proximity beacons and real-time triggers allow marketing that responds to where and when the customer actually is — a capability no traditional medium possesses at all.

(5) **Measurement and iteration speed.** Attribution, cohort retention and in-app analytics close the feedback loop in days rather than quarters, so strategy adapts at the speed the technology changes.

(6) **Native absorption of new technology.** Each wave of advancement has arrived on the phone first and been absorbed by mobile marketing quickly — 5G making rich video viable, AR try-on, voice search and assistants, conversational commerce through chatbots, UPI and one-tap payment, wearables and connected devices. The channel has repeatedly demonstrated it can adopt rather than be displaced.

(7) **Cost-efficiency and accessibility.** Precise targeting and low production cost make it viable for small firms, which means the channel spreads adaptation across the whole market rather than only to large incumbents.

The limits on that effectiveness

(1) **Privacy regulation and identifier loss** — ATT, cookie deprecation and consent requirements have removed much of the targeting precision on which the personalisation argument rested.

(2) **Saturation and intrusion** — notification fatigue, ad blocking and permission revocation mean the same immediacy that makes mobile responsive also makes it easy to alienate users.

(3) **Fragmentation, obsolescence and cost** — constant device, OS and platform change forces continuous re-investment, and high app acquisition costs with poor retention undermine the cost argument.

(4) **Unequal access** — device capability, data cost and network quality vary widely, so a strategy assuming high-end phones excludes part of the market.

Evaluation. On balance mobile marketing is the most adaptive channel currently available: its speed, data and context-awareness let a business absorb technological change rather than be overtaken by it, and its record of assimilating each successive advancement supports that. But its effectiveness is conditional, not automatic. It holds only where the brand builds consent-based first-party data to replace lost third-party targeting, restrains frequency so that immediacy does not become intrusion, and continues investing in experience as devices change. Where those conditions fail, the channel's greatest strength — direct access to a personal device — becomes its greatest liability.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 4 M for the effectiveness arguments, 2 M for the limitations or challenges, 2 M for a reasoned overall judgement. "Evaluate" requires the verdict; an answer that lists advantages only is incomplete.

8. **Create a strategy to use new digital channels like mobile apps, chatbots, and social media integration to strengthen a brand's global online presence.** [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q8b — 8 M]

(1) **Strategic objective and the glocal principle.** One consistent global brand identity, promise and visual system, executed with local relevance in language, culture, payment and festival calendar. The governing rule is "global framework, local expression", and success is measured by global share of digital voice, engagement rate, assisted revenue and consistency of brand perception across markets.

(2) **The mobile app as the owned hub.** Build the app as the one channel the brand controls entirely: multilingual and multi-currency, region-aware content and inventory, a loyalty programme that works across markets, offline-capable for low-connectivity regions, and permissioned push notifications scheduled to local time zones. Support it with app-store optimisation in each market's language and a progressive web app for regions where installs are resisted.

(3) **Chatbots for round-the-clock multilingual service.** Deploy conversational agents on the website, in the app, and on WhatsApp, Messenger and Instagram DMs, handling FAQs, order tracking, product finding, appointment booking and lead qualification in the local language, with clean escalation to a human agent. For a global business this is what makes 24-hour presence economically possible across time zones, and it captures structured intent data as a by-product.

(4) **Social media integration.** Operate regional handles under a shared global content template and calendar; enable social login and social commerce with shoppable posts and in-platform checkout; run user-generated-content and hashtag campaigns that travel across markets; and build a per-market influencer network. Platform selection follows the market, not headquarters — WeChat and Douyin in China, LINE in Japan, WhatsApp in India and Brazil, TikTok, Instagram and LinkedIn elsewhere.

(5) **Data and technology integration.** Join app, web, chatbot, social and CRM identities in a customer data platform, with server-side tagging through GTM feeding one analytics stack. Without this the channels remain three separate silos; with it, a customer recognised on WhatsApp in the morning receives a consistent experience in the app that evening. This integration layer is what converts a list of channels into a strategy.

(6) **Content and localisation.** Transcreate rather than translate — adapt idiom, imagery, models, colour associations and humour to each market; localise pricing, payment methods and delivery promises; comply with local advertising and product-claim regulation; and meet accessibility standards so the presence is genuinely global rather than merely multinational.

(7) **Emerging-channel layer.** Extend deliberately into AR try-on and virtual product experiences, voice assistants and voice search optimisation, short-form video, community platforms such as Discord and Telegram, and connected TV — piloting each in one market before global rollout rather than launching everywhere at once.

(8) **Governance, compliance and measurement.** Publish global brand and tone guidelines with a regional approval workflow; run a consent management platform satisfying GDPR, CCPA and DPDP simultaneously; maintain a crisis-response playbook covering all time zones; and report a single global dashboard — reach, engagement rate, app monthly active users, chatbot containment rate and CSAT, social commerce revenue, conversion and ROAS — reviewed monthly, with a test-and-learn pilot protocol before any market-wide launch.

Marking scheme: 8 M for eight strategy components at 1 M each. All three named channels — app, chatbot, social integration — must be addressed substantively, and the answer should show them *integrated* rather than described separately; the data and governance layers are what distinguish a strategy from a list.

9. Explain the concept of web design and the importance of website optimization. [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 10 M]

Web design is the planning and creation of a website's structure, appearance and interaction — layout and grid, colour palette, typography, imagery and graphics, navigation architecture, responsiveness across devices, and the interaction patterns that let a user complete a task. It is the discipline in which visual communication and usability meet business objective.

Types of optimisation

(1) **Technical** — load speed, Core Web Vitals, clean code, uptime, security and HTTPS.
(2) **Content** — clarity, structure, readability, relevance and persuasive copy.
(3) **SEO** — crawlability, metadata, heading structure, internal linking, structured data.
(4) **Mobile** — responsive layout, tap targets, performance on weak connections.

Importance of website optimisation

(1) **It raises conversions from existing traffic,** which is almost always cheaper than buying more traffic.
(2) **It improves user experience and satisfaction,** directly lowering bounce and abandonment.
(3) **It improves search visibility,** because speed, mobile-friendliness and structure are ranking factors as well as usability factors.
(4) **It reduces cost per acquisition across every channel at once,** since every channel points at the same destination.
(5) **It builds credibility and trust** — a slow, broken or confusing site is read as an unreliable business.
(6) **It sustains competitiveness,** because user expectations, devices and algorithms move continuously, so an unoptimised site degrades even when nothing about it changes.

Benefits in summary: more traffic, better engagement and more revenue from the same marketing spend.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 4 M for the concept of web design and its elements, 2 M for the types of optimisation, and 4 M for the importance points. Both halves of the question are named explicitly and must both appear.

5. A start-up notices that visitors leave their website within a few seconds. As a web designer, explain how you would optimize the website to improve user engagement and conversion rate. [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 10 M]

(1) **Diagnose before redesigning.** Read GA4 for bounce by landing page, device and source, and watch Hotjar recordings and scroll maps to see *why* people leave. Redesigning without diagnosis usually moves the problem rather than fixing it.
(2) **Fix load speed first.** Visitors leaving within seconds are often leaving before the page renders. Compress and lazy-load images, serve modern formats, defer non-critical scripts, remove unused tags, enable caching and a CDN, and target a load under three seconds.
(3) **Make it genuinely mobile responsive.** Most traffic is mobile; test real breakpoints, ensure tap targets of at least 44 pixels, type of 16 pixels or more, and no horizontal scrolling.
(4) **Rewrite the above-the-fold section.** One benefit-led headline stating what the business does for the visitor, a supporting sub-line, one dominant call to action — the visitor must know within five seconds that they are in the right place.
(5) **Enforce message match.** The landing page must repeat the promise of the advertisement, keyword or link that produced the visit; mismatch is the commonest cause of instant exits.
(6) **Simplify navigation and structure.** A clear menu, logical hierarchy, working search, breadcrumbs, and no more than a handful of top-level choices.
(7) **Improve content quality and scannability.** Short paragraphs, descriptive subheadings, bullets, supporting visuals, and the answer to the visitor's question near the top rather than after three screens of company history.
(8) **Strengthen calls to action and reduce friction.** One visually dominant accent-coloured button with action-verb copy, repeated at intervals; forms cut to the minimum fields; guest checkout; visible progress indicators.

(9) **Add trust signals.** Reviews and ratings, testimonials, security badges, clear contact details, refund and privacy policies — a new start-up has no brand recognition, so trust must be constructed on the page.

(10) **Validate and iterate.** A/B test the headline, hero image and CTA one change at a time; monitor bounce rate, engagement time, scroll depth and conversion rate weekly; and repeat the cycle rather than treating the fix as final.

Marking scheme: 10 M for ten optimisation actions at 1 M each. Opening with diagnosis and closing with A/B validation are the two moves that lift this above a generic checklist — the question says "as a web designer", so a professional method is being examined, not a list of tips.

6. A college plans to publish its departmental website for admissions and student activities. Explain the complete process involved in designing and publishing the website. [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 10 M]

(1) **Requirement analysis.** Establish the objectives — admissions enquiries, student information, activity updates, placement data — and the audiences: prospective students and parents, current students, faculty and recruiters. Each wants something different from the same site.

(2) **Information architecture and website design.** Plan the sitemap (home, about, programmes, admissions, faculty, research, activities, placements, contact), wireframe the key pages, and design the visual layout within the institution's brand identity.

(3) **Content development.** Write and collect programme details, eligibility and fee structure, faculty profiles, syllabi, event calendars, photographs, accreditation and placement statistics — for an admissions site, content accuracy is a compliance matter, not only a quality one.

(4) **Domain registration.** Register an appropriate domain, ideally under the institution's existing `.edu.in` or `.ac.in` domain, which carries credibility that a generic domain does not.

(5) **Web hosting.** Choose hosting sized for admission-season traffic spikes, with adequate bandwidth, uptime guarantees, automated backups and an SSL certificate.

(6) **Website development.** Build the pages on a CMS such as WordPress or Drupal so that non-technical staff can update notices; implement responsive layouts, the enquiry and application forms, the notice board and the events calendar.

(7) **Testing.** Verify across browsers and devices; test every form and the application workflow end to end; check load speed, broken links and accessibility — a public institution's site has an accessibility obligation; and have faculty proof the academic content.

(8) **Pre-launch technical setup.** Install SSL, generate and submit the XML sitemap, configure robots.txt, add title tags and meta descriptions, and install Google Analytics and Search Console so measurement starts on day one.

(9) **Publishing.** Point the domain to the host, deploy, verify the live site, and announce it through the institution's existing channels — notice boards, social handles, admission communications.

(10) **Maintenance.** Assign an owner; update notices, results and event information on a schedule; refresh admission content each cycle; apply security patches and backups; and review analytics to see which information prospective students actually look for — an unmaintained college site loses credibility faster than no site at all.

Marking scheme: 10 M for the ten stages at 1 M each, in correct sequence. The official scheme names requirement analysis, design, content development, domain registration, hosting, development, testing, publishing and maintenance — covering those nine secures the marks; the pre-launch technical setup and the college-specific detail earn the top band.

7. Discuss what website visitors typically look for when they land on a business webpage, and suggest design and content strategies to meet those expectations. [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 10 M]

Answer as visitor question paired with delivery strategy — that pairing is what the scheme rewards.

(1) **"Am I in the right place?"** *Strategy:* a headline stating plainly what the business does and for whom, matching the source that brought them, visible without scrolling.
(2) **"What exactly do you offer?"** *Strategy:* a clear product or service overview with benefit-led descriptions, images and categories one click from the homepage.
(3) **"What does it cost?"** *Strategy:* transparent pricing, or a clear explanation of how pricing works when it must be quoted. Hidden pricing is the most common cause of exit on a business site.
(4) **"Can I trust you?"** *Strategy:* reviews and ratings, testimonials with names and photographs, client logos, certifications, case studies, a real address and phone number, and an About page with actual people.
(5) **"How do I contact you?"** *Strategy:* contact details in the header and footer, a short enquiry form, WhatsApp or chat, a map, and stated response times.
(6) **"What do I do next?"** *Strategy:* one obvious, dominant call to action per page with action-verb copy, repeated at intervals down the page.
(7) **"Is this current and maintained?"** *Strategy:* recent updates, current dates, working links, live stock or availability — an obviously stale site reads as a closed business.
(8) **"Will this work on my phone, and quickly?"** *Strategy:* mobile-first responsive design, sub-three-second load, compressed images, readable type and thumb-sized targets.
(9) **"What are the terms if something goes wrong?"** *Strategy:* visible shipping, returns, warranty, cancellation and privacy policies — risk reversal converts hesitant buyers.
(10) **Underlying design and copy principles.** Simplicity and generous whitespace; clear visual hierarchy putting the most important thing highest; consistency of colour, type and button style; accessibility of contrast and alt text; and copy that is customer-focused, specific, scannable and free of jargon — "you" language rather than "we" language.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6–7 M for the visitor expectations each paired with a strategy, and 3–4 M for the general design and copy principles. Listing what visitors want without saying how the site delivers it answers only half the question.

8. Design a user-centered website layout for a new e-commerce startup targeting young urban professionals. How would you ensure optimal user experience and engagement? Include key design principles, optimization strategies and website copy suggestions. [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 10 M]

Research first. Persona: 25–35, urban, mobile-first, time-poor, price-aware but convenience-driven. Primary task: find and buy quickly on a phone, often during a commute. Every decision below follows from that.

(1) **Layout — above the fold.** Sticky header carrying logo, prominent search bar, account and cart; a hero section with one benefit headline, one supporting line and one call to action.
(2) **Layout — body.** A three-column category grid (single column on mobile); a social-proof band with aggregate ratings and review count; a personalised "recommended for you" row; a delivery-promise strip; and a simple footer carrying trust, policy and contact links.
(3) **Design principle — mobile-first responsive.** Designed at the phone breakpoint first and expanded upward, not the reverse.

(4) **Design principle — visual hierarchy.** Search bar and primary CTA given the greatest visual weight, because search is how a time-poor buyer shops.
(5) **Design principle — simplicity and consistency.** Generous whitespace, one accent colour reserved exclusively for actions, one button style, type at 16 pixels or larger, tap targets of at least 44 pixels, and accessible contrast with alt text throughout.
(6) **Optimization — speed.** Compressed modern-format images, lazy loading, deferred scripts, CDN delivery, targeting a load under three seconds on mobile data.
(7) **Optimization — checkout.** One-page guest checkout with a four-field form, saved payment methods and wallets, a visible progress indicator, and no forced account creation — forced registration is the single largest abandonment cause for this persona.
(8) **Optimization — engagement and recovery.** Exit-intent offer, abandoned-cart e-mail and push, personalised recommendations, and heatmaps and session recordings to locate friction continuously.
(9) **Copy suggestions.** Headline: "Everything for your week, delivered by tomorrow". Subline: "Free delivery over Rs. 499. Returns in one tap." CTA: "Shop today's deals" rather than "Submit". Form microcopy: "Takes 30 seconds — no account needed". Product copy: specific, benefit-led claims rather than adjectives.
(10) **Measurement.** Conversion rate, mobile against desktop conversion gap, checkout completion rate, average order value, mobile bounce rate and repeat purchase rate — with A/B tests on the hero headline and the CTA running continuously.

Marking scheme: 10 M. The question names four deliverables — layout, UX and engagement, design principles, optimisation strategies and copy — so roughly 2–2.5 M each. Actual suggested copy strings earn marks that a description of "good copy" does not; write the words you would put on the page.

9. A travel agency's landing page for a limited-time holiday offer gets many ad clicks but converts poorly. Evaluate the possible reasons and suggest optimizations for headlines, call-to-action buttons and visuals. [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 10 M]

Possible reasons for the low conversion

(1) **Message mismatch** — the advertisement promised a specific offer that the page does not restate, so the visitor believes they have arrived in the wrong place.
(2) **Vague headline** that describes the agency rather than the offer.
(3) **The offer and price sit below the fold,** so most visitors never see them.
(4) **Competing or invisible calls to action** — several links of equal weight, or none that is visually dominant.
(5) **An over-long enquiry form** demanding details the visitor is not ready to give at this stage.
(6) **No urgency conveyed** even though the offer is time-limited, and no trust signals — no reviews, certifications or cancellation policy.
(7) **Slow load and poor mobile rendering,** plus generic stock imagery that could belong to any agency, and hidden total cost or unclear inclusions. Site navigation left on the page also lets visitors wander away.

Optimizations

(1) **Headline.** Restate the advertisement's exact promise with specifics — "Kerala backwaters, 4 nights from Rs. 18,999 — book by Sunday" — with a sub-headline listing what is included. Specificity is what converts on an offer page.
(2) **Call-to-action buttons.** One dominant high-contrast button repeated above and below the fold, with active benefit copy — "Reserve my package" rather than "Submit" — plus reassurance microcopy beneath it such as "Free cancellation up to 7 days".

(3) **Visuals, and everything else.** Replace stock photography with real destination and customer images, add a short itinerary video, and show a countdown timer for the deadline. Cut the form to name, phone and travel date; place testimonials and ratings adjacent to the CTA; strip the site navigation from the landing page; compress images for a sub-three-second mobile load; and A/B test the headline and CTA. *Measure with:* conversion rate, form-start to completion ratio, scroll depth and session recordings to confirm the fix worked.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 5 M for the diagnosis and 5 M for the optimisations, and the three elements named in the question — headlines, CTA buttons, visuals — must each be addressed under their own heading, since the examiner marks against those words.

8. **How do online applications serve as effective tools for mobile marketing? What key features should businesses incorporate into their apps to maximize marketing potential?** [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 10 M]

Why apps are effective

(1) **An owned, unthrottled channel.** Push notifications reach the user directly without an algorithm deciding whether the message is delivered.
(2) **Far higher engagement and conversion** than mobile web among the same users, because installation is itself an act of commitment.
(3) **Rich first-party behavioural data** — every screen, search and purchase, tied to a known user, which is increasingly valuable as third-party tracking degrades.
(4) **Device capability access** — GPS for location marketing, camera for scanning and AR try-on, biometrics for frictionless payment, wallet integration.
(5) **Personalisation at the individual level,** driving recommendation engines that raise average order value.
(6) **Persistent brand presence** — the icon on the home screen is continuous, unpaid brand exposure.
(7) **Loyalty and retention mechanics** — points, streaks, tiers and wallet passes that are impractical on mobile web.
(8) **Offline capability and speed,** giving a better experience on weak connections than any browser session.

Key features to incorporate

(1) **Acquisition and onboarding:** fast OTP or social sign-up, a short value-first onboarding flow, and a push-permission request made only *after* the user has experienced value — asking on first launch is how permission is permanently lost.
(2) **Engagement and marketing:** segmented, deep-linked push notifications and in-app messaging; a personalised home feed and recommendation engine; in-app offers, coupons and gamification; referral and loyalty programmes; and social sharing.
(3) **Conversion and retention:** one-tap checkout with saved payment and wallets; saved addresses and reorder; wishlist and price-drop alerts; abandoned-cart recovery; in-app support or chatbot; and ratings and review prompts.
(4) **Measurement and hygiene:** analytics SDK with event tracking and attribution, A/B testing and feature flags, crash reporting, a preference centre for notification control, and transparent privacy and consent handling — since an app that over-notifies is uninstalled, and an uninstalled app has no marketing value at all.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 5 M for why apps work as marketing tools and 5 M for the feature checklist. Grouping the features by purpose — acquisition, engagement, conversion, measurement — reads far better than an undifferentiated list of eleven items.

9. A luxury cosmetics brand is launching a flash sale exclusively through mobile. Design a mobile marketing campaign that drives awareness of the sale and maximizes conversion during the limited window. [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 10 M]

Pre-launch — awareness, seven days out

(1) **Teaser push and SMS** to the segmented installed base, revealing the date but not the discount, building anticipation rather than announcing a sale.
(2) **Influencer and Reels previews** with beauty creators, plus an in-app countdown banner on every screen.
(3) **A "notify me" opt-in** that both captures purchase intent and, in the same tap, secures push permission — the highest-value action of the pre-launch phase.
(4) **Paid social and mobile display retargeting** to past purchasers, cart abandoners and lookalike audiences.

Launch — the conversion window

(1) **Timed push at each segment's peak activity hour,** deep-linked straight to the sale screen rather than the home screen.
(2) **App-exclusive early access** one hour before the website, which converts the sale into an install driver as well as a revenue event.
(3) **Scarcity and urgency on-screen** — a visible countdown timer and limited-stock indicators, which suit a luxury flash sale where exclusivity is part of the proposition.
(4) **Personalised product rows** built from browsing and purchase history, and one-tap checkout with saved cards and wallets, since every additional field costs conversions during a short window.

During and after

(1) **Recovery and support:** abandoned-cart push within 20 minutes; geo-fenced offers with click-to-map near flagship stores; in-app live chat; and free-shipping threshold prompts to raise average order value.
(2) **Post-sale and technical.** Thank-you and review-request push, a win-back offer to browsers who did not buy, and a wallet pass for the next drop. Technically the campaign requires sub-three-second load, server capacity provisioned for the traffic spike, and a fully mobile-first design. *Measure:* push open rate, sale-screen sessions, add-to-cart rate, checkout completion, conversion rate, average order value, revenue per push, opt-out rate and installs during the window.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Structure by campaign phase — pre-launch, launch, during, post — which is what earns the "design a campaign" marks; roughly 2.5 M per phase. The answer must be recognisably mobile-exclusive and recognisably a *flash* sale, with urgency and scarcity mechanics explicit.

9. You are launching a promotional campaign for a new product using mobile marketing. Prepare a detailed plan including mobile advertising channels, push notifications, app-based promotions and integration with social media. [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 10 M]

(1) **Objective and audience.** A SMART objective — for example 20,000 installs and 5,000 first purchases in eight weeks at a defined cost per acquisition — and a mobile persona specifying device tier, active hours, preferred platforms and data-cost sensitivity.
(2) **Mobile advertising — search and intent.** Mobile search advertisements on high-intent queries with location and call extensions, and click-to-call advertisements for enquiry-driven products.
(3) **Mobile advertising — display and video.** In-app banner and native placements on contextually relevant apps; rewarded video for cheap reach; interstitials placed at natural

app breakpoints rather than mid-task; expandable rich media for the brand story; and click-to-map advertisements to drive footfall.

(4) **Push notifications — the sequence.** Teaser, launch, reminder and last chance, each segmented by behaviour, deep-linked to the relevant screen, frequency-capped and A/B tested on copy and send time.

(5) **Push notifications — permission discipline.** Request permission only after the user has experienced value, offer a preference centre, and suppress the disengaged — because an opt-out is permanent and an uninstall irreversible.

(6) **App-based promotions.** App-exclusive early access and pricing, in-app coupons, gamified spin-to-win, loyalty points, referral codes, wallet passes and one-tap checkout.

(7) **Social media integration — organic.** Reels and Stories carrying the campaign hashtag, influencer seeding, user-generated content contests, and a messaging broadcast channel for order updates and offers.

(8) **Social media integration — paid and data.** Shoppable posts and product tags, click-to-WhatsApp advertisements, and retargeting audiences built from app and site events through the pixel and SDK — which is what makes social and app one campaign rather than two.

(9) **Cross-channel integration.** QR codes on packaging, print and in-store signage linking to the mobile landing page; one consistent creative and offer across every touchpoint; and mobile treated as the connective tissue between online and offline media.

(10) **Measurement.** Installs and cost per install, push open and opt-out rates, in-app conversion rate, coupon redemption, ROAS, and lifetime value by acquisition source — reviewed weekly, with budget reallocated to the channels producing profitable customers rather than cheap installs.

Marking scheme: 10 M. The question names four components explicitly — advertising channels, push notifications, app promotions, social integration — so roughly 2–2.5 M each with the remainder for objectives and measurement. Answer under those four headings.

10. Discuss the relationship between design principles and website copy. How can visual design and well-crafted content work together to enhance user experience and achieve website objectives? Include examples. [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 10 M]

Design and copy are not sequential tasks — design does not decorate finished copy, and copy does not fill finished layouts. Each design principle has a copy counterpart, and the page works only when both are satisfied.

(1) **Visual hierarchy ↔ message hierarchy.** The largest element must carry the most important message. A giant headline saying "Welcome to our website" is a hierarchy correctly built around the wrong sentence.

(2) **Simplicity ↔ concision.** Whitespace fails if the paragraph inside it runs to 200 words; clean layout and long-winded copy cancel each other out.

(3) **Consistency ↔ consistent voice and terminology.** If the button style is uniform but one says "Buy now", another "Submit" and a third "Proceed", the interface is still inconsistent.

(4) **Contrast and emphasis ↔ the single call to action.** The one visually dominant element and the one action the copy asks for must be the same element.

(5) **Readability ↔ plain language.** Type size, line length and contrast govern whether text can be read; sentence length and jargon govern whether it can be understood. Failing either loses the reader identically.

(6) **Imagery ↔ specific claims.** A photograph shows what the product looks like; the copy supplies the number, the guarantee and the proof. Neither persuades alone.

(7) **Whitespace and rhythm ↔ scannable structure.** Subheadings, bullets and short paragraphs are simultaneously a design decision and a writing decision.

Worked examples of successful integration

(1) **Hero section.** A high-contrast headline stating one benefit, a supporting line, one accent-coloured button, over an image showing the product in use — the eye reaches the headline first, the copy answers the question it raises, and the button is where the eye lands next.
(2) **Pricing table.** Three aligned columns with the recommended tier visually elevated, copy naming who each tier is for — "for teams of 2–10" — rather than merely listing features. Design directs the choice; copy justifies it.
(3) **Failure modes, for contrast.** A beautiful layout carrying vague copy — "innovative solutions for a connected world" — communicates nothing; and strong specific copy set in low-contrast 12-pixel grey type is never read at all. Both fail, and both fail for the same reason: one half of the pairing was treated as decoration.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6 M for the principle-by-principle relationship — a two-column table is the most efficient presentation — and 4 M for the worked examples, which the question demands. Including a failure example as well as successes usually earns the top band.

8. What is the role of user interface and user experience design in web design for marketing? How can businesses ensure a positive user journey on their websites? [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q7a — 8 M]

UI is what the user sees and interacts with — layout, colour, typography, buttons, icons, spacing, visual states. **UX** is the whole experience of using the site — research, information architecture, flows, usability, accessibility and satisfaction. UI is a component of UX: a beautiful interface over a broken flow is good UI and bad UX.

Their role in marketing

(1) **They convert the traffic marketing pays for.** Acquisition spend is realised only at the destination, so UI/UX determines the return on every other marketing rupee.
(2) **They establish credibility within seconds,** which for an unknown brand decides whether anything else is read.
(3) **They reduce friction and therefore abandonment,** particularly in forms and checkout.
(4) **They support SEO indirectly,** because engagement, speed and mobile usability are ranking signals.
(5) **They differentiate the brand** where products are otherwise comparable, and drive retention and repeat visits.

Ensuring a positive user journey

(1) **Research the users and map the journey** — personas, tasks and touchpoints — before designing anything.
(2) **Design mobile-first and responsively,** and keep load times under three seconds.
(3) **Make navigation and information architecture obvious,** with search, breadcrumbs and a shallow hierarchy.
(4) **Maintain message match and consistency** from advertisement to landing page to checkout, so the journey never contradicts itself.
(5) **Minimise friction** — fewest form fields, guest checkout, progress indicators, clear error messages that say how to fix the problem.
(6) **Meet accessibility standards** for contrast, keyboard operation and screen readers, so the journey exists for everyone.

(7) **Test with real users and iterate** — usability testing, heatmaps, session recordings and A/B tests — and measure the journey with bounce, completion, task-success and conversion rates.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 2 M for defining UI and UX and their relationship, 3 M for their role in marketing, and 3 M for ensuring a positive journey. Confusing UI with UX, or treating them as synonyms, costs the first two marks immediately.

6. Describe the importance of testing and optimization in web design for marketing. What tools and methods can be used to analyze and improve website performance? [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q7b — 8 M]

Importance

(1) **Design opinion is unreliable.** What a team believes will convert and what does convert diverge often enough that testing, not judgement, is the only dependable method.
(2) **It raises revenue without raising traffic cost,** improving the economics of every acquisition channel at once.
(3) **It reduces the risk of redesigns,** since changes are validated on a fraction of traffic before full rollout.
(4) **It catches defects that analytics alone hides** — a broken form on one browser, a checkout failure on one device — which can silently cost a large share of revenue.
(5) **It creates a culture of continuous improvement,** where the site is treated as a product under development rather than a project that ended.

Methods and their tools

(1) **Quantitative analysis** — Google Analytics 4 for traffic, funnels, segments and conversions; Google Search Console for search performance.
(2) **Behavioural analysis** — Hotjar or Microsoft Clarity for heatmaps, scroll maps, session recordings and form analytics; on-site surveys for voice of customer.
(3) **Performance testing** — PageSpeed Insights, Lighthouse, GTmetrix and WebPageTest for load time and Core Web Vitals.
(4) **Experimentation** — A/B and multivariate testing through Optimizely, VWO or AB Tasty, run to statistical significance.
(5) **Usability and accessibility testing** — moderated and unmoderated user testing, five-second tests, WAVE and axe for accessibility; plus cross-browser and cross-device testing (BrowserStack) and technical auditing (Screaming Frog, SEMrush Site Audit).

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 4 M for the importance and 4 M for methods paired with named tools. Naming actual tools rather than saying "analytics software" carries marks; a table of method against tool against what it reveals is the most efficient format.

6. Discuss push notifications in mobile marketing. How can businesses use them to engage and retain mobile app users? Provide examples of effective push notification strategies. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q8a — 8 M]

Definition. Push notifications are short messages sent by an application directly to a user's device screen, appearing whether or not the app is open. They require explicit permission, and are the only marketing channel that reaches an installed user without an intermediary algorithm deciding delivery.

Uses for engagement and retention

(1) **Re-engagement** of users who have not opened the app recently, before dormancy becomes uninstallation.

(2) **Transactional and status updates** — order confirmed, shipped, out for delivery — which are opened almost universally and build the habit of trusting notifications from that app.
(3) **Cart and browse abandonment recovery,** typically the highest-value automated push available.
(4) **Personalised offers and recommendations** based on past behaviour.
(5) **Time-sensitive promotions** — flash sales, price drops, back-in-stock and low-stock alerts.
(6) **Location-triggered messages** when a user enters a geofence near a store.
(7) **Content, streaks and loyalty prompts** that build routine usage.

Effective strategies, with examples

(1) **Ask permission at the right moment** — after the user has experienced value, with an explanation of what they will receive, never on first launch.
(2) **Segment and personalise** — send to behaviour-defined groups, not the whole base. *Example:* a cart reminder 20 minutes after abandonment, naming the item left behind.
(3) **Time by behaviour, not by convenience** — send at each segment's observed active hour and respect time zones. *Example:* a food delivery app pushing at 12:30 pm and 8 pm rather than mid-morning.
(4) **Be specific, brief and deep-linked** — state the benefit in under ten words and land the tap on the exact screen. *Example:* "Your size is back in stock — 3 left" opening the product page.
(5) **Cap frequency, give a preference centre, and A/B test everything** — copy, emoji, timing and offer — measuring opt-out rate alongside open rate. *Example:* a 30-day win-back offering a specific incentive rather than a generic "we miss you". Over-notification is the single largest cause of uninstalls, so restraint is a strategy, not a compromise.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 1 M for the definition, 3–4 M for the engagement and retention uses, and 3–4 M for strategies with concrete examples — the question asks for examples explicitly, so generic advice without them loses those marks.

8. **Explain the significance of mobile analytics in mobile marketing campaigns. What key metrics should marketers track to measure success?** [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q8b — 8 M]

Significance

(1) **It measures a journey that web analytics cannot see.** App sessions, screens and in-app events are invisible to conventional web tracking, so without mobile analytics a large part of the customer journey is simply unrecorded.
(2) **It attributes installs and revenue to source,** which is the only way to know which campaign actually produced paying users rather than cheap installs.
(3) **It exposes the retention problem.** Most installed apps are abandoned quickly; only cohort retention analysis reveals whether acquisition spend is building a user base or filling a leaking bucket.
(4) **It supports personalisation and segmentation** from behavioural data, and enables in-app A/B testing and feature experimentation.
(5) **It surfaces technical failures** — crashes, slow screens, failed payments — that destroy conversion silently and would otherwise be reported only by the few users who complain.

Key metrics

(1) **Acquisition:** installs, cost per install, install source and campaign attribution, click-to-install rate.

(2) **Activation and engagement:** onboarding completion rate, daily and monthly active users, DAU/MAU stickiness ratio, sessions per user, session length, screens per session, feature adoption.
(3) **Retention:** Day 1, Day 7 and Day 30 retention, cohort retention curves, churn rate and uninstall rate.
(4) **Conversion and revenue:** in-app conversion rate, funnel completion, average revenue per user, average order value, lifetime value, and the LTV-to-CAC ratio — which is the metric that decides whether the whole campaign is viable.
(5) **Channel and technical health:** push opt-in rate, push open rate and opt-out rate, deep-link performance, crash-free session rate, screen load time, and app-store rating and review sentiment.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 4 M for the significance and 4 M for the metrics, best grouped by funnel stage — acquisition, engagement, retention, revenue — rather than listed flat. Naming LTV against CAC, and retention cohorts, marks the answer as informed rather than generic.

UNIT 5

Conversion Optimization and Digital Analytics

Syllabus: Conversion Optimization — what AIDAS is and its role; website optimisation; what visitors want to see on the website; how to optimise key elements and increase the effect of landing on a particular page. Digital Analytics — evolution of digital analytics; information about the end-to-end customer experience; the analyst's influence on business and role as a change agent.

In the examination: Part B Questions 9 and 10 are set from this unit. Both papers examined AIDAS and website optimisation in Q9 and the broader digital-analytics themes in Q10, so the unit divides cleanly into a conversion half and an analytics half.

Part A — Two-Mark Questions

1. **Why is the 'Satisfaction' component important in the AIDAS model?** [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.9 — 2 M]

   Satisfaction is the stage that follows the purchase and confirms that the expectation created by the first four stages was actually met. It is important because it converts a single transaction into a relationship: a satisfied customer repeats, reviews, refers and stays, which raises retention and lifetime value and lowers acquisition cost, whereas a dissatisfied one returns the product and damages the brand publicly. Without Satisfaction the model ends at a one-time sale — which is precisely the weakness of the older AIDA formulation that adding this stage corrects.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for what Satisfaction is — post-purchase fulfilment of the expectation, 1 M for why it matters — repeat purchase, loyalty, referral, lifetime value.

2. **What is meant by the "end-to-end customer experience" in digital analytics?** [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q1.10 — 2 M]

   It is the complete, connected view of every interaction a customer has with a brand across all touchpoints, channels and devices — from the first impression, advertisement or search query, through website and app browsing, purchase, delivery and support, to repeat purchase and advocacy — measured as one continuous journey rather than as a set of separate channel reports. In digital analytics it is achieved by joining data through User-ID, CRM integration, cross-device tracking and multi-touch attribution, so that the whole path to conversion and retention becomes visible instead of only the last click.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for the connected all-touchpoint journey view, 1 M for what it replaces — channel silos and last-click reporting — or for how it is achieved technically.

3. **What does the AIDAS model stand for in conversion optimization?** [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 2 M]

   Attention, **I**nterest, **D**esire, **A**ction, **S**atisfaction — the sequence of psychological states a prospect passes through from first exposure to post-purchase satisfaction. It extends the older AIDA model by adding Satisfaction, so that the framework ends at a retained customer rather than at a completed sale.

Marking scheme: 1 M for the five terms in order, 1 M for stating what the sequence represents.

4. **What is the role of the AIDAS framework in conversion optimization?** [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023 — 2 M]

   It acts as a diagnostic and structuring tool. Diagnostically it locates which psychological stage is failing — high impressions with low clicks is an Attention problem, high add-to-cart with low purchase is an Action problem. Structurally it assigns every section of a page a defined job and sequences the page accordingly, which in turn generates specific, testable optimisation hypotheses.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for the diagnostic role, 1 M for the structuring or hypothesis-generating role.

5. **What is digital analytics?** [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 2 M]

   Digital analytics is the collection, measurement, analysis and interpretation of data from all digital touchpoints — website, app, social, e-mail, advertising and CRM — in order to understand customer behaviour and improve business performance. It is broader than web analytics, which is confined to website data alone.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for the definition, 1 M for the purpose or for the distinction from web analytics.

6. **How does digital analytics influence business decisions?** [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 2 M]

   It supplies the customer insight and performance evidence on which decisions are made rather than argued: which channels receive budget, which segments to target, which products and features to develop, which experience problems to fix first, and what to forecast for the next period. In doing so it shifts decision-making from seniority and intuition to measurement.

   Marking scheme: 1 M for providing insight and performance data, 1 M for naming two or more decisions it determines.

> **Three Unit V questions are answered under Unit IV.** The papers have set *"What is website optimization?"*, *"State two key elements visitors expect on a well-optimized landing page"* and *"What is the impact of user behavior analysis on website optimization?"* under both units, since website optimisation appears in the Unit IV and Unit V descriptors alike. Each is answered once, in Unit IV — see questions 13, 17 and 24 of that chapter. Expect any of them in a Unit V slot as well.

Part B — Eight, Six and Ten-Mark Questions

1. **Explain the AIDAS model and its role in conversion optimization.** [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q9a — 8 M]

   AIDAS is a hierarchy-of-effects model describing the psychological stages a prospect passes through on the way to becoming a satisfied customer. It extends the classical AIDA formulation by adding a fifth stage, *Satisfaction*, so that the model ends at a retained customer rather than at a completed sale.

   (1) **Attention.** The prospect becomes aware that the brand or offer exists. *Digital tactics:* display and social advertising, SEO visibility, striking hero headlines and imagery, video hooks in the first three seconds. *Metrics:* impressions, reach, CTR, scroll-past rate.
   (2) **Interest.** Attention converts into engagement with what is being offered. *Digital tactics:* benefit-led sub-headlines, explainer video, demonstrations, how-it-works sections, useful content. *Metrics:* time on page, scroll depth, video completion, pages per session.
   (3) **Desire.** The prospect moves from "this is interesting" to "I want this". *Digital tactics:* social proof — ratings, reviews, testimonials, case studies, client logos — comparison

tables, guarantees, free trials, scarcity and urgency. *Metrics:* add-to-cart rate, wishlist saves, pricing-page views, return visits.

(4) **Action.** The prospect does the thing the page exists to make them do. *Digital tactics:* one dominant, unambiguous call to action; short frictionless forms; multiple payment options; trust and security badges; exit-intent offers. *Metrics:* conversion rate, form completion rate, cart-abandonment rate, cost per acquisition.

(5) **Satisfaction.** The purchase meets or exceeds expectation. *Digital tactics:* order confirmation and tracking, onboarding sequences, accessible support, easy returns, loyalty and referral programmes, review requests. *Metrics:* repeat purchase rate, NPS and CSAT, churn, customer lifetime value, referral rate.

Role in conversion optimisation

(1) **It maps the funnel, so content can be matched to stage.** Each stage has a different job, and offering a purchase decision to someone still at Attention is the commonest cause of a low conversion rate.

(2) **It localises the leak diagnostically.** High impressions with low CTR is an Attention failure; high traffic with low time on page is an Interest failure; high add-to-cart with low purchase is an Action failure. The model turns a vague "conversions are poor" into a specific stage to fix.

(3) **It supplies stage-wise KPIs and a testing framework.** Because each stage has its own metric, A/B tests can be designed to move one stage at a time, and the result attributed to that change rather than to everything at once.

(4) **It forces attention past the sale.** By including Satisfaction the model makes retention part of conversion optimisation, which matters because raising repeat purchase is generally cheaper than raising first-purchase conversion.

(5) **It gives sales and marketing a shared vocabulary** for describing where a prospect is and whose job it is to move them.

Limitation worth noting. AIDAS assumes a linear progression, whereas real journeys loop, pause and cross devices, and a returning customer may enter directly at Action. It remains valuable as a structuring heuristic for designing and diagnosing pages, not as a literal description of behaviour.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 5 M for the five stages, each named and explained with a digital tactic — roughly 1 M each — and 3 M for the role in conversion optimisation. The question has two halves joined by "and"; an answer that explains the model beautifully and never addresses conversion optimisation loses the second half outright.

6. Discuss the purpose of website optimization. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q9b — 8 M]

(1) **To convert more of the traffic already being paid for.** Raising conversion rate from 2% to 3% increases revenue by half without buying a single additional visitor, which is almost always cheaper than acquiring 50% more traffic.

(2) **To improve the user experience.** Clear navigation, readable content, logical structure and helpful functionality reduce the effort a visitor must spend to get what they came for.

(3) **To reduce bounce, exit and abandonment.** Optimisation identifies and removes the specific points where visitors leave — slow pages, confusing forms, unexpected shipping costs at checkout.

(4) **To improve technical performance.** Faster loading, stable layout and responsive interaction directly affect both conversion and ranking, and are among the few improvements that benefit every page at once.

(5) **To strengthen search visibility.** Optimised structure, speed, mobile-friendliness, metadata and content quality raise organic rankings, so the same work delivers both more traffic and better conversion of it.

(6) **To guarantee cross-device consistency.** With most traffic on mobile, optimisation ensures the experience holds on small screens and weak connections rather than only in the desktop mock-up.
(7) **To lower acquisition cost and raise return.** A higher-converting site reduces cost per acquisition on every channel simultaneously and improves paid-search quality scores, so media budgets go further.
(8) **To build trust and credibility.** Professional design, visible contact details, security indicators, transparent pricing and genuine reviews are optimisation targets that determine whether a first-time visitor is willing to transact at all.
(9) **To improve accessibility and compliance.** Meeting accessibility standards widens the addressable audience and reduces regulatory exposure.
(10) **To institutionalise evidence-based decisions.** Optimisation is a continuous measure–hypothesise–test–implement cycle, which replaces argument about design preferences with data.
(11) **To increase engagement and repeat visits.** Longer engagement time, more pages per session and higher return rates follow from a site that is genuinely useful, and they feed both revenue and ranking signals.
(12) **To sustain competitive position.** User expectations, devices, search algorithms and competitors all change continuously; a site that is not optimised on a schedule degrades relative to them even if nothing about it changes.

Marking scheme: 8 M for eight purposes at 1 M each, named and explained. The strongest answers open by defining website optimisation as the continuous, data-driven improvement of a site against defined business goals, then list the purposes.

7. What are the key performance indicators (KPIs) used to evaluate website optimization, and how do they contribute to increased conversions? [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q9a — 8 M]

The KPIs

(1) **Conversion rate** — the percentage of sessions completing the defined goal. The headline indicator, and the one every other KPI ultimately explains.
(2) **Bounce rate and engagement rate** — whether the landing experience matches the expectation that produced the visit.
(3) **Average engagement time and pages per session** — the depth of interest the content generates.
(4) **Page load time and Core Web Vitals (LCP, INP, CLS)** — the technical quality of the experience.
(5) **Exit rate by page** — where in the journey visitors give up.
(6) **Click-through rate** — both from the search results page and on internal calls to action, measuring whether messaging persuades.
(7) **Funnel and checkout completion rate, and cart-abandonment rate** — the step-by-step efficiency of the conversion path.
(8) **Form completion and abandonment rate, with field-level data** — the friction inside the final step.
(9) **Average order value and revenue per visitor** — the value, not merely the count, of conversions.
(10) **Cost per acquisition and return on ad spend** — whether the optimised site is economically profitable.
(11) **Mobile against desktop conversion gap** — the single most revealing segmentation on most sites.
(12) **Returning-visitor rate and customer lifetime value** — whether optimisation is

building a customer base or only harvesting one.

How they contribute to increased conversions

(1) **Each KPI localises a specific friction.** They are diagnostic, not decorative: load-time metrics point to abandonment before the page is seen; bounce and exit rates name the page that fails; form field analytics name the input that fails. Effort therefore goes where the loss actually is, instead of where opinion assumes it is.
(2) **They convert improvements into money.** AOV, revenue per visitor, CPA and ROAS translate a design change into a financial result, which is what justifies further investment and settles disputes about priorities.
(3) **They make the optimisation cycle possible.** The KPIs supply the baseline, the hypothesis and the verdict in the loop *measure* → *diagnose* → *hypothesise* → *A/B test* → *re-measure*. Without a stable KPI set, a test has no outcome and a change cannot be shown to have helped — so conversions rise reliably only where these indicators are defined, instrumented and reviewed.
(4) **They protect against false wins.** Watching several KPIs together prevents the classic error of celebrating a rise in one metric that was bought at the cost of another — more leads of lower quality, or a higher conversion rate on a smaller and more expensive audience.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 4 M for naming eight relevant KPIs with a brief definition each (half a mark apiece), and 4 M for the second half of the question — the explanation of *how* they drive conversions through diagnosis, valuation and the test-and-learn cycle. A list of KPIs alone answers only half the question and is marked accordingly.

13. Analyze how market segmentation can be refined using digital analytics data. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q9b — 8 M]

The starting position. Traditional segmentation is built from survey and census data into a small number of broad, static groups defined mainly by demography and geography. It is based on what people *say*, is refreshed annually at best, and cannot be acted upon directly. Digital analytics refines this on every one of those dimensions, because it observes what people *do*.

(1) **Behavioural refinement.** Pages viewed, products browsed, content consumed, search terms used, features adopted and recency–frequency– monetary value scores build segments from actual conduct rather than stated preference — and behaviour predicts future purchase far better than demography does.
(2) **Acquisition-source refinement.** Cohorts defined by the channel that produced them — organic, paid, social, e-mail, referral — behave and convert very differently, so channel becomes a segmentation variable in its own right and directly informs budget allocation.
(3) **Technographic refinement.** Device type, operating system, browser, screen size and connection quality separate a mobile-first segment from a desktop segment whose needs, session lengths and conversion rates are genuinely different.
(4) **Micro-geographic and temporal refinement.** Analytics resolves location to city and pin-code level and layers time of day and day of week on top, allowing segments such as "weekday-evening mobile buyers in three specific postcodes" that a survey could never construct.
(5) **Lifecycle and engagement refinement.** Users are separated into new, activated, active, at-risk and churned, and cohort analysis by acquisition month exposes retention differences between them — turning a static segment into a dynamic state that a customer moves through.
(6) **Value-based refinement.** Average order value, margin, purchase frequency and predicted lifetime value identify the minority of customers producing the majority of profit, which is usually the single most commercially useful segmentation available and is invisible without analytics.

(7) **Intent-based refinement.** On-site search terms, comparison-page views, pricing-page visits and abandoned carts identify purchase readiness, allowing segmentation by *where in the decision* someone is rather than by who they are.
(8) **Predictive and machine-learning refinement.** GA4 predictive audiences and similar models score users for purchase probability and churn probability, and lookalike modelling extends a proven high-value segment to a new audience — segmentation that is generated by the data rather than defined in advance by the analyst.

Why the refinement matters, and its limits. The refined segments are continuous and self-updating rather than annual; they are validated against observed behaviour rather than stated intention; they are immediately actionable, because a segment defined in the analytics platform can be published directly as a remarketing audience or a personalisation rule; and they are individually measurable, so segment-level conversion rate and CPA can be compared. The limits are equally real: consent and privacy regulation restrict what may be collected and used; tracking loss and cookie deprecation degrade the data; poor data quality produces confidently wrong segments; and over-segmentation creates groups too small to be statistically meaningful or operationally worth serving.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 6 M for six distinct refinement methods at 1 M each, and 2 M for the analysis of why the refinement is superior — continuous, behaviour-based, actionable, measurable — together with its limitations. The command word is "analyze", so a contrast with traditional segmentation and an acknowledgement of limits raise the answer above a list.

14. Design a basic digital dashboard that reflects holistic marketing performance. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q10a — 8 M]

Purpose, audience and tool. A single-page dashboard for the marketing head, reviewed weekly and at month end, built in Looker Studio (or Power BI) connected live to GA4, Google Search Console, Google Ads, Meta Ads, the e-mail platform and the CRM. "Holistic" means it must show every channel, the whole funnel and the customer after the sale — not one channel's vanity metrics.

Layout, top down.

(1) **Row 1 — Executive KPI tiles.** Sessions, Users, Conversion Rate, Conversions, Revenue, Cost, CPA and ROAS, each shown against the previous period and against target, with red/amber/green status. A reader must be able to answer "are we winning?" in five seconds.
(2) **Row 2 — Acquisition.** Sessions, conversions and revenue by channel — organic, paid search, paid social, organic social, e-mail, referral, direct — as a stacked trend plus a table with spend, clicks, CPC, conversions, CPA and ROAS per campaign. This is where budget decisions are made.
(3) **Row 3 — Engagement and behaviour.** Top landing pages with engagement rate and conversions, average engagement time, bounce and exit pages, site-search terms and top content. This is where content is judged.
(4) **Row 4 — Conversion funnel.** Sessions → product or service page views → add to cart or enquiry started → checkout or form begun → completed, with the drop-off percentage shown at each step and a device split beneath it.
(5) **Row 5 — Channel detail panels.** SEO: impressions, clicks, average position, top queries from Search Console. Paid: impressions, CTR, CPC, quality score, budget pacing. Social: reach, engagement rate, follower growth, top posts. E-mail: sends, open rate, CTR, conversion rate, unsubscribe rate.
(6) **Row 6 — Customer and retention.** New against returning users, cohort retention curve, repeat purchase rate, average order value, customer lifetime value, and NPS or

CSAT. Including this row is what makes the dashboard holistic rather than an acquisition report.

(7) **Row 7 — Segments and context.** Device split, geography map, top audience segments, and an annotation layer marking campaign launches, price changes and site releases so that movements in the charts can be explained rather than merely observed.

(8) **Controls and design principles.** Date-range, channel, device and region filters at the top applying to the whole page; one connected source of truth so no two tiles can disagree; every metric tied to a stated business objective, with vanity metrics excluded; consistent colour semantics; automatic daily refresh and a scheduled Monday e-mail; and a documented definition for every metric so the numbers mean the same thing to everyone reading them.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 4 M for the structure and layout — the reader should be able to picture the page — 2 M for a metric selection that genuinely spans acquisition, engagement, conversion and retention, and 2 M for design principles such as filters, single source of truth, targets and refresh. A sketch or a row-by-row table is worth drawing; "holistic" is the examined word, so a dashboard covering only web traffic will not score well.

15. Analyze how a company can use the AIDAS model to structure content on its product landing page. [SEE, Jun/Jul 2025, Q10b — 8 M]

The model becomes a page layout: each stage is a block, arranged in the order a visitor scrolls, so that the page moves them from stranger to buyer without asking for the purchase too early.

(1) **Attention — above the fold.** A single benefit-led headline stating what the product does for the buyer, not what it is; a high-quality hero image or a short autoplay video of the product in use; a one-line value proposition; and a clean uncluttered layout. The whole job of this block is to earn the next five seconds. *Test with:* headline variants, hero imagery. *Measure with:* scroll-past rate and bounce rate.

(2) **Interest — immediately below.** Three to five benefit bullets written in customer language; a short "how it works" in three steps; a 60–90 second explainer or demonstration video; and the key specifications for the buyer who wants detail early. This block converts a glance into engagement. *Measure with:* scroll depth, video completion, engagement time.

(3) **Desire — the persuasion block.** Social proof first — star ratings, named testimonials with photographs, customer counts, press or client logos, user-generated photographs. Then differentiation: a comparison table against the alternative the buyer is actually considering, including the option of doing nothing. Then risk reversal: warranty, free trial, money-back guarantee, free returns. Finally value framing: price anchoring, bundle options, and genuine scarcity or a deadline where one truly exists. *Measure with:* engagement with the testimonial and comparison sections, add-to-cart rate.

(4) **Action — the conversion block, repeated.** One dominant call to action in a contrasting colour with a specific action verb — "Start my free trial", not "Submit" — repeated after the hero, after the Desire block and at the foot of the page, so a visitor convinced early never has to scroll back. Keep the form to the minimum fields, show accepted payment methods and security badges, state delivery time and total cost with no surprises, and add an exit-intent offer for the leaving visitor. *Measure with:* CTA click-through, form completion and abandonment, conversion rate.

(5) **Satisfaction — after the click, but designed with the page.** An order confirmation and tracking page that sets expectations; a welcome and onboarding e-mail sequence; visible help, chat and FAQ; a simple returns policy; a review request timed after the product has actually been used; and a loyalty or referral offer. It belongs in the answer because the landing page's promise is what this stage must fulfil — a page that oversells guarantees dissatisfaction later. *Measure with:* repeat purchase rate, NPS, return rate, referral rate.

(6) **Supporting structure across the whole page.** Objection-handling FAQ placed between Desire and the final Action block, since unanswered objections are what stop otherwise-convinced buyers; trust signals distributed rather than clustered; mobile-first design, because most of the traffic will scroll this page on a phone; and fast load, because the Attention block cannot work if it has not rendered.

(7) **Instrumentation and testing.** Map one metric to each stage as above, then A/B test one block at a time so that a lift can be attributed to a stage rather than to a redesign. Heatmaps verify that users reach the Desire block at all; session recordings show where the sequence breaks.

(8) **Worked illustration.** For a fitness-tracker landing page: *Attention* — "Know exactly how well you slept" over a hero shot on a wrist; *Interest* — three bullets on sleep staging, 14-day battery and water resistance, plus a 45-second demonstration; *Desire* — 4.6 stars from 12,000 buyers, a comparison against the two competing bands, and a 30-day money-back guarantee; *Action* — "Buy now — delivered by Friday" with UPI, cards and cash on delivery shown; *Satisfaction* — setup e-mail on day one, a check-in on day seven, and a review request on day fourteen.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 6 M for the five stages mapped to concrete page blocks — roughly 1.2 M each, and the Satisfaction stage must not be omitted, which is the commonest error — 1 M for the measurement and testing layer, and 1 M for a worked illustration on a named product. The question says "structure content on its landing page", so the answer must read as a page layout, not as an explanation of AIDAS.

16. Explain how advancements in technology, data collection methods and analytical tools have transformed the way businesses understand and optimize their online presence. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q10a — 8 M]

The question names three drivers; the safest structure is to take them in turn and then state the transformation they jointly produced.

Advancements in technology

(1) **Cloud computing and big data infrastructure** removed the storage and processing limits that once forced analytics to work on samples, so every interaction of every user can now be retained and queried.

(2) **The mobile-first internet and high-speed networks** shifted the majority of traffic to phones and made continuous, always-on measurement of an always-on customer possible.

(3) **Artificial intelligence and machine learning** moved analysis from describing the past to predicting behaviour — propensity to buy, propensity to churn, modelled conversions where observed data is missing.

(4) **Automation, martech platforms and customer data platforms** connected measurement to action, so an insight can trigger a campaign without human intervention.

Advancements in data collection

(1) **From server log files to JavaScript page tags to event-based collection.** Measurement moved from counting file requests, to counting pageviews, to recording named user actions with parameters — which is what makes behaviour rather than traffic the unit of analysis.

(2) **Tag management and the data layer** let marketers deploy and standardise collection without engineering releases, which enormously increased the pace at which measurement could evolve.

(3) **Cross-device and identity resolution.** User-ID, CRM stitching and logged-in identity joined the fragments of one person's journey into a single record, replacing device-level counting.

(4) **Qualitative and voice-of-customer collection.** Heatmaps, session recordings, on-site surveys, review mining and social listening added *why* to the *what*, which pure clickstream data never supplied.
(5) **First-party, consent-based and server-side collection.** Privacy regulation and third-party cookie deprecation forced a shift to consented first-party and zero-party data, server-side tagging and modelled measurement — a change in method driven by law rather than technology.

Advancements in analytical tools

(1) **Analytics platforms** — GA4's event model, Adobe Analytics, Mixpanel and Amplitude for product analytics.
(2) **Warehouses and self-service BI** — BigQuery and SQL access to raw event data, with Looker Studio, Power BI and Tableau putting interactive dashboards in the hands of non-analysts.
(3) **Experimentation and behaviour tools** — Optimizely, VWO and Google Optimize successors for A/B testing; Hotjar and Microsoft Clarity for behavioural observation.
(4) **Marketing intelligence tools** — SEMrush, Ahrefs and Similarweb for competitive and search visibility; attribution and media-mix modelling for budget allocation; and generative AI for content production and for summarising insight in natural language.

The resulting transformation

(1) **In understanding:** from aggregate hit counts to individual journey-level understanding; from monthly retrospective reports to real-time dashboards; from description to prediction; and from isolated channel reports to end-to-end, cross-device attribution.
(2) **In optimisation:** continuous experimentation as a routine rather than an occasional project; personalisation and recommendation at scale; automated bidding and budget reallocation; predictive retention intervention before a customer churns; and technical or UX faults detected within hours.
(3) **And the caveats:** privacy regulation and signal loss, data quality and governance debt, cost and skill shortages, analysis paralysis from over-measurement, and the ethical obligation not to use the resulting capability against the customer's interest.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 2 M for each of the three named drivers — technology, data collection methods, analytical tools — and 2 M for the transformation in how businesses understand and optimise, ideally with the caveats. An answer that covers only tools and never distinguishes them from collection methods loses a third of the marks; the three-part structure is given in the question and should be used.

14. Analyze the evolution of Digital Analytics in the last decade and predict the changes we might see in the next decade from a marketing perspective. [SEE, Sept/Oct 2024, Q10b — 8 M]

The evolution, roughly 2015–2025

(1) **From sessions to events.** Universal Analytics' session-and- pageview model gave way to GA4's event-based model, migration being forced in 2023. The unit of analysis became the user action, which suits apps and single-page applications that the older model measured badly.
(2) **From desktop to mobile and app.** Measurement extended to mobile apps through Firebase and to cross-device journeys, reflecting where the audience had already gone.
(3) **From last-click to multi-touch and data-driven attribution.** Credit was redistributed across the journey, which changed budget decisions — upper-funnel channels stopped looking worthless.
(4) **From third-party tracking to a privacy-first regime.** GDPR in 2018, CCPA, Apple's App Tracking Transparency in 2021 and India's DPDP Act in 2023, together with third-

party cookie deprecation, moved the discipline to consent management, first-party data, server-side tagging and modelled conversions. This is the defining change of the decade.

(5) **From description to prediction.** Machine learning entered the mainstream products as predictive audiences, propensity and churn scores, and anomaly detection.

(6) **From siloed tools to integrated stacks.** Customer data platforms, cloud warehouses and reverse ETL joined web, app, CRM, e-mail and advertising data, and raw event export to BigQuery ended the era of sampled, locked-in reporting.

(7) **From quantitative alone to quantitative plus qualitative.** Heatmaps, session replay and voice-of-customer tools became standard alongside clickstream analytics.

(8) **From reporting analyst to business partner.** Self-service dashboards removed routine report production, and the analyst's value shifted to framing questions, interpreting results and driving change — the change-agent role the syllabus names.

The next decade, predicted

(1) **AI-native analytics.** Natural-language querying, automatic insight narration and anomaly explanation will replace most dashboard building; the skill shifts from producing the chart to asking the right question and judging the answer.

(2) **Agentic optimisation.** Systems that propose, run and deploy their own experiments and budget shifts within guardrails, with humans setting objectives and constraints rather than executing changes.

(3) **Privacy-preserving measurement as the default.** Data clean rooms, aggregated and differentially private reporting, federated learning and modelled conversions will become the normal way to measure, with deterministic user-level tracking increasingly the exception.

(4) **First-party and zero-party data as strategic assets.** Loyalty programmes, logged-in experiences and value exchanges will be built primarily to earn consented data, and identity will be resolved through relationships rather than through tracking.

(5) **Measurement of new interfaces.** Voice assistants, AR and VR commerce, wearables, connected TV, in-car screens, and — most immediately — traffic and citations arriving through AI answer engines rather than through the traditional results page, which will require an entirely new visibility metric to replace the ranking position.

(6) **Outcome metrics replacing traffic metrics.** Predicted lifetime value, incrementality measured by controlled experiment, and media-mix modelling will displace session counts and last-click conversions as the numbers marketing is judged on.

(7) **Real-time decisioning.** Streaming data feeding personalisation and offer decisions within the session rather than in the next campaign.

(8) **Regulation, governance and ethics.** Stronger and more fragmented regional regulation, algorithmic accountability requirements, and a genuine competitive advantage accruing to brands that are trusted with data — so the analyst's role expands to include governance and ethical judgement, not only technique.

The through-line. The decade past moved digital analytics from counting to understanding; the decade ahead will move it from understanding to autonomous action — while privacy constraints tighten simultaneously. The tension between those two forces, more prediction on less individual-level data, is the defining problem the next generation of marketing analysts will be paid to solve.

Marking scheme: 8 M. 4 M for the evolution — four or more substantiated changes with approximate dates or named events, since a dated answer reads as informed — and 4 M for the predictions, which must be reasoned extrapolations rather than science fiction. A concluding synthesis linking the two halves secures the top band on an "analyze and predict" question.

9. Explain the AIDAS model in detail. Discuss how each stage plays a critical role in conversion optimization, using examples to illustrate how businesses can enhance customer journeys. [Improvement CIE, 28 Aug 2024 — 10 M]

This is the example-weighted form of the AIDAS question. Give the five stages with the marketer's task and metric for each, and attach a concrete worked example to every stage — the examples are where the marks concentrate.

(1) **Attention — being noticed at all.** *Task:* interrupt the scroll and establish relevance in three to five seconds. *Example:* a streaming service whose entire first screen is one headline, one button and nothing else — every removed element increases the chance the remaining ones are seen. *Metric:* impressions, CTR, scroll-past rate.

(2) **Interest — earning the next thirty seconds.** *Task:* show immediately what the visitor gains, not what the company is. *Example:* a product page opening with three benefit bullets instead of a specification table, with the specifications available lower down for those who want them. *Metric:* engagement time, scroll depth, video completion.

(3) **Desire — moving from interest to wanting.** *Task:* supply proof and reduce perceived risk. *Example:* a marketplace placing star ratings and the review count directly above the buy button rather than in a tab further down — proximity to the decision point is what makes proof effective. *Metric:* add-to-cart rate, wishlist saves, return visits.

(4) **Action — removing every remaining obstacle.** *Task:* make the desired action the easiest thing on the page. *Example:* one-tap checkout with saved payment details and guest checkout enabled — forced account creation is among the largest single causes of cart abandonment. *Metric:* conversion rate, form completion, cart abandonment.

(5) **Satisfaction — converting a buyer into an advocate.** *Task:* meet or exceed the expectation the earlier stages created. *Example:* an order confirmation with proactive delivery tracking, followed by an onboarding message and a review request timed after the product has actually been used. *Metric:* repeat purchase rate, NPS, return rate, referral rate.

Why each stage is critical to conversion optimisation

(1) **The stages are sequential and lossy.** Each can only convert what the previous one delivered, so a failure early is unrecoverable later — no checkout optimisation rescues a page nobody scrolled past.

(2) **It localises the problem.** Matching the symptom to the stage turns "conversions are poor" into a specific, fixable defect.

(3) **It assigns each page section a job,** which is the practical test of whether a section belongs on the page at all.

(4) **It gives each stage its own metric,** so A/B tests can move one stage at a time and the result be attributed to that change.

(5) **It extends optimisation past the sale.** Including Satisfaction makes retention part of conversion work — and since selling to an existing customer is several times more likely to succeed than selling to a new prospect, that stage often carries the highest return of the five.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6 M for the five stages with examples — the question demands examples, so a stage explained without one earns partial credit — and 4 M for the discussion of why each is critical to conversion optimisation.

6. Explain the AIDAS model and its role in website conversion optimization. How can key elements of a website be optimized to increase landing page effectiveness? [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 10 M]

Part one — the model and its role. Give the five stages and their role in CRO as set out in the two preceding answers: AIDAS maps the funnel, localises the failing stage, assigns each page section a job, supplies stage-wise metrics for testing, and extends optimisation beyond the sale into retention.

Part two — optimising the key elements

(1) **Headline.** One benefit-led statement matching the source that produced the visit; specific rather than clever; visible without scrolling. Test variants — headline changes routinely produce the largest single conversion movements of any element.
(2) **Sub-headline and opening copy.** One line expanding the promise, then three benefit bullets in customer language. No company history above the fold.
(3) **Call to action.** One dominant action per page, in a contrasting accent colour reserved exclusively for actions, with active first-person copy ("Start my free trial"), repeated after each persuasion block so a convinced visitor never scrolls back.
(4) **Visuals.** Real product and customer imagery rather than stock; a short demonstration video; images compressed and lazy-loaded so they support the page rather than delay it.
(5) **Forms.** Minimum viable fields — every additional field costs completions; inline validation; clear error messages that say how to fix the problem; guest checkout; a visible progress indicator on multi-step flows.
(6) **Trust signals.** Ratings and review counts, named testimonials with photographs, certifications, security badges, guarantees and return policies — placed adjacent to the call to action, where the hesitation actually occurs.
(7) **Page speed.** Sub-three-second load, compressed modern-format images, deferred scripts, CDN — the Attention stage cannot function on a page that has not rendered.
(8) **Mobile experience.** Mobile-first layout, 44-pixel tap targets, 16-pixel type, no horizontal scroll, and payment methods suited to mobile.
(9) **Focus.** Remove site navigation and competing links from a dedicated landing page, so the only paths are convert or leave.
(10) **Layout as an AIDAS sequence, and validation.** Order the page hero (Attention) → benefits (Interest) → proof and comparison (Desire) → CTA and form (Action) → post-purchase follow-up (Satisfaction); then A/B test one block at a time and verify with heatmaps, scroll maps and session recordings.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 4 M for the model and its role and 6 M for the element- by-element optimisation. The question has two explicit halves joined by "How can"; answering only the model is the commonest way to lose half the marks.

7. Describe the conversion funnel in digital marketing. What are the key stages, and how can businesses identify and address drop-offs? [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q9a — 8 M]

The conversion funnel is the staged path from first exposure to completed action, narrowing at each step because only a proportion of people progress.

The stages

(1) **Awareness.** The prospect learns the brand exists. *Metrics:* impressions, reach, new users. *Common drop-off cause:* wrong targeting or a weak hook.
(2) **Interest / Consideration.** They engage and evaluate. *Metrics:* sessions, engagement time, pages per session, product views. *Cause:* irrelevant content, poor message match, slow pages.

(3) **Desire / Intent.** They signal purchase intent. *Metrics:* add-to-cart rate, wishlist saves, pricing-page views. *Cause:* weak proof, unclear pricing, no differentiation.
(4) **Action / Conversion.** They complete the purchase or form. *Metrics:* checkout completion, conversion rate, cart abandonment. *Cause:* long forms, forced registration, surprise shipping cost, limited payment options.
(5) **Retention / Advocacy.** They return, repurchase and refer. *Metrics:* repeat purchase rate, churn, NPS, referral rate. *Cause:* poor onboarding, weak support, no follow-up.

Identifying drop-offs

(1) **Funnel exploration in GA4** — the step-by-step drop-off percentage, which localises the largest loss quantitatively.
(2) **Segmentation** — the same funnel by device, channel and geography; a site-wide 3% conversion rate can conceal 6% on desktop and 1% on mobile.
(3) **Behavioural tools** — heatmaps, scroll maps, session recordings and form-field analytics to see *why* the drop occurs.
(4) **Voice of customer** — exit-intent surveys and support tickets, which supply reasons no behavioural data can.

Addressing them. Fix the stage with the largest absolute loss first, not the one that is easiest. Improve targeting and hooks at awareness; message match, speed and content at interest; social proof, guarantees and transparent pricing at desire; form length, guest checkout, payment options and cost transparency at action; and onboarding, support and lifecycle e-mail at retention. Then A/B test each change and re-measure, since a fix that is not verified is only a hypothesis.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 4 M for the stages with their metrics, 2 M for identification methods, 2 M for the remedies. The instruction to fix the largest loss first, and to verify by testing, is what distinguishes a practitioner's answer.

6. Explain the concept of social proof and its impact on conversion rates. Provide examples of how businesses can use social proof effectively. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q9b — 8 M]

Concept. Social proof is the psychological tendency to look to other people's behaviour to decide what is correct, especially under uncertainty. Online, where the buyer cannot touch the product or meet the seller, uncertainty is the default condition — which is why social proof carries disproportionate weight in digital conversion.

Impact on conversion

(1) **It substitutes for trust the brand has not yet earned,** which matters most for new and unknown businesses.
(2) **It reduces perceived risk** at the decision point, addressing the hesitation that stops otherwise-convinced buyers.
(3) **It is believed more than brand claims.** People trust recommendations from other consumers far more than advertising, so a customer sentence outperforms a marketing sentence saying the same thing.
(4) **It works hardest at the Desire stage** and, placed adjacent to the call to action, converts intent into action.

Types, with examples

(1) **Ratings and reviews** — "4.6 stars from 12,430 buyers" shown directly above the buy button.
(2) **Testimonials and case studies** — named customers with photographs and, for B2B, quantified results.

(3) **User-generated content** — customer photographs and videos reposted on product pages, which read as more credible than studio imagery.
(4) **Numbers and popularity** — "Trusted by 50,000 businesses", "Bestseller in this category", "23 people bought this today".
(5) **Expert and celebrity endorsement, and certifications** — dermatologist recommendation, ISO or organic certification, award badges.
(6) **Client logos, press mentions, influencer content and real-time activity notifications.** Also: friend and referral signals where a network connection is visible.

Caution. Fabricated reviews and inflated counts destroy more trust than they borrow, are increasingly detectable, and carry regulatory risk — so social proof must be genuine, specific and recent. A single detailed real review outperforms fifty generic ones.

Marking scheme: 8 M. Roughly 2 M for the concept, 3 M for the impact on conversion, 3 M for types with examples. The caution about fabricated proof is frequently credited as evidence of judgement.

5. Define digital analytics. Describe the key metrics and KPIs used in digital analytics, and explain how these help businesses measure the success of their online campaigns. [SEE, Oct/Nov 2023, Q10a — 10 M]

Definition. Digital analytics is the collection, measurement, analysis and reporting of data from every digital touchpoint — website, mobile app, social media, e-mail, search and paid advertising — in order to understand customer behaviour and optimise business performance. It is broader than web analytics, which covers website data only.

Acquisition metrics

(1) Sessions, users and new users; traffic by channel, source and campaign; impressions and click-through rate; cost per click and cost per acquisition. *They answer:* where audiences come from and what each channel costs.

Engagement metrics

(1) Bounce and engagement rate; average engagement time; pages per session; scroll depth; video completion; social engagement rate. *They answer:* whether the audience found the content relevant once it arrived.

Conversion metrics

(1) Conversion rate; goal or key-event completions; cart-abandonment rate; form completion rate; average order value; revenue and revenue per visitor. *They answer:* whether attention became business value.

Retention and value metrics

(1) Repeat purchase rate; returning-user rate; cohort retention; churn; customer lifetime value; net promoter score. *They answer:* whether the business is acquiring customers or merely transactions.

Efficiency metrics

(1) Return on ad spend; return on investment; cost per lead; LTV-to-CAC ratio. *They answer:* whether the whole operation is profitable — the only question that finally matters.

How these measure campaign success

(1) **They make objectives testable.** A campaign target expressed as a KPI with a number can be passed or failed; one expressed as "build awareness" cannot.

(2) **They allow channel comparison on a common basis,** so budget moves to the channel with the best cost per outcome rather than the largest traffic.
(3) **They diagnose, not merely score.** Read as a funnel, the families above localise failure — good traffic with poor engagement is a content problem; good engagement with poor conversion is a landing-page or offer problem.
(4) **They enable mid-campaign correction,** because the data arrives while the campaign is still running.
(5) **They separate vanity from value.** Impressions and likes describe activity; conversion, CAC, LTV and ROAS describe results — and campaigns judged only on the first set can look successful while losing money.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 2 M for the definition, 5 M for the KPIs presented in structured families rather than as a flat list, and 3 M for how they measure success. Grouping the metrics by funnel stage is itself worth marks, because it demonstrates that they are understood as a system.

6. Trace the evolution of digital analytics and its growing importance in delivering a seamless end-to-end customer experience. [Improvement CIE, 4 Jun 2025 — 10 M]

The six eras

(1) **Server log analysis (1990s).** Hit counters and log files parsed by tools such as Analog and WebTrends. Counted file requests, not people — images inflated "hits", caching hid visits, and no user could be identified.
(2) **Page-tag web analytics (early 2000s).** JavaScript tags and cookies arrived with Urchin, then Google Analytics in 2005. Sessions, pageviews and referrers became measurable, and analytics became free and universal — but measurement stopped at the browser.
(3) **Visitor and goal analytics (late 2000s).** Goals, funnels, segmentation and e-commerce tracking connected traffic to outcomes for the first time, so marketing could report ROI rather than volume.
(4) **Multi-channel and social analytics (early 2010s).** Mobile apps, social platforms and multi-touch attribution entered the picture; the limitation was that each channel still reported in its own silo, with last-click distorting credit.
(5) **User-centric, event-based analytics (late 2010s–2020s).** The unit of analysis moved from the session to the user and from the pageview to the event; cross-device identity through User-ID and CRM stitching, and GA4's event model, made the individual journey visible.
(6) **Unified, predictive and privacy-first analytics (2020s onward).** Customer data platforms, warehouse-native analytics, machine-learning predictions, consent mode, server-side tagging and modelled conversions — more inference from less individual-level data.

The direction of travel. From counting files to predicting behaviour; from sessions to people; from channel silos to one connected view; from retrospective reporting to real-time and forward-looking decisioning.

Why it matters for end-to-end customer experience

(1) **Customers never experienced the silos in the first place.** A buyer who sees an advertisement, researches on a phone, asks on WhatsApp and buys on a laptop experiences one journey; only unified analytics can see what they already lived.
(2) **Decisions are made across touchpoints, not at one of them.** Measuring the last click credits the final touch and defunds the ones that created the demand.
(3) **Personalisation and continuity depend on a single customer view,** which is exactly what the last two eras made possible.
(4) **Requirements for genuine end-to-end measurement:** consistent identity resolution; a

standardised event and data-layer specification across channels; offline and CRM integration; multi-touch attribution; post-purchase and service data included; consent captured and honoured throughout; and one governed set of metric definitions — without which "end-to-end" remains a diagram rather than a measurement.

Marking scheme: 10 M. Roughly 6 M for the evolution — eras named, dated and with the limitation of each — and 4 M for the connection to end-to-end customer experience. The question says "trace", so chronological structure is itself part of the mark.

7. A company plans to enter a competitive global market. Explain how digital analytics and website optimization can help it maintain competitive advantage. [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 10 M]

(1) **Market selection before entry.** Search-demand data, Google Trends, competitor traffic analysis and Similarweb-style benchmarking identify which markets have genuine unmet demand — so entry is a measured decision rather than an assumption about market size.
(2) **Competitor benchmarking.** Analytics on competitors' keywords, content, advertising and backlink profiles reveals where they are strong and, more usefully, the segments and queries they neglect.
(3) **Market-by-market customer insight.** Behaviour differs sharply by country — device mix, payment preference, session times, price sensitivity — and only per-market analytics prevents a single global assumption being applied everywhere.
(4) **Localisation driven by data.** Language and transcreation, local currency and pricing, locally preferred payment methods, delivery expectations and regionally hosted or CDN-accelerated pages so that speed is acceptable in each market, not only at head office.
(5) **Website optimisation for conversion in each market.** The same page rarely converts equally everywhere; per-market A/B testing of headline, offer framing, trust signals and checkout flow is what turns traffic into revenue locally.
(6) **Technical and mobile optimisation.** Core Web Vitals measured from each target region, mobile-first design for markets that are overwhelmingly mobile, and lightweight pages for low-bandwidth conditions.
(7) **Efficient acquisition through measurement.** Cost per acquisition and ROAS compared across markets and channels allows capital to be concentrated where returns are highest — decisive for a new entrant with finite budget competing against incumbents.
(8) **Retention and lifetime value analysis.** Cohort retention and CLV by market show where customers stay, which is a better guide to long-term investment than first-purchase volume.
(9) **Governance, privacy and risk.** Consent management under GDPR, CCPA and DPDP, region-specific tagging and compliant data handling — in a global market this is a condition of operating, and getting it wrong is a competitive disadvantage in itself.
(10) **The durable advantage is speed of learning.** Products, prices and creative are copyable; an organisation's rate of measuring, testing and correcting is not. A new entrant that runs a disciplined measure–test–learn cycle compounds small advantages faster than a larger incumbent that reviews performance quarterly — which is why analytics capability, rather than any single optimisation, is the competitive advantage worth building.

Marking scheme: 10 M for ten points at 1 M each. Both named instruments — digital analytics *and* website optimisation — must be covered, and the answer must be visibly about a *global, competitive* entry, so localisation, per-market measurement and regional compliance are the context marks.

8. A food delivery app wants to improve customer retention. Apply digital analytics concepts to solve the problem. [CIE-III, Jun 2026 — 10 M]

Answer as a five-step method — measure, segment, diagnose, act, re-measure — because the question says "apply", not "describe".

Step 1 — Measure the actual problem

(1) Establish the baseline: Day 1, Day 7 and Day 30 retention; cohort retention curves by acquisition month and source; churn rate; order frequency; repeat-order rate; and customer lifetime value against acquisition cost. Retention is a curve, not a number, and the shape shows whether users leave immediately or fade gradually — two entirely different problems.

Step 2 — Segment

(1) Split by acquisition channel, by first-order experience (was it late? was it discounted?), by order frequency band, by city and by RFM value tier. Retention almost always differs sharply between segments, and the average conceals which one is failing.
(2) Identify the highest-value cohort and the fastest-churning cohort specifically — for most delivery apps, users acquired through deep discounts churn fastest, which is itself a finding about acquisition, not retention.

Step 3 — Diagnose

(1) In-app funnel and event analysis: where do returning users drop — app open, restaurant browse, cart, checkout, payment?
(2) Behavioural and qualitative evidence: session recordings, crash and slow- screen reports, delivery-time data against order rating, support tickets, cancellation reasons and app-store review sentiment.
(3) Correlate churn with experience variables — a single late delivery, an unresolved refund, or a failed payment is typically the strongest single predictor of churn, and this is discoverable only by joining operational data to behavioural data.

Step 4 — Act on the diagnosis

(1) Fix the operational causes first — delivery-time reliability, refund handling, payment failure rates — since no marketing offsets a broken core experience.
(2) Personalise and re-engage: recommendations from order history, one-tap reorder, segmented push at each user's habitual ordering hour, a subscription pass for frequent users, and loyalty streaks.
(3) Build lifecycle automation: a strong first-order onboarding sequence, a second-order incentive (the second order is the strongest predictor of long-term retention), proactive service recovery after any failed delivery, and a win-back flow at defined inactivity thresholds.

Step 5 — Re-measure

(1) Run each intervention against a held-out control group so that improvement is attributable rather than coincidental; track the same cohort retention curves, repeat-order rate and CLV; and iterate monthly. Without a control group, a seasonal uplift will be reported as a retention success.

Marking scheme: 10 M. The marks are for *applying* analytics — a defined method, specific metrics, a real diagnosis and a measured validation. A generic essay on customer retention with no metrics and no control group answers a different question and is marked accordingly.

Appendix A — Paper-wise Concordance

The body of this book is arranged unit-wise. This appendix inverts that arrangement. Each paper is listed in its original order, with the unit the question belongs to and the page on which its answer appears — so a past paper can be attempted end to end and then marked against the answers, without hunting through the chapters.

SEE, June/July 2025

Q. No.	Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
PART A				
1.1	Differentiate push and pull marketing	02	I	1
1.2	Four characteristics of good content	02	I	1
1.3	Primary goal of social media marketing	02	II	18
1.4	Primary objective of SEO	02	II	18
1.5	How bounce rate affects performance assessment	02	III	40
1.6	Importance of segmentation in e-mail marketing	02	III	40
1.7	Integrating SEO in website development	02	IV	61
1.8	Role of geo-targeting in mobile marketing	02	IV	61
1.9	Importance of Satisfaction in AIDAS	02	V	83
1.10	End-to-end customer experience	02	V	83
PART B				
2a	Website analysis, CX and conversion optimisation	08	I	6
2b	Content research tools and competitive edge	08	I	7
3a	Facebook and Instagram across the funnel	08	II	21
3b	SEO content plan, eco-friendly e-commerce	08	II	22
4a	Social media analytics and audience profiles	08	II	23
4b	B2B plan using Google Analytics and SEMrush	08	II	23
5a	Marketing plan for an e-learning platform	08	III	46
5b	Failed e-mail campaign and marketing research	08	III	47
6a	Effectiveness of responsive e-mail design	08	III	48
6b	Contribution of Google Tag Manager	08	III	49
7a	Google Analytics and Hotjar for user insight	08	IV	68
7b	Mobile plan, food delivery, student segment	08	IV	69
8a	Mobile marketing against technological change	08	IV	69
8b	Apps, chatbots and social for global presence	08	IV	70
9a	KPIs for website optimisation and conversions	08	V	86
9b	Refining segmentation with digital analytics	08	V	87
10a	Design a holistic marketing dashboard	08	V	88
10b	AIDAS to structure a product landing page	08	V	89

SEE, September/October 2024

Q. No.	Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
PART A				

Q. No.	Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
1.1	Importance of demographic segmentation	02	I	1
1.2	Identify the 4 P's of marketing	02	I	2
1.3	Sell this pen — how would you respond	02	I	2
1.4	Two types of research data	02	I	2
1.5	Your own psychographic and demographic profile	02	I	2
1.6	Psychographic segmentation: merit and limit	02	I	3
1.7	Quantitative feedback for a student app	02	I	3
1.8	Four online marketing tools for beginners	02	I	3
1.9	Benefits of A/B testing in e-mail marketing	02	III	40
1.10	Mobile advertising against mobile marketing	02	IV	61
PART B				
2a	Four key principles of digital marketing	08	I	5
2b	Four channels to spread awareness of a product	08	I	5
3a	Social media campaign for a local bakery	08	II	24
3b	On-site against off-site SEO	08	II	25
4a	Importance of SEO in digital marketing	08	II	26
4b	Benefits and challenges of social media	08	II	27
5a	Key features of Google Analytics	10	III	43
5b	Elements of an effective e-mail campaign	06	III	44
6a	Importance of web analytics	10	III	44
6b	Short notes: bounce rate, monthly unique visitors	06	III	45
7a	Steps to publish a basic small-business website	08	IV	64
7b	Any four important website metrics	08	IV	65
8a	Challenges of mobile marketing for promotion	08	IV	66
8b	Importance of user-centered design	08	IV	67
9a	AIDAS model and conversion optimisation	08	V	84
9b	Purpose of website optimisation	08	V	85
10a	Technology, data and tools transforming presence	08	V	90
10b	Evolution of digital analytics, and what is next	08	V	91

SEE, October/November 2023

Q. No.	Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
PART A				
1.x	Any two principles of digital marketing	02	I	4
1.x	Market segmentation against marketing mix	02	I	4
1.x	Define hashtag and its importance	02	II	19
1.x	Importance of keyword research	02	II	19
1.x	Dimensions and metrics in Google Analytics	02	III	41
1.x	Two components of a successful e-mail campaign	02	III	42
1.x	Branding and consistency in web design	02	IV	63
1.x	Mobile web against mobile app marketing	02	IV	64
1.x	Impact of user behaviour analysis	02	IV	64
1.x	Role of the AIDAS framework in CRO	02	V	84
PART B				
2a	Digital marketing and five differences	08	I	7
2b	Pricing strategies with examples	08	I	15
3a	Metrics for social media campaign success	08	II	33
3b	Best practices for shareable social content	08	II	39
4a	Concept and significance of SEO	08	II	27
4b	Role of content in SEO	08	II	30

Q. No.	Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
5a	Acquisition channels in Google Analytics	08	III	53
5b	A/B testing and conversion rate optimisation	08	III	54
6b	Reports available in Google Analytics	08	III	54
7a	Role of UI and UX in web design for marketing	08	IV	79
7b	Importance of testing and optimisation	08	IV	80
8a	Push notifications in mobile marketing	08	IV	80
8b	Significance of mobile analytics	08	IV	81
9a	The conversion funnel and its drop-offs	08	V	94
9b	Social proof and its impact on conversion	08	V	95
10a	Digital analytics — key metrics and KPIs	10	V	96
10b	Setting up and tracking goals in Analytics	06	III	55

Continuous Internal Evaluation Papers

CIE papers set two-mark questions and ten-mark descriptive questions. Question numbers were not consistently printed on all of them, so the questions are listed by paper in the order they were set.

Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
CIE-I — 1 July 2024			
Principles of digital marketing against traditional	10	I	8
SEO, PPC or SMM for a high-tech gadget	10	I	11
Five metrics for content marketing performance	10	I	14
GreenTech "EcoChef" content strategy	10	I	14
Data-driven insights in social media marketing	10	II	35
CIE-I — 3 April 2025			
Marketplace against market space	02	I	3
The mantra of marketing	02	I	4
Affiliate marketing, defined with an example	02	I	4
Four characteristics of good content	02	I	1
Push against pull marketing	02	I	1
E-commerce content marketing strategy	10	I	12
Travel agency buyer persona	10	I	16
Traditional to digital transition for a retailer	10	I	10
Entities that can be marketed	10	I	9
The 4 Ps in the digital era	10	I	9
CIE-I — 16 April 2026			
Marketplace against market space	02	I	3
First step of content marketing	02	I	4
Two core concepts of marketing	02	I	4
Four characteristics of good content	02	I	1
Push against pull marketing	02	I	1
Health and wellness content strategy	10	I	13
Travel agency buyer persona	10	I	16
Traditional to digital transition for a retailer	10	I	10
Key components of SEO and their contribution	10	II	28
Aligning web analytics KPIs with business goals	10	III	52
CIE-II and CIE-II Quiz — 24 July 2024			
Two technical aspects affecting organic ranking	02	II	20
Define SEO and its importance	02	II	20
Two considerations when writing SEO content	02	II	20
Two metrics for a travel agency's e-mail campaign	02	III	42
Raising open and click rates for a fashion sale	02	III	43

Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
Metrics for organic ranking and the SEO audit	10	II	31
SEO audit for an educational institution	10	II	32
Integrating keywords into technical content	10	II	30
Segmentation and personalisation in e-mail	10	III	55
Organic skincare e-mail launch case study	10	III	56
CIE-II — 7 May 2025			
Importance of keyword research	02	II	19
On-site against off-site SEO	02	II	20
Purpose of optimising organic rankings	02	II	20
Main purpose of Google Analytics	02	III	41
Two web analytics tools other than Analytics	02	III	41
Importance and integration of social media	10	II	33
Comparing Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn and X	10	II	34
On-site against off-site SEO, with examples	10	II	29
Role of web analytics and its benefits	10	III	51
Setting up Analytics for a new e-commerce site	10	III	51
CIE-II — 26 May 2026			
Data-driven audience insight	02	II	18
Four elements of an effective social campaign	02	II	19
Campaign optimisation and its purpose	02	II	19
Four benefits of social media for business	02	II	19
Define web analytics and its importance	02	III	41
Four features of Google Analytics	02	III	41
Campaign analysis in e-mail marketing	02	III	42
Define click-through rate in e-mail	02	III	42
Four advantages of e-mail over traditional	02	III	42
How bounce rate affects performance assessment	02	III	40
Importance of segmentation in e-mail	02	III	40
The Facebook algorithm filter	10	II	36
The customer lifecycle orbit	10	II	37
The content lifecycle matrix	10	II	37
The four Rs of content scaling	10	II	38
Traditional against web analytics-based analysis	10	III	50
Analysing e-mail effectiveness using KPIs	10	III	57
Challenges in e-mail marketing, with solutions	10	III	58
Integrating web analytics and e-mail marketing	10	III	58
E-mail plan for a business targeting students	10	III	59
CIE-III — June 2026			
What is website optimization	02	IV	62
Two principles of website design	02	IV	62
Mobile advertising against mobile marketing	02	IV	61
What is digital analytics	02	V	84
How digital analytics influences decisions	02	V	84
Web design and the importance of optimisation	10	IV	71
Visitors leaving a start-up site within seconds	10	IV	72
Designing and publishing a college website	10	IV	73
Analytics and optimisation for global entry	10	V	98
Retention for a food delivery app	10	V	99
Improvement CIE — 28 August 2024			
Image optimisation and website performance	02	IV	63
Four metrics of website success	02	IV	63
Push notifications for sales promotions	02	IV	63
Impact of user-friendly design	02	IV	63

Question (abridged)	M	Unit	Page
Mobile advertising against mobile marketing	02	IV	61
Travel agency landing page converting poorly	10	IV	75
Online applications as mobile marketing tools	10	IV	76
Luxury cosmetics mobile flash sale	10	IV	77
Design principles and website copy	10	IV	78
AIDAS in detail, with examples per stage	10	V	93
Improvement CIE — 4 June 2025			
Two principles of user-centered design	02	IV	62
How website metrics help optimisation	02	IV	62
Two elements visitors expect on a landing page	02	IV	62
Mobile advertising against mobile marketing	02	IV	61
What AIDAS stands for	02	V	83
What visitors look for on a business webpage	10	IV	74
User-centered layout for an e-commerce startup	10	IV	74
Mobile promotional campaign plan	10	IV	77
AIDAS and optimising landing page elements	10	V	94
Evolution of analytics and end-to-end experience	10	V	97

Coverage Summary

Unit	Part A	Part B	Total Q	Total M
I — Digital & Content Marketing	17	16	33	34 + 142
II — Social Media & SEO	13	24	37	26 + 212
III — Analytics & E-mail	14	22	36	28 + 196
IV — Web Design & Mobile	15	22	37	30 + 196
V — Conversion & Analytics	6	16	22	12 + 142
Total	**65**	**100**	**165**	**130 + 888**

The mark column is shown as *Part A + Part B* because the two are not comparable: Part A questions are worth two marks each in every paper, whereas Part B sub-divisions are worth six, eight or ten depending on the paper. The totals far exceed the marks of any single sitting, because every internal-choice alternative and every paper is answered here.

Where the marks concentrate. In the SEE, Unit I carries the most Part A questions but only the compulsory Q2 in Part B, while Units II to V each carry a 16-mark internal-choice pair. The practical consequence for revision is that Unit I must be known broadly but not deeply, whereas any *one* of Units II to V left unprepared costs a full 16 marks that no choice can recover — the internal choice is *within* a unit and never *between* units.

The CIE pattern is different. Each CIE covers roughly two units in depth with ten-mark descriptive questions, so the same topic is examined at greater length than in the SEE. Questions repeated across papers are the highest-value revision targets: push against pull marketing, the four characteristics of good content, mobile advertising against mobile marketing, on-site against off-site SEO, and the AIDAS model have each been set three or more times.